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Prologue

Introduction

Chorus is a world rich with diverse life—life brought about through the influence of turbulent ether that seeps into every crevice of its lands and the hearts of its creatures. It was starlings, the beings most sensitive to ether, who first bestowed the world with its name. A charming moniker that emphasizes many voices coming together in harmony. Unfortunately, many of those voices are savage and dangerous. They lurk throughout Chorus, crying out in hunger and territorial brutality, much to the dismay of the people that wish for sanctuary. These discordant voices grow louder and more numerous with each passing day.

These perils echo loudest on the continent of Lalos. Home to a fantastic variety of peoples and places that have existed in a tenuous balance for generations. Much of Chorus is too dangerous for larger settlements to be established; instead there are clans of people that amount to little more than sparse villages and communes. As clans were left to the untamed wilds that do their utmost to tear apart nascent civilizations, a need for empowered fighters arose. Powerful combatants to face down each crisis that threatens nearby homes.

For a long measure of Lalos's history, clans were the sole divider of peoples and cultures across the land. The first clans are suspected to have belonged to the keb rasska, two different species from deep underground that developed symbiotically. Clans began to splinter and migrate to other regions of Lalos when resources became too scarce to support their size. Eventually, differences of opinion would redefine these disparate clans—rather than simple population bloat. As other species rose to prominence this distinction was asserted through the geographic needs (or lack thereof) found with each group of people.

Competition for territory was rarely waged between clans, but came from packs of beasts, ranges of destructive plants, and swarms of mindless insects. Such competition rarely saw clear victory for a clan and frequently resulted in their complete annihilation. While a larger clan stands better odds at defending itself in direct combat, it is increasingly difficult to successfully feed such a population. Clans often wither away due to poor harvests—whether from the wilds, sabotage, or simply bad luck. Such became the rallying cry for Rovers. For you.

Rovers separate from their clans for the benefit of all, leaving even their traditions behind to tame the savagery strewn about the world. To rove the land in search of people and places in need of sanctuary that only their special talents can provide; learning to harness the very energy that contributes to the brutal harmonies found across Chorus. Through Rovers, the peoples of Chorus invest their hopes and dreams for a more harmonious future.



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Prologue

Tales of a Nameless Deed

As with any grand formula, change rarely occurs in isolation. An infinite number of variables are affected by an infinite number of dependents. This is why the starlings refer to it as Chorus, after all—it is the many voices that make up the song which has composed our world. I just wish, perhaps, for the volume to... be lowered in intensity. A small note becomes dangerously raucous in the presence of the energies that are weaved through the world. I have heard the rising pitch across the land and fear that I will be unable to ensure it is our part in the performance that withstands the violent crescendos.

I have frequently traveled the meridians of Lalos (as any apostle should!). When it comes to the metaphoric richness of a melody I consider our home on this continent to be unmatched. Such a diverse and interesting region of the world we live upon! As of late, each of those journeys now reveal more perils spreading across the lands at an alarming pace. Long ago it was those of us who feared losing ourselves to the savage wilds that sought to establish Rovers as a means of defense against the power struggle between Clans and Crises.

Rovers are the powerful individuals from the Clans who have sworn themselves to defend people against the untamed aspects of Chorus as a whole. To Rove is to divide yourself from the interests of one's Clan in favor of the interests of all. Wielding the energies of Chorus to cleave a path to the future we all desire; each Rover represents a promise to the hopes of all people that yearn for a better life.

Introduction

Silky, an ancient zusag that leads one of the more secluded mountain clans, paces back and forth in front of your party. Zusag are well-known for the intensity and eccentricity their communities can breed; the wizened individual muttering to himself in front of your group is the perfect embodiment of those labels. Befitting enough, for a certain audacity is necessary to call together Rovers from different parts of the continent as he has. Each of you received a message that emphasized an impending great danger... but it was curiously vague. It shouldn't have been a surprise to discover it was something of a trick to gather multiple Rovers in one place.

Unwilling to ignore a clan leader's plea, you find yourselves in a small outpost at the foot of the northern mountains that Silky calls home—waiting for this scholarly bundle of limbs and fur to get to the point. With a flourish, Silky conjures a gleaming avian construct on one hand and unravels a heavily-scrawled-upon map of Lalos in the other. He traces his fingers across various rough lines scribbled across the map, illustrating the peak of the mountains where his village is built, to the points of interest denoted throughout the entire continent. Mentions of things like “knock-on effects,” “imbalance of the Arcane,” and other jargon washes over you all in a lengthy and impassioned speech about the state of Chorus at large.

To Silky, there isn't one danger, but many—all of which he claims to be tracking. Some dangers brewing for long enough that he is convinced that a single Rover would be incapable of handling the situation, hence the deception used to gather together your party. A questionable ploy as Rovers rarely, if ever, find themselves working in groups. Too many problems spread too far across Lalos to justify pulling this many Rovers into one location.

One such danger is the obvious one of Uzem, The King of Storms. Close to the heart of Lalos is a giant shrine, carved out from a colossal tree, known as Uzem's Throne. Rumored to have been built by a primitive clan lost to time, Uzem has been part of the continent's history both written and unwritten as far back as any can tell. From his Throne, he conjures mighty storms—gales and lightning that have shaped the continent generation after generation—bending the land to his whim. No matter how one views it, Uzem has always been a quantifiable threat to the clans that call Lalos their home.

Uzem is quite literally a force of nature and is treated as such; clan migrations, scouting parties, and other such endeavors seek to keep track of the regular pattern of storms that billow forth from the Throne. As of late, that pattern has become very irregular, leaving nearby clans unprepared for sudden downpours and other destruction in the wake of the storms. Even the reclusive tihfur clans, who largely consider themselves masters of discerning sudden changes in their territories, have fallen victim to Uzem's strange temperaments. The King of Storms would certainly be far too great of a threat for a single Rover to face but Silky's efforts to bring you all together may tip the odds in your favor.

Silky clicks his nails against one of his antlers to catch your attention. “We will first travel south to Uzem's Throne and come to terms with what it means for Rovers to work together as a group. This will be a new experience for us all, but let me assure you that I have foreseen nothing but the fantastic as a result of this endeavor!” He leaps forth in a surprising display of agility for one his age, beckoning for your group to follow. The only thing left is to trust that the old zusag hasn't gone senile.

Campaign Link



Go to “Fling to the Hollow Gale”  pg. 6.

Fling to the Hollow Gale

Introduction

Transcribed musings from “Silky,” Fundamentalist of the Mist clan.

Scattered accounts from starlings that have traveled to other continents suggest that Uzem is not the only addax that has earned an epithet related to their destructive capabilities, but Lalos is home to just the one. I continue to find myself curious about the evolutionary link between whatever proto-being existed before the likes of zusag and crown emerged from the primordial therans.

The avian conjuration of Silky’s is supposedly just a refinement of the aerios pattern common among burgeoning akmeists, sophists, holists, and other such roles of zusag associates. “Just a refinement” seems a gross understatement to any of you—conjurations do not simply allow one to broadcast their voice or expand their vision with complete freedom. Silky’s seemingly endless list of concerns spread across the entirety of Lalos does make more sense now; few have the ready capability to supervise a whole continent.

Your trip from the northern peaks, where Silky’s home of Tuor lies, to the secluded valley where Uzem’s Throne rests near the center of Lalos should have taken a full week or more. Instead, Silky pressed your march down to a grueling few days. If you didn’t know better his musings might have betrayed an annoyance at not managing such an arduous journey even faster. Worse still is that the entire last day of the journey was beset by one of the irregular storms plaguing the region. The excursion to build camaraderie instead finds it to be in short supply. Somehow, Silky remains as tireless and upbeat as ever.

The blissful reprieve held within a roughshod and hurriedly set camp outside of the towering landmark is called short as your indefatigable leader finishes scouting around the shrine with his aerios. “Well, we’ve good news and bad. The good: There’s no sign of Uzem, despite the raging storms... so that means our investigation can

proceed apace! The bad: Our journey took long enough that not only did a swarm of galeaper take residence, but with the number of molting young, a queen is likely present. That will impede the investigation more than I’d like, but let’s cast two stones where we can! Your work to develop as a team will function just as well through a gauntlet of entoman infestation as it would have the silvan that I expected to be here.”

It seems your efforts will begin with a task well-known to Rovers—dispatching entoman that have grown fat and complacent through devouring the local flora. There seems to be quite the large collection of creatures; the ground flutters and buzzes with the squirming young of the galeaper seeking to consume anything they can wrap their mandibles around. Perhaps it is a boon after all that you were brought as a team. Not that any of you would want Silky to have the satisfaction of hearing you say as much.

Setup



Take 0 ▶ Go to 3 ▶ Go to 2.

Victory Condition



Hold out against the galelings.

Round limit: 4

Terrain



Spaces with a blue border and the icon slows your movement down. It costs an extra movement point to dash into these spaces (pg. 24).



Spaces with a yellow border and the icon block dash actions (pg. 25).

Abilities

For this first round, focus on your abilities (pg. 58). Abilities are the four tiles you inserted into your player board during setup. When it's your turn, you will perform two of these abilities. Focus on your abilities that let you Dash X (pg. 28) or Jump X (pg. 29) and either Melee Attack or Range Attack (pg. 33).

Rove is played in phases, and the first phase is the Rover phase (pg. 58), which means you get to take your turns first. Decide amongst yourself in what order you would like to take your turns.

When your turn begins, use your ability that contains a X or X action to move closer to the galelings, then attack one of them with an

ability that contains either a action or action. Each attack has a Range X value (pg. 33), which explains how far away an enemy can be for you to be able to target them. Make sure to use your dash or jump action to get within range of the attack you would like to perform.

When you attack an enemy, roll the damage dice, adjust your damage based on your ether affinity which is found on your class board, and resolve damage against your target (pg. 36). To track the damage you deal to adversaries, place damage chits within the slot that matches their standee number in the damage tracker (pg. 27).

Your ability tiles slide within the slot they are placed into. When you activate an ability, slide it within its slot revealing the red X to indicate that you've used one of your ability activations.

Below is the Codex Links section for the encounter. When you meet the condition of a codex link entry, read that entry. In this case, once each Rover has taken their turn we'll go over how adversaries take their turns.

Codex Links



Q 1

After all Rovers have taken their turn and performed two abilities, the Rover phase is over, read “Its Sullen Sound”, 2.

When Each Thing Joy Supplied

Introduction

Transcribed musings from “Silky,” Fundamentalist of the Mist clan.

Alchemy, industry, ecology... ether lies at the heart of all of these, yet to my reckoning we have barely begun to scratch the surface. We yield decent respect to the various keb rasska clans who literally name themselves along some of these disciplines, but of course their focus tends to be so narrowly defined. Similarly, every major record we’ve compiled of theran, silvan, and entoman alike are all bereft of elaborated detail.

Surely we can all do better. Perhaps this is something to bring forward during the next caucus...

Makaal tumbles back to the alcove he has been calling home for the past day, another box in hand. The human beams triumphantly as he shows his prize to the starling and arkenyn huddled inside, his grin showing no worry toward the danger he has just escaped. “You see, Mo! I told you I could do it.” he exclaims.

Mo, a starling replete with water ether and limbs reminiscent of a keb, waves one of their dripping tendrils. “Yes. Good. Just thirty or so more trips through the starving galeaper.” Makaal scratches his nose and turns to face the arkenyn, hoping for a more positive response. Arkenyn are large, white, quadrupedal therans native to the central band of Lalos. This furry theran in particular opts to ignore the merchant and adjusts his heavy frame to try and find a more comfortable position to continue his rest. Makaal sighs in defeat, “Grandpaw, can’t you at least pretend to be proud of me?” His request falls upon fuzzy, round, deaf ears.

“Well, what have we here? I was under the impression that this shrine was no place for the well-reasoned...” croaked an old, and oddly ringing, voice. The merchant whips his head around, frantically searching for the source. “Hello?! Where are you? Can you help us? I may be swift and brave, but I am definitely sure we would be better off

handling our situation with some help!” Makaal shouts at the entrance of the alcove. Mo simply allows their tendrils to drift outside. The ether-sensitive sensory limbs are drawn towards a particularly bright aerios conjuration.

“That’s right, my pelagic peer, it is indeed the avian hence that speaks. Assistance can certainly be arranged, but what possessed you to take flight of your senses and climb The King of Storm’s Throne... during a storm?” Silky balks, equally as surprised to find a small party aside from his own this far from safety. Makaal peers out from the alcove to face the speaker. “Would you believe there wasn’t a storm when we first decided to travel through this valley? Not to mention the surprise of a galeaper swarm... If you can help us, I’m more than happy to bargain away any of our wares you recover!”

The aerios tilts its head and lets out a short chuckle. “Well, let us twist your misfortune to fortune on this day, shall we?”

Setup



Take 0 ▶ Go to 4 ▶ Go to 3.

3x Bursting Bells, 4x Hoards, 1x Treasure Chest,
1x Nektari Hive

Victory Condition



Get to an exit space.

Round limit: 5 ⌚

Terrain



Occupy an exit space before you run out of rounds (pg. 22).

Spaces with a red border and the dangerous icon damage non-flying units that enter into them. Non-flying units that enter into thick bramble suffer 1 (pg. 24).

Bursting bell trap tiles are placed throughout the map. Units that enter into these spaces trigger the trap, suffering 2 (pg. 25), then the trap tile is removed.

Spaces with white borders and the open air icon are open air spaces (pg. 24). You can attempt to push enemies into open air spaces, where they could fall (pg. 32).

You have the chance to earn extra loot. There are hoard tiles (pg. 26) across the map, most likely Mo and Makaal's dropped cargo. Try to grab what you can!

There's a treasure chest as well (pg. 26). Treasure chests are usually locked, so you'll have to search for the key if you want to open it.

There is a nektari hive. These are special objects (pg. 25). It has R*2 . If you destroy it you can grab the nektari pollen inside. Is there something shiny within it?

Spaces with a green border and an ether icon are ether nodes (pg. 25). During map setup, place the ether dice shown onto the ether node space. Almost every encounter will have some type and number of ether nodes. You'll find the rules for these



nodes within the terrain section of an encounter. Remember, Rovers that are adjacent to an ether node and performing a or action can spend one movement point to grab the ether dice from the node, adding that dice to their personal pool.



Units that end their turn within 1 of this object recover 1.

Overgrown Climb

Make sure that you've read the terrain rules above. There's dangerous terrain, traps, and open air you can use against your enemy. Try to benefit from the ether node while denying the same to adversaries.

Adversary Traits

Adversaries will often have traits (pg. 46). Check the dekahas statistic block to read their traits. Dekahas are deeply rooted. They can not move, can not be forced to move, and can not be pushed or pulled.

Codex Links



8

Immediately each time a Rover enters into a space with a hoard tile, remove the tile and read “**Favors Court Thy Smile**”, 7.

10

Immediately when the Nektari Hive is destroyed, read “**And Steal Their Sweets**”, 8.

9

After the Rover phase ends, read “**And Shake the Blooms**”, 8.

The Storms Hath Bound

Introduction

Transcribed musings from “Silky,” Fundamentalist of the Mist clan.

The singular pursuit of power is one that only ends in tragedy. Nothing better embodies a thoughtless reach for strength than the Star Hunter clan. Humans are well-known for their unusual adaptability—what twisted thoughts drove that clan to exploit themselves and others we may never know. If we must kill one another to empower ourselves, are we not driving ourselves further to the brink we seek to avoid?

The stormcaller runs her hands along the carapace of the tumescent galeaper broodmother. From midge to matriarch, the entoman has been her partner for years. Whether their prey was starling, crown, or even Uzem himself, they both understand that this is their responsibility; The King of Storms has to be brought to heel. While her clan works to fracture the seat of his power deep below, she would let her companion claim this upper hollow as her own. What a beautiful thing! To see your companion flourish to the peak of her form. To fill a false monarch's castle with her vibrant brood. Both stormcaller and galeaper can not help but salivate at the prospect of harvesting the power of The Seat of Storms for themselves.

Hissing, squealing, wailing—dozens of young galeaper stream in, clamoring for safety and succor from their mother. The stormcaller realizes this will be her companion's first real test. A queen must be able to rule her territory and enrich her subjects. One final time the stormcaller lets loose a gentle gust of wind along the queen's inarticulate wings, reminding her of the days when they used to leap together along streams of ether. Then it is time to say goodbye. The human sprints to the end of a great bough and unleashes her power, raw energy pumping through the Air-aspected crystals, harvested from unwitting prey, impaled through her hands and legs. A crack of thunder and a flash of

lightning disguise her departure; the sheets of rain obscuring her form.

Just as obscured by the blinding light is the glittering conjuration belonging to a certain elder zusag, ever watchful of any development within his purview. Nothing more could be left to chance. Lalos, and perhaps the entirety of Chorus, balances on a precarious edge. That a member of the Star Hunter clan would try and invade Uzem's Throne meant their power was growing too dangerous to be left unchecked. Silky would see his team through that ordeal eventually, but first he needed to be sure the Rovers could contend with more... conventional dangers. Dangers such as a nesting galeaper queen birthing enough spawn to populate an entire valley.

Setup



Take 0 ▶ Go to 5 ▶ Go to 4.

Tiles: 3x Bursting Bells, 2x Nektari Hives

Victory Condition



Slay the Galeaper Queen.

Round limit: 8

Terrain



Non-flying units that enter a thick bramble space suffer ⚡ 1.



Units that trigger Bursting Bell traps suffer ⚡ 2.



Galeaper Hive Entrances (use Nektari Hive tiles) are special objects with R*2 ♥.



Units within ↗ 1 of this object gain +1 🛡.



Spaces with a black border and the barrier 🛡 icon are out of bounds (pg. 24). No unit, tile, or token can enter into these spaces, and they block line-of-sight (pg. 29).

Galeapers

Mature galeapers guard their queen. Galeapers have the flying 🦋 trait (pg. 29), so they ignore difficult and dangerous terrain. They also don't suffer impact damage from being pushed into objects, as they normally can enter these spaces. Since no unit can enter a barrier space, you can push flying enemies into these spaces.

Large Adversaries

The Galeaper Queen, a rotund fearsome matriarch, is a large adversary (pg. 48). Read the previously cited rules carefully. Large adversaries occupy four spaces. Use the large stand for this adversary. Use the primary hex of the large stand as a reference when moving the Queen. Don't forget to evaluate

each space she occupies. You can place negative ether fields into each space the Queen occupies. You can also push the Queen into multiple dangerous terrain spaces at once with enough effort.

Don't forget that attacks that target the Queen are evaluated from the space she occupies that is closest to the attacker.

Galeaper Queen

The Galeaper Queen is a boss with several special features. Her hit points ♥ scale. As discussed in encounter 1, the R value in her hit point property is equal to the number of Rovers on the map.

The Queen has two traits. She gains a defense 🛡 value of 2 as long as at least one galeaper is on the map. Try slaying all the galeapers before attacking her, or use attacks with the ignore defense 🛡 effect. She also is resistant to being pushed. If you want to push the Queen into dangerous terrain or traps, you'll have to work together to do so.

The Hive Stirs

The Galeapers are alert to their Queen's plight. At the beginning of round 2, 4, 6, and 8, spawn R-1 Galeapers within ↗ 0-1 of the Galeaper Hive Entrance closest to the Rovers.

That's it for this encounter. The rest is up to you! Use all the rules you've learned up to this point to play this encounter.

Codex Links



🔍 15

Immediately when the Galeaper Queen is slain, read "**Borne in Heedless Hum**", 📖 11.

Chapter 1

A Choice

The air stills and your group collects themselves, attempting to shake loose the strange tension built during the brawl. Loud rattling and cracking resounds through the structure, similar to a rain storm's assault. Is this it? Has Addax Uzem returned to his throne—at the worst possible time? Each of you prepare for the worst. Peering out of a hole in the bark, one of your group hopes to catch sight of Uzem ... before letting out a breath and signaling for everyone to relax. You all share quizzical looks before the source of the disturbance presents itself.

When a keb rasska legion marches, everything nearby knows. The thousands of legs, the weight of the rasskas' reptilian limbs, the clicking of the kebs' insectoid segments, and the clattering of equipment—all of it contributes to a cacophony of sound—sharp and stinging. Add in a few dozen gruv dragging their spade tails through the rock as the beasts of burden carry the legion's provisions, and it's no wonder their march causes the ground to quake. Their gear and gleaming crystalline weapons catch Makaal's gaze, his face betraying conflicting emotions of desire and distaste. Leading the marching party at the side of a heavily-plated gruv is a massive rasska armored entirely in crystal. Atop the saddle of this battlemount is a stately keb whose chitin seems to have been completely bleached of color; a strange appearance for the often flamboyant insectoids.

Silky chuckles into the ensuing silence. "Aha... the clan of the Crystal Queens, already upon us." Makaal turns in confusion. "As a merchant that wanders the continent, shouldn't I have known of a roaming army?" Silky shakes his head and offers an upturned palm. "Little more than second-paw accounts of a peculiar clan risking their lives on treacherous mountain expeditions. Their pursuit has yet to be recorded in any meaningful way."

After the crystal-clad army marches off beyond the horizon, the valley settles into calm. Silky begs leave to return to Tuor, citing enough physical excitement for his 'harried bones.' He leaves one of his trademark aerios conjurations with the group. The daylight slowly melts away to a violet dusk. A sedate skyline hangs overhead

without a hint of any energy to it. Each of you has found a comfortable spot in your camp to wait, and hope, for the King of Storms's return to the Throne to be challenged. Waiting for Uzem's return begins to seem like a futile endeavor. Nothing to be done for it—Rovers have little control over forces of nature.

As the daylight disappears behind the mountains, a piercing crack from the southern treeline snaps your party to attention. Rising all at once the group focuses their attention toward the screeching of a massive bird breaking through the treeline. Or—no, not exactly a bird. Glowing in the silhouette of his head is a set of three eyes; one central—the Hayin—with another pair of eyes beneath. A signature characteristic of all tihfur—this one having shifted to their bestial avian form. "It was rumored that a clan of flying-tihfur lived near the Throne, but tihfur are difficult to track even under the best of conditions. Acolytes of nature and shadow aren't usually found unless they desire it," Makaal ruminates. "Seems this one desires to be found," Mo retorts, one tendril drifting toward a sheathed knife. Silky's laughter tinkles through the aerios. "Acolytes of light tend to fare better when finding places and people. This, too, was expected. Sheath your arms and hear them out."

The tihfur lands fluidly in the center of your camp. His avian features recede into a thin down of feathers along his arms and upper torso. The tihfur man closes his lower eyes and gives a slight bow to each of you, his Hayin inspecting the gleaming aerios. "Caw," flatly chimes Silky through the aerios, causing the tihfur to flinch, followed by Silky's bemused laughter. "Your instincts were entirely correct, my feathered friend. I suspect you saw this camp on your way out of the Taharik, hoping to find some sort of assistance?" The tihfur anxiously flexes his talons in the dirt before lifting off and gesturing for you to follow.

Makaal watches the tihfur disappear into the darkened sky with particular interest, tapping his finger against the head of his arkenyn companion in thought. "To be so openly and willingly welcomed into the lands of kin... Strange. Curious." Mo trills in agreement while

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inspecting the marks left behind in the ground. “His behavior too...” they note quietly. The aeries gestures excitedly with its wings. “It would seem there is a decision to make, Rovers!” Silky chimes. “Both the marching keb rasska and the tifhur’s invitation fall under the purview of our assembly; I am equally interested in the details to be found from either while we await Uzem.”

You have been left with two choices—they are the paths that lie ahead, Rovers. Remember that you are a testament to the heights which no other is willing to achieve, the depths which no other is willing to breach. Your lives are filled with challenge and excitement in equal measure.

Special Rules



Adversary Ether Field

In the bottom right hand corner of the campaign sheet you will track the effects of adversary  and  ether fields. For Quest 0-2, there is only one possible effect. Fill in both pips as a reminder of what the effect is.

Choice



A Help the Yenshif.

Open up quest box 1 / 6 and unpack the standees.

Place the Alad Ahma sticker, A-1, onto the map.

Proceed to page 14 of the campaign book.

B Help the Kebraska tribe.

Open up quest box 2 / 5 and unpack the standees.

Place the Crystal Caves sticker, C-2, onto the map.

Proceed to page 26 of the campaign book.

Quest 1

The Tihfur That Was Used Up

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Introduction

Transcribed musings from “Silky”, resident Fundamentalist of the Mist clan.

Tihfur are not so different from we zusag. Both of our peoples relish challenges—finding thrills where it aligns with our principles. Tihfur are merely more... specific... in their pursuits. Bound by... a more physical approach to their problems. This reflects their relationship to the element of Morph. The limitations of the body. Their most dreaded legends describe scenarios in which balance was eschewed—their “natural order” and the limitations of such—broken. How interesting that their greatest fears come not from distortions of either of what they consider souls, but of the body shared.

Mo, Makaal, and Silky all agree that when a tihfur clansman strikes out to ask for help, it's likely to be worse than was suggested by the messenger. This is likely a situation far out of the control of any clan. “I do believe that we should make haste!” the aerios acting as Silky's eyes, ears, and unrelenting mouth, proclaims.

Fighting one's way through the tangle of outer forests is an arduous endeavor. Tihfur clans prefer to keep as much of their territory as untouched as possible, relying on their natural advantages to outhunt the predators that would threaten their livelihoods. Silky emphasizes this further as he details the specific nature of this particular clan; the Yanshif. Their bodies shift into large avians with powerful talons, swift flight, and the capacity to see perfectly in the murk and darkness. Nocturnal hunters that rely upon stealth and overpowering force. That they are desperate enough to ask for assistance from outsiders is all the more worrying.

Most tihfur cultures highly value the predictable ebbs and flows of nature within their territories. The Taharik, a wide stretch of woodland in the southeast claimed by

the Yanshif clan, has been encroached upon by the ever-growing swamps and marshes that separate it from the edge of Lalos. What was once a natural boundary is now a breeding ground for a number of creatures the Yanshif are less equipped to handle, being a clan of almost strictly arboreal hunters. Rather than transforming their geography—more often the domain of keb rasska or human-led clans—tihfur clans prefer to migrate entirely to a more suitable home over time. In this case, the issues presented by the growth of the swamp are not imminent and would take many more years before they drive the clan from their current home.

It's possible a clan of entrenched and veteran hunters could be entirely overrun by a seasonal surge of invading marshland beasts; that is exactly the sort of thing Rovers are trained to contend with. But there could be something more going on. The first step is to find out why the clan felt the need to send out a messenger at all.

Campaign Link



Go to “In Search of the Yanshif”  16.

In Search of the Yanshif

Introduction

Transcribed excerpt from a presentation by “Silky,” resident Fundamentalist of the Mist clan.

Ether is quite a volatile thing. It must be expressed no matter what. Fire will consume. Water will connect. Earth will press. Air will move. Crux will manifest. Morph will shape. We can direct these expressions, but we cannot seem to fundamentally change them. They certainly can fundamentally change us though. Tihfur are the most prominent example of this. Morph is deeply intrinsic to the tihfur; it courses through the entirety of their bodies. If anybody has the capacity to change the nature of Morphic expression it would be the tihfur. But even then Morph will not be denied its one and only purpose: Morph will shape.

Makaal’s arkenyn begins snarling and snorting after passing by a patch of bramble. It draws its gaze up and emits a deep, rumbling growl at the treeline.

“Woah! Easy, easy, Grandpaw. Apologies, Rovers. It seems he’s scented something dangerous,” he explains, rubbing his hands through the arkenyn’s bristling fur.

Mo also presses a few of their tendrils through Grandpaw’s fur. “He has an excellent nose for trouble. Let us stay behind for now. I look forward to seeing all that you can do, Rovers.” With a quick flap of its wings, Silky’s aerios launches itself through the trees to inspect what might have disturbed Grandpaw. After a moment, it glides back to perch on a nearby branch.

“Without the clan actively patrolling the forest, a number of beasts have been free to nest here in its depths. Swarming galeaper are often the first symptom in any neglected region, spreading like a dark bruise over the landscape. When galeaper are left to ascend their local food chain, they are inevitably followed by larger and worse threats; for then follows the sickly green briarwog. Their fights over territory perpetuate a wanton cycle of savagery that spoils any chance for peaceable living for

clans in the area.

“When a male briarwog grows strong enough—perhaps on a steady diet of those same galeaper—they develop into a large bull ready to tend his own brood. Many females will flock to him in hopes of food, succor, and reproduction. Briarwogs in the act of rearing will ooze all kinds of vile fluids into the waters they use for spawning. This leads to a slow but certain poisoning of everything in and around the water. Hunting them will be more than a favor to the kin of clan Yanshif,” Silky concludes.

Assuming that tihfur messenger was not the only clan member to take flight from their home, then chances are the usual hunting parties have been too preoccupied to deal with threats like this. Your main burden as Rovers is always in service to making the world a safer place, which means this ever-burgeoning population of aggressive beasts will have to be dealt with.

Setup



Take 1/6 ▶ Go to 6 ▶ Go to 6.

Tiles: 3x Bursting Bells

Victory Condition



Slay Zipahudi the Briarbull.

Round limit: 8 ⌚

Challenges



- 1 Briarwogs have +2 ❤️.
- 2 Zipahudi the Briarbull is immune to all forced movement.
- 3 Zipahudi the Briarbull gains +1 🛡️ while there is at least one Briarwog on the map.

Terrain



Non-flying units that enter a thick bramble space suffer ⚡ 1.



Units that trigger Bursting Bell traps suffer ⚡ 2.



It costs units 1 additional movement point to enter a space within ↗ 1 of this object.

Codex Links



16

The first time a Grovetender is slain, read “**Silvan Theory**” 12.

17

When Zipahudi the Briarbull is slain, read “**The Airs That Brood**” 13.

Then Came too Late the Warning

Introduction

Transcribed excerpt from a presentation by “Silky,” resident Fundamentalist of the Mist clan.

Many of our own clans are content simply hiding our homes from prying eyes and letting that which draws near pass over us as would a harmless breeze. Should you, during your travels, find yourself suddenly surrounded by creatures that bear three eyes, it is no reason to balk! Tihfur clans take a more... proactive approach. Patrolling, hunting, stalking; any number of things that draw them out of their homes and into the wilds to ensure nothing would threaten that safety. Offer them the same attitude you would any fellow associate and you will more than likely find yourself a guest of the night's feasts and festivities. Take the opportunity to inquire about their territory and how they defend it, then marvel at how the oft-reserved tihfur become an excited font of pride as they regale the stories and strategies that fill their nights.

The wretched screech of the strange tihfur now fills the distant woods, choking out any other cries. “I’ve dealt with many clans of kin in my life, and while some of them might be more or less unusual, they’ve never behaved... like that.” Makaal anxiously swings his arms through the air. “Guiding you through their territory, inviting you back to their home, stalking you until you depart their lands... any reaction to be found under the skies but that. It’s not the way of things!” Grandpaw snorts agreeably and Mo’s tendrils writhe irritably.

As the group tears through branches and bramble

trying to follow the strange noises to their source, Grandpaw suddenly rears back and snaps his snout wildly through the air—punctuated by an ear-splitting crack of splintered wood—then releases his jaws and lets the previously unseen arrow fall to the dirt. Makaal scrambles atop Grandpaw as the movement nearly throws him aside. “Cut the cauda! What—”

His swearing is interrupted when a deep bellowing shakes the treetops around the party. Silky’s aerios folds in on itself before launching skyward for safety. A woman’s voice calls from the other side of the trees. “Forgiveness asked!” she exclaims hurriedly. “I shot first without questioning what I saw. If you’ve come looking for my clan, I’m not sure that I—” before she can finish, another voice, similar to the distorted tihfur that led you this way, pierces the thicket.

“COMING TO HELP. I CAN’T SEE YOU!”

In the center of the clearing stands a lone tihfur woman, doing her best to contend with a stampede of aggressive beasts trying to slip past her volley of arrows. She clearly needs help. Not wasting any more time, Mo and Makaal work to pull a copse of saplings apart for the rest of you to dive through.

Setup



Take 1/6 ▶ Go to 7 ▶ Go to 7.

Tiles: 6x Bursting Bells

Victory Condition



Survive for seven rounds.

Round limit: 7 ⌚

Loss Conditions



Lose if Zeepurah is slain.

Challenges



- 1 Zeepurah is injured and can not move during this encounter.
- 2 Nahoot's will always attack Zeepurah if she is within range of their attacks.
- 3 Terranape's always gain the benefit of their hit point threshold augments.

Special Rules



Consuming Corruption

There are six ether dice icons next to spaces on the edges of the map. These icons represent possible spawn locations throughout the encounter.

When an adversary is slain, place it off to the side of the map on its side. During the **Start Phase**, for each adversary that is both off to the side and flipped vertically, roll an ether dice from the general pool, then spawn that adversary at the space with the icon corresponding to the icon that was just rolled. Then, for each adversary that is both off to the side and placed on its side, flip them vertically.



Champion of the Yanshif

Zeepurah is a character ally to Rovers. For this encounter Zeepurah will only use the “Left of the Yenshuv” side and will not flip.

Thinning the Ranks

Keep track of the number of Nahoot slain during this encounter.

Terrain



Non-flying units that enter a thick bramble space suffer 1.



Units that trigger Bursting Bell traps suffer 2.



Units within 1 of this object gain +1 .

Codex Links



The first time a Nahoot is slain, read “Creeping Darkness” 13.



At the end of round 7, read “Unnatural Stillness” 14.

Swallowed by the Night

Introduction

Some hours after a Yanshif ascension ritual—

The Dominant looked down at the pair perched at the bottom of the nest-home. The girl, clever, but reserved; the boy, brash, but passionate. Fresh from their third patterning—Morph still potent in the runes inscribed through their skin and feathers. He made sure his bloodied arm was out of sight from the girl, busy at work preening every inch of her. She was thoroughly recounting the week's hunts to the boy and planning for the upcoming winter. The Dominant was pleased, for they would be excellent leaders to the clan. It had been some time since the Yanshif flew with two Dominant. A scroll was collected and carried down to the pair. Both rose to attention as the Dominant approached and unfurled the scroll.

Between sprawls of text written in the language of kin are images of a skilled tihfur that easily overcomes their every challenge. But with each victory the tihfur grows darker and more misshapen. "What you see transcribed is no mere legend, but a warning. The Ahma is a very real threat to all kin. When kin put their essence at risk to protect a home, the natural Morphic energies within us resonate with that desire, empowering our bodies, our Haya—everything. But our bodies are not suitable conduits for such uncontrolled powers. Over time it can corrupt us if we allow it. To become Ahma is to lose sight of who, and what, you are. Once you are Ahma there is no longer tihfur. Morph has taken over completely. It consumes the body and Haya both as its own vessel for its whims. The very place you sought to protect will eventually become a graveyard for you and everyone you once loved."

The Dominant could only hope they both would remember these lessons.

As your group follows after Zeepurah the faint rays of light reaching the forest floor gradually become more obscured by a variety of structures built in and around the trees. It would make sense that a clan of avian-shifters makes their homes primarily in the treetops. Occasionally a frightened tihfur can be seen peeking out from their home down towards your party. Howls echo through the trees—peppered with the sounds of splintering and crashing wood.

Zeepurah grimaces as she flexes a transformed talon where a hand once was. Creaking and snapping emit from inside of her body as she calls upon her Morphic power. "No more forgiveness. He thinks he can steal our families from their nests? Destroy our home? I will suffer this no longer! Rovers, I ask your assistance in tending to the remainder of my flock."



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Setup



Take 1/6 ▶ Go to 8 ▶ Go to 8.

Tiles: 1x Hoard

Victory Condition



Slay the Zaghan Nahadir.

Round limit: 8

Loss Conditions



Lose if Zeepurah is slain.

Challenges



- 1 All skills that generate generate instead.
- 2 Dark Conversion spawns nahoot at the start of rounds 2, 4, and 6 instead.
- 3 All spawned nahoot must be slain before reading “Taken a Toll”.

Special Rules



Dark Conversation

The Zagan Nahadir is transforming the Yanshif into monsters. During the **Start Phase** of rounds 3 and 6, spawn one nahoot in the space at the bottom right corner marked with a icon.

Champion of the Yanshif

Zeepurah is a character ally to Rovers. At the start of the Rover Phase, if Zeepurah is within 1-3 of any nahoot or Zaghan Nahadir, flip her ally card over to its “Eyes in the Dark” side, otherwise flip her ally card over to its “Left of Yanshif” side.

Terrain



Units within 1 of this object gain +1 .

Codex Links



20

If a Rover enters into the space with the hoard tile, remove the tile and read “Knock on Wood”, 14.

21

At the end of Round 2, read “Into the Tainted Air”, 15.

22

Immediately when the Zaghan Nahadir is slain, read “Taken a Toll”, 15.

The River of Black Bile Flows

Introduction

Zeepurah recalls an evening spent with her mate after inheriting leadership of the Yanshif—

Hasayon held up the two massive and limp corpses of the streak—a quaint name granted to the spindly avian pests—and flashed me his most feral grin. I humored him with a laugh and marked our patrol in the trunk. It was one of those small necessities he was prone to forgetting. So consumed with the hunt as to lose sight of why we stalked these parts of the Taharik. No matter. I would soon train him so thoroughly that even if his mind forgot, his body would not. Our new flight as the Dominant of the Yanshif would burden us with this and more with each passing day.

“My love, are you so excited for dinner, or does your tail wave for me?” I teased him.

“The first verse always begins with you, no matter how solemn or jubilant my songs are to be. I cannot deny a thrill to finally having plucked the gristle from our coats. Too long have these lovebirds been pretending to lay claim to our roost.” He twisted his head slightly, his Hayin dilating as I entered his view. I couldn’t contain the shudder that prickled at my feathers; so rare was it that a hunter and his Haya aligned so perfectly as within Hasayon. Shame that they each shared the same numb skull.

“Do you not feel we are much the same as they?” I asked, motioning to the dead avians held in each of his hands.

“They suffered to mistake our lands for their own and thought to extract blood tithe from the children they attacked! My regret, as it so often is, was not listening to your instincts over my own to determine where they nested. Forgiveness asked, my muse,” he muttered.

The night was oozing through the pale dusk and would soon plunge the marsh into complete darkness. Mo’s azure fluorescence and Zeepurah’s pulsing tattoos are all that keep the gloom at bay. Makaal

and Grandpaw had tracked ahead just far enough to confirm the gurgling stream could be heard before returning to the safety of the group. It was this stream that Zeepurah said had to be crossed to find the roost of the Nah.

Makaal broke the silence. “I’ve never seen anything like what’s happening here—and that’s coming from somebody who has traded blows with Star Hunters. Zeepurah, just what is all of this?” he asked while nervously rubbing one of Mo’s tendrils that had drifted up toward him.

“How much do you know about kin, trader? Not just the clans, but what lies in our very hearts? The stories held within our bodies?” Zeepurah asks.

Makaal traces a finger across the ink along his neck as he ponders her question. “Not enough, though that is hardly an answer worth a scale. I would offer that I’ve only seen the good, I think,” he replies.

Zeepurah whips a talon out, signaling for silence and stillness. “Hold, Rovers. Something feels—” before she can finish, the forest is plunged into chaos as a ground-shaking roar erupts from everywhere at once. An entire copse of trees suddenly lifts itself from the ground, shaking loose a number of kifa, nektari, and other denizens that were hiding inside. Then it turns to face you—two giant eyes illuminating the mottled bark around its face. Rivulets of sticky ichor run from its muzzle down its chin.

Zeepurah curses loudly and identifies the creature as one her clan refers to as Hokmala. A rather ancient, and normally docile, grovetender that has now fallen under the same thrall that captured the Nah. The stream that divides the forest from their marsh can be heard nearby. Hokmala’s sole intent appears to be barring the way.

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Setup



Take 1/6 ▶ Go to 9 ▶ Go to 10-11.

Tiles: 2x Nektari Hives

Victory Condition



Slay Hokmala.

Round limit: 8 ⌚

Loss Conditions



Lose if Zeepurah is slain.

Challenges



- 1 Dekahas gain +2 .
- 2 Zeepurah flips to “Eyes of the Dark” when within 1-3 of Hokmala.
- 3 Replace Hokmala’s trait with: After each turn where this unit suffers damage: Spawn R-1 galeapers in empty spaces within 1 of it.

Special Rules



Champion of the Yanshif

Zeepurah is a character ally to Rovers. She starts on the “Left of the Yanshif” side. At the start of the Rover Phase, if Zeepurah is within 1-3 of a node, flip her ally card over to its “Eyes in the Dark” side, otherwise flip her ally card over to its “Left of Yanshif” side.

Terrain



Non-flying units that enter a polluted pool space suffer 1.



Nektari Hives are special objects and have Rx2 .



An incredibly deadly river of poisonous sludge runs through the map. Poisoned water spaces have a white border and follow all the rules of open air spaces.



It costs units 1 additional movement point to enter a space within 1 of this object.



Units within 1 of this object gain -1 to the first attack they perform during their turn.

Codex Links



23

The first time a Terranape is slain, read “Marsh Mallow”, 16.

24

Each time a Nektari Hive is destroyed, read “Not-So-Sweet Nectar”, 16.

25

Immediately when Hokmala is slain, read “Midst of Black Waters”, 16.

There is Always a Bigger Beast

Introduction

Moonlight pours into the pallid grove, revealing shades of sickly browns and revolting purples; all with a cloying blanket of grimy Morphic scum. Grandpaw had refused to draw near the ichor stream you all crossed, much less travel across the bridge that was once Hokmala, and so Mo and Makaal stayed behind, hoping to stop any of the Nah from stalking back into the evacuated village.

As if presenting its tapestry for the world to see, a monstrous avian sits in the center of the grove with one pair of its myriad wings spread wide. Its reverie is quickly extinguished as your group approaches. A pale skull with three eyes full of rancor, woe, and death gaze across each of you before finally falling on Zeepurah. The skull spins in place, clattering and wobbling with uncertainty. Top down, bottom up, side to side; no perspective brings it satisfaction. Finally it lets its beak fall open.

“WHY?”

“Hasayon, my love... This should have never happened.” Zeepurah reaches out towards the monster with one wavering hand.

“WE SAVE THEM,
LIKE YOU SAVED ME,
WE ARE BUT CHILDREN,
WE CAN STILL SING,
TOGETHER.”

“This is oblivion, Hasayon! Do you not see the decay? The sickness? There is no balance, no order! Unbridled is your requiem!” Showers of feathers are cast with each frantic motion of her body—each one thin and frayed.

“DO YOU NOT ENJOY MY SONG,
FORGIVE ME MY MUSE,
I DO NOT KNOW OTHER NOTES,
TEACH ME.”

The Ahma—Hasayon—opens his beak wider and begins to moan. It is an otherworldly tone that vibrates through your entire being. While distressing, it seems to have affected Zeepurah much worse, her talons are clutched to her head and she trembles violently. After a few moments she rears back, shrieking up at the night sky. Hasayon echoes her despair with the same fervor. The air stales. The ground churns. The forest weeps. The entire world seems to grow black at the edges.

Then it all stops as Hasayon’s song is interrupted with an expulsion of Morphic sludge from his visage. It pours from his eyes, his beak, his neck. Zeepurah regains a measure of composure and shakily draws her bow.

“TOO SOON.”



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Setup



Take 1/6 ▶ Go to 10 ▶ Go to 12-13.

Tiles: 6x Bursting Bells, 4x Nektari Hives

Victory Condition



Slay the Ahma.

Round limit: 6

Loss Conditions



Lose if Zeepurah is slain.

Challenges



- 1 The Ahma gains +2 movement points to all of their movement actions.
- 2 Add R dice to the map, evenly distributed amongst ether nodes. Rover movement actions can not remove more than one dice from an ether node per action.
- 3 When the Ahma Corrupter is defeated, Zeepurah is injured. Return her to the nearest space. Zeepurah can no longer perform or actions.

Special Rules



Deep-rooted Corruption

The Ahma is drinking the pollution of the swamp and gaining power. You do not know what will happen when the Ahma consumes the pollution, but it is probably best to prevent it.

The Ahma uses their Ahma Corrupter statistic block.

The Corrupted Nektari Hives are guarding the nodes. Rovers can not take the dice from nodes that have a Corrupted Nektari Hive within 1. Try to grab all dice before defeating the Ahma.

Champion of the Yanshif

Zeepurah is a character ally to Rovers. At the start of the Rover Phase, if Zeepurah is within 3 of any Nahoot, Nahadir, or Ahma enemy, or if Zeepurah is within 3 of a node, flip her ally card over to its “Eyes in the Dark” side, otherwise flip her ally card over to its “Left of Yenshuv” side.

Terrain



Non-flying units that enter a polluted pool space suffer 1.



Units that trigger Bursting Bell traps suffer 2.



Corrupted Nektari Hives are special objects and have R .



Units within 1 of this object gain -1 to the first attack they perform during their turn.

Codex Links



26

Each time a Corrupted Nektari Hive is destroyed, read “Just Desserts”, 17.

27

Immediately after the turn where the Ahma Corrupter is defeated, read “Taste of Morphic Paradise”, 17.

Quest 2

A Message From the Empress

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Introduction

Transcribed musings from “Silky,” resident Fundamentalist of the Mist clan.

Keb Rasska... Such a complete complement of contradictory and confounding combinations, as usually suggested considering their stories... Ah, forgive me if that was difficult to follow. You see, keb rasska often adopt quite the interesting manner of speech—when they do bother to speak verbally—and I couldn’t help but emulate it while thinking about them. Something to do with their physical makeup? Not a pair of lips between any pair of ilk! You’ll find they rely upon a number of different ways to convey information between themselves and others, from onerous orations to gushing gestures to mental missives! Despite the quirks to their communications many would still give any disciple of the Mouth a skip from their spear. Quite shrewd negotiators—after all, more minds manifest more mischief!

The booming footfalls of “Grandpaw”—the massive arkenyn bonded to Makaal that everyone has managed to settle atop of—reverberate loudly through the valley. Before long, Silky’s aerios descends from its flight to Grandpaw’s head, drawing a chuff of minor complaint from the animal. The gleaming avian turns to face the mounted party and takes the opportunity to begin a discussion regarding the strategy for approaching the army further along. Mo, whose extra limbs developed from their clan once living with a population of keb rasska, is familiar enough with their methods of communication and offers to facilitate a meeting.

With the scorching heat of the sun now bearing down from directly overhead, Grandpaw lets out a low half-bark and slows his gallop. As fortune would have it the marching army hasn’t gained much ground from Uzem’s Throne and has only just begun their hike up the steeper inclines that surround the mountain range. Suddenly, Makaal clicks his tongue in irritation. Members of the army’s rearguard have noticed Grandpaw and your entourage.

A wave of rapid movement rolls through the antennae and fins of the sentries; signals and warnings

communicated in near-silence. “Seems that is the cue,” Mo says before leaping to their full height on the back of Grandpaw. Arms and the front pair of their legs lift up in a series of non-verbal signals to the sentries. A good number immediately relax at the communicated intent, though Mo doesn’t share the specifics of the message. One of the keb rasska begins to hike back down to meet with your group. She appears to be a flagbearer of some sort, and passes her charge to another before they separate from their position completely. On the army’s banner is an unfamiliar emblem; an iridescent geometric pattern that at a distance seems to resemble a crystal serpent? The rasska is upon you before anyone thinks to question Silky about the iconography, her fins fluttering with the speed of her movement. Unnoticed until getting this close, her smaller keb partner clambers on to her shoulders and begins motioning toward your party. Each of you disembarks from Grandpaw and performs the standard greeting-salute of a Rover, with Mo and Makaal motioning by tipping their heads and turning up outstretched palms.

Campaign Link



Go to “Rolling to the Top”  28.

Rolling to the Top

Introduction

“Salutations, Rovers,” the girl calls, tinged with the common rasp of a rasska. Her keb companion emits a few quiet clicks but is waved off. “This arkenyn—”

“Grandpaw, stout and stalwart ally!” Makaal interjects, receiving a light tap from one of Mo’s tendrils on his cheek. Grandpaw snorts into the dirt. The rasska girl clicks her teeth together—whether in irritation or just an attempt to grasp the syllables is uncertain. She turns to Mo and begins to pantomime a series of questions with her four arms. As the pair communicate in the signed keb rasska language, Mo verbally relays the topic of each question. The army had apparently taken note of your group outside of Uzem’s Throne and were concerned about banditry. Silky lets out a sound approximating a scoff.

Mo continues to wave their limbs side to side and slowly draws their tendrils upward and closer together on their head. “Currently explaining the events that brought Makaal and myself to Uzem’s Throne, and the following intervention by Silky and his Rovers,” they report. During their explanation, Mo’s tendrils have slowly coiled and curved around themselves to fashion a set of elaborate and undulating antennae, like one might see on an older keb, to assist with the unspoken language. The smaller keb seems enraptured by the process.

After the signing from Mo, the rasska girl begins to scratch her face in thought. She turns to the keb and they begin a rapid exchange of clicks and hisses, seemingly judging Mo’s story and intent. Finally, they come to a decision and nod at each of you. “Saras, Kelo” she croaks, motioning to herself and then her keb partner. Mo motions similarly to themselves and each of your entourage, listing your group’s names and titles. Saras’ face contorts in confusion as Mo employs a longer series of motions and signs to describe the aerios Silky controls.

“Exceptional as I seem, I promise there isn’t a deception being spun!” Silky chirps, causing both Kelo and Saras to startle, but the exclamation seems to placate their questioning gazes. Mo and the keb rasska pair resume their silent discussion. With each passing second the movements grow swifter until Mo suddenly claps and bows to the pair and ends the exchange.

“Mo, Makaal... Grandpaw, please stay with the dorsal segment of the clan. Rovers, come with us as we counsel with the queens,” Saras croaks. As you follow behind the keb rasska, Kelo repositions atop Saras to allow for an unobstructed view of Mo. Makaal chuckles quietly.

The keb rasska pair at the head of the army are the queens of the clan. Saras insists you all wait as she confers with them, which involves a fair amount of silent gesturing and hissed commands. Eventually, the large rasska woman clad in violet crystal armor waves two of her arms out towards the mountain path dismissively. Kelo motions for each of you to rejoin the hike beyond the army, passing under the oppressive glares of the queens.

After hiking ahead to a flat part of the mountain pass Kelo and Saras turn back to you. “We must puncture the mountainside somewhere forward. The queens insist that Rovers... Clear the path. Prove value,” they said.”

Kelo pops up from behind Saras. “Exercise caution! Is quite the fall if there is a slip.” he adds, as if the leering cliffs weren’t warning enough.

Setup



Take 2/5 ▶ Go to 11 ▶ Go to 14.

Victory Condition



Slay the Gruv.

Round limit: 8 ⌚

Challenges



- 1 Before a Zinix is slain, all of their allies within 1 of them recover 1.
- 2 The Gruv's ability tokens starts on their "Power Dive" ability.
- 3 Kifa gain +1 movement point to all of their movement actions.

Terrain



Units that end their turn within 1 of this object recover 1.

Codex Links



30

The first time a Zinix is slain, read "The Bush is the Obstacle", 19.

31

Immediately when the gruv is slain, read "Dust Endures no Restraint", 19.

Quest 2 • Encounter 2

A Visit to a Mine

Introduction

Transcribed excerpt from a presentation by “Silky”, resident Fundamentalist of the Mist clan.

While we zusag may prefer the paths less traveled, it is the paths most traveled upon which keb rasska built themselves. You see, they were not always keb rasska, but once upon a time, keb and rasska. Keb were small and delicious-looking creatures, much like us, that caught the attention of every hungry predator in the area. Rasska, however, were neither small nor looked like much of anything, what with their spectral and glass-like skin. It was certainly a momentous day in those ancient times when the first keb—so afraid of everything around it and only able to keep to the paths its ilk had drawn before it—was attacked by a predator and then rescued by a rasska that had hidden somewhere along that very same path. So began the very long and very prosperous journey of the keb rasska—the respected path-builders of the current age.

Too proud of their own crystalline and chitin armaments as they were, the queens were more than happy to allow Mo and Makaal the opportunity to work with the mundane scales of the defeated gruv. Marii, impressed with your performance in clearing the mountain passage, now seems very interested in spending more time getting to know your party. Kelo and Saras aren't far away either, having apparently received some accolades for gathering Rovers in service to the clan. The keb queen—Femii, apparently bonded to Marii—remains rather dispassionate, but Marii explains that is nothing unusual for her.

Marii's gaze bares down on each of you as she makes her proposal; apparently the march through and up the mountains has taken a significant toll on her army, and she desires the strength of Rovers to act as the vanguard through the unexplored depths of the caverns. “The clan still needs rest. I wish each of the soldiers could call such strength their own, though this wish is less than reasonable—they can't call themselves Rovers as you can.” Despite her stern expression her words sound

honest enough. It's surprising enough that a keb rasska speaks their desires so plainly given the difficulty of common speech for them. The few dozen keb rasska that are part of the armed complement of the clan army are clearly exhausted. Bruised flesh, drooping antennae, chipped shells, and many leaning on their weapons for support just to stand. The clan's journey has not been as easy as perhaps hoped.

Marii separates to tend to her retinue and you return to Mo and Makaal to make preparations for traversing the depths of the caves. Kelo and Saras intercept and follow behind you, apparently with orders to accompany you as something of a guide through the subterrain. Once you finally return to Mo and Makaal, they wave you over with a fresh set of armor fashioned from the Gruv and a handful of small, glowing lanterns. Mo affixes them to each of you as Makaal speaks. “These should mostly help down there, though chances are these'll probably draw some attention from the locals. Take care down there, Rovers!”

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Setup



Take 2/5 ▶ Go to 12 ▶ Go to 15.

Tiles: 5x Crumbling Column, 3x Hoard

Victory Condition



All Rovers and Kelo & Saras end the round within 1 of the Crystal .

Round limit: 8

Loss Conditions



Lose if Kelo and Saras are slain.

Challenges



- 1 Set the Round Limit to 6.
- 2 All adversaries within The Deep Caves add 1 to all of their attacks.
- 3 Onisski always benefit from their action augments as if they were adjacent to a mushroom space.

Special Rules



The Deep Caves

The spaces outlined in white are the deep caves. During the encounter set up, place these adversaries in their spaces as normal, but they are not active when the encounter starts. This means they do not perform abilities during the adversary phase. These adversaries activate after the first time any unit a part of the Rover faction enters a space within the white border. Once these adversaries are active, they act normally during the Adversary phase

Queens' Defectors

Kelo & Saras are character allies to Rovers. They start on either the "Kelo" side or the "Saras" side. At the start of the Rover phase, flip Kelo & Saras over to their other side.

Terrain



Units that trigger Crumbling Column traps suffer 2.



Units that end their turn within 1 of this object recover 1.

Codex Links



32

If a Rover enters into a space with a hoard tile, remove the tile and read "Crystalline Depression", 19.

33

The first time an onisski is slain, read "Such a Fuss", 20.

34

When all Rovers and Kelo & Saras end the round adjacent to the Crystal , read "The Crystal and its Story", 20.

Description of a Struggle

Introduction

Kelo recalls a day after another conquest by the Ezmen Queens—

Kelo dug a claw under a loosening bit of his chitin, letting out an awkward hiss. “Shouldn’t pick.” Saras admonished. “Growth occurs as the mite matures. Dangerous if they’re removed so soon. They’ll come off eventually, Kelo.” Kelo shuddered and waved an arm dismissively, then emitted an irritated buzzing. “Something troubles?” Saras asked. Kelo tapped a digit against the ezmenite blade that was given to him by the clan’s queens.

APPROVAL OBLIGATION BURDEN

“Recall this investment as the future draws closer.”

The disturbingly pale queen—Femii, he later learned—had said those things during his and his sister’s coming of age celebration. The words had pressed against his mind as she motionlessly, unblinkingly, bore witness to the granting of the siblings’ rank in the clan’s army, alongside the rather brutish Marii. Kelo wondered how many other members of the clan had received these sorts of insidious missives during their conscriptions.

Saras and Kelo had gone back to usher Mo and Makaal back through the tunnels in secret. Poor Grandpaw could barely fit through even with his body pressed in on itself. The gleam of Silky’s aerios was muted along with the other glittering materials tucked away under a conspicuous bit of cloth in the arkenyn’s baggage. Returning to the crystal formation with the merchants in tow, the keb rasska pair finally began to explain what the army had made a cross-continent march to these mountains for. Hidden within the depths of Lalos are a species of entoman whose carapace is more powerful than any metal. The queens named their clan after this material referred to as “ezmen.” Ezmen comprises the armor, weapons, and other finer equipment that the queens and their army wield. The creatures responsible for the rise of the Ezmen clan are named skara; another keb rasska affectation that alluded to the mandibles

spanning the length of their massive bodies.

While some colonies of skara are isolated, others, however, have seen clans build themselves around the tunnels and formations the entomans left behind. The Ezmen queens did not care what the circumstances were, for the hunt of these hidden creatures was the entire genesis of their army. The clan simply crushed any who did not join the queens’ grand pursuit.

The crystal formation here is not just an ether-infused swathe of rock, Saras and Kelo explain. It is an egg of an unborn skara that is waiting for others of its kind to free it to begin its own tunneling endeavors. This is what their clan has been marched across the continent to find and capture, with that purpose literally pressed into their bodies by keb thoughtweavers.

Guilt is the motivation for the siblings now. Guilt over their contributions to the enslavement and destruction of clans across Lalos, guilt over the indulged pleasures of being ranking soldiers. The appearance of Rovers provides a chance for redemption. Kelo and Saras present a plan to secret away the juvenile skara somewhere safe, and after some discussion, a solid approach takes shape. Unfortunately a camp of the clan’s sentinels stands between your group and the passages the siblings intend to escape through.

The soldiers must be scattered before any further steps are taken. As it happens, Mo and Makaal know quite a bit about creating distractions and escaping under the press of chaos.

Setup



Take 2/5 ▶ Go to 13 ▶ Go to 16.

Tiles: 1x Treasure Chest, 4x Hoard

Victory Condition



Place R bomb satchels onto the Ashemak seed pod pile.

Round limit: 8 ⌚

Loss Conditions



Lose if Kelo & Saras are slain.

Challenges



- 1 Rovers that are carrying a bomb satchel reduce all of their movement actions by 1.
- 2 At the end of round 4, spawn R seks in spaces closest to the Rovers.
- 3 The Zisafi Principle gains +1 to all of their attacks.

Special Rules



Queens' Defectors

Kelo & Saras are character allies to Rovers. They start on either the "Kelo" side or the "Saras" side. At the start of each round, flip Kelo & Saras over to their other side.

Terrain



Units that enter or end their turn in fire suffers 1. Wrathbone ignores this effect.



Units that end their turn within 1 of this object suffer 1.



Hoard tiles are bomb satchels. A Rover that enters a hex with a hoard tile picks up that tile. To indicate this, place the hoard tile on your class board. Rovers may carry only one bomb satchel.



The Ashemak seed pod pile is in space . Rovers that end their turn adjacent to the ashemak seed pod pile may place a bomb satchel on it. To do this, move the hoard tile from your class board onto the seed pod pile.



The treasure chest is locked and requires a key to open.

Codex Links



35

The first time a wrathbone is slain, read "It Must Catch Fire", 20.

36

If the Zisafi Principle is slain, read "Agreement is the Best Weapon", 20.

38

Immediately when R bomb satchels have been placed onto the ashemak seed pod pile, read "Hot and Dreadful", 21.

The Burrow

Introduction

A memory from Ezmen Queen Femii—

Worthless. Each and all. From the day she first hatched, Femii had sensed just how pitiful everybody surrounding her was. She, too, was weak, but only in body. Her chitin was soft and colorless, forever marking her as an aberration. No matter. Her mind was exceedingly powerful; the power of Morph allowing her to twist others to her will with a mere thought.

Marii had worked tirelessly to become the strongest in their birthclan. Years spent in constant training just to protect her “beloved” sister from those that feared and ostracized her. Femii could see Marii’s thoughts so clearly, as if looking through glass. Even Marii carried the weight of resentment. Buried so deep that perhaps Marii herself wasn’t even aware of them, but it was there all the same. Fine. Marii was useful, like any beast of burden, and Femii would keep her until she found something better. Something stronger.

Ezmenite was merely another tool. The skara were key. Femii would unlock their secrets.

Stress seems to be weighing heavily on Kelo and Saras. The map was marked with a passage that lies directly on the other side of the skara’s egg and is where they directed the group. With a look of trepidation, the siblings begin to repeatedly clash together their ezmenite equipment, generating a resonant chiming that echoes near-endlessly throughout the tunnels. As the echoing peals of the ezmenite reaches a head-splitting volume, the walls around you begin to quake. Grandpaw whips around to face a part of the cave and rumbles with a deep growl.

With a piercing crack that quells all other noise, a giant spear of ezmenite suddenly breaks through the wall the arkenyn growled at. Everyone pulls back as more spears of ezmenite puncture the wall. With one last burst of effort the wall collapses entirely and a hulking creature shrouded in the violet crystals drives its way through the debris. A skara, freshly hatched from its egg. You now realize that this is the same creature that the Ezmen clan bears on its emblems. It clatters over to Kelo and brushes its antennae against the keb’s chitin and ezmenite blade. He seems to relax slightly as he runs a claw against the creature’s razor-sharp legs. Saras brushes dust from herself and grins at the rest of you. All according to plan.

For the next stage of the plan, the skara will need to be led through the caverns to a place that the siblings believe will give it the opportunity to escape from the clan’s clutches. Doubtless the earlier distraction has run its course and the recalled soldiers will be ready to interfere with the effort. Fortunately the creature is hardy and seems keen to obey Kelo’s desires—leading it through the winding passages should be simple enough.

Setup



Take 2/5 ▶ Go to 14 ▶ Go to 18-19.

Tiles: 4x Crumbling Column

Victory Condition



Escort the skara grub to the space.

Round limit: 8

Loss Conditions



Lose if Kelo & Saras or the skara grub are slain.

Challenges



- 1 When performing the Hurry up! ability, the skara grub performs 2 instead.
- 2 Zisafis will always attack the skara grub if the grub is within range of their attacks.
- 3 The Sek Principle loses their trait and gains +1 .

Special Rules



Queens' Defectors

Kelo & Saras are character allies to Rovers. They start on either the "Kelo" side or the "Saras" side. At the start of each round, flip Kelo & Saras over to their other side.

Somewhere, There is a Worm

The skara grub is a character ally to Rovers, has 6 , 1, and is immune to forced movement. At the end of the round, the skara grub performs 3, controlled by a consensus from among the players.



Once each round, one Rover may perform the following ability:

Hurry up!: The skara grub performs 3, with you controlling the action.

Note: Hurry up! is an ability and requires an ability activation to use.

Terrain



Units that trigger crumbling column traps suffer 2.



Units that end their turn within 1 of this object suffer 1.

Codex Links



39

The first time an ashmak is slain, read "Ready to Release", 22.

40

Each time an urn is slain, read "Absorption Without Assimilation", 22.

41

When the skara grub ends the round occupying the exit space , read "Truth Cannot Know Itself" 22.

Kenyn and Keb

Introduction

EXCITEMENT NOSTALGIA CRAVING

DISGUST BOREDOM SADNESS

AMUSEMENT SATISFACTION ANGER

CONFUSION ADMIRATION ANXIETY

INTEREST SURPRISE CALM

fear

Your heads ache as Femii's mental assault collides against you in waves of conflicting impressions, but she continues to underestimate your fortitude as Rovers. Eventually the attack abates with the last of her psychic tendrils failing to find purchase in your minds.

After enduring Femii's onslaught through the skara's tunnel, you all spill out into a huge chamber. Ezmenite gleams from every wall within the hollow. Large, shattered formations speak to the emergence of skara hatchlings in the past. Great spikes of the material still lay scattered throughout. Only one hatchling is here now; the one you followed here rests against the back wall. Already it has grown larger and more vibrant. A pool of dark liquid peppered with floating gruv scales ripples underneath its mass.

Seated atop the skara is Femii, exuding her aura of dominion. Marii stands before her with weapons already drawn. "This was a great mistake, Rovers," she snarls. "Standing against sister's ambitions..."

Silence, Marii. Your teeth-gnashing is unnecessary and pitiful. The mite and skink performed... acceptably. They were useful. After all of these years, we finally secured my prize. You, and the ilk beneath you, see these creatures we pursue as just the source of ezmenite—a means to raise yourselves—but they are so much more.

Femii's condemnation lashes against each of you but no longer bears any real impact. Marii, however, spasms as her sister's psychic outburst sinks into her. A shrill noise emits from the skara—Femii's many claws raking deeply against its carapace in unison.

Skara hold the key to enhancing my powers beyond comprehension. It is a shame the clan could not fend off the Rovers for even a brief duration. The wonders I could exact now that I've finally captured this hatchling... Who are you to stand before me, Rovers? How dare you. You, who finally deign to set foot in my presence. You, who would belittle the years of effort I've spent. You, with your heads so buried in your masochistic idealism, futilely screeching into the abyss that is the will of Chorus. How dare you HOW DARE YOU?

I will bring it all to heel. Every last step of this journey has been endless, desultory resistance. STOP FIGHTING! I will bring peace. STOP FIGHTING! Every mindless beast, every pathetic clan. STOP FIGHTING! I will bring serenity to the whole of Chorus. STOP FIGHTING! The aberrant, the infirm, the deviant—all will be equal under my sovereignty. Free yourselves from the burden of struggle. I sympathize with your trials, Rovers. Go. Leave us. LEAVE. Give me these last few days to nurture the skara to its apex. I can erase the weight of your, of everyone's, responsibilities.

Femii levels her gaze at each of you, psychically probing for any signs of compromise, slowly amplifying her powers through the skara's body. She clicks her mandibles together in frustration.

Marii, your life has not been easy beside me. Kill them, so that we—so that you—may finally live easy. KILL THEM KILL THEM KILL THEM!

Setup



Take 2/5 ▶ Go to 15 ▶ Go to 20-23.

Tiles: 8x Hoard

Victory Condition



Slay Marii and Femii.

Round limit: 6 ⌚

Challenges

- 1 The lowest crystalline spears can reduce Marii or Femii's is to 1.
- 2 When rolling the adversary dice to advance a boss ability token, if the token is not on ability 4, move the token to ability 4 instead.
- 3 You start the encounter with 0 ether dice in your personal pool.

Special Rules



Crystalline Armor

Marii and Femii are well armored in resplendent crystalline armor and are nearly unassailable.

They have R-X, where X equals the number of crystalline spears (hoard tiles) on their statistic block. Use crystalline spears to weaken their defense.

Crystalline Spears

Each time a Rover attacks Marii or Femii, you may empower that attack with a crystalline spear (hoard tile). When attacking Marii or Femii, a Rover may move one crystalline spear from their class board to their target's statistic block to gain +1 to that attack.



On Advance

Adversaries in this encounter use the On Advance mechanic, which is found on page 47 of the rulebook.

Terrain



Non-flying units that enter jagged crystals suffer 2.



Hoard tiles are crystal spears. A Rover that enters a space with a hoard tile picks up that tile. To indicate this, place the hoard tile on your class board.



There are several spaces marked , , , , and . Ignore these encounter aid markers for now. As the encounter progresses, these aid markers will be referenced when it becomes relevant.

Codex Links



Immediately after the turn where Marii is slain first, read “**Usurpation**”, 24.



Immediately after the turn where Femii is slain first, read “**Desperation**”, 25.

Chapter 2

A Choice

Makaal looks toward the party he found himself bound to—at least for the time being. Was this how Mo felt in the past when they first left their clan to journey with him? It hadn't seemed strange to Makaal then. He was used to the occasional traveling partner—or even a Rover escorting him between settlements—but was it any different with the realization that you would be spending more than just a few days on the same path? Traveling with a host of Rovers was already a grand departure from the norm. Working to equip them against the unknowable dangers of the world wasn't something Makaal was sure he was qualified to handle.

Twice now, it felt like they were battling the continent itself rather than just the simple beasts roaming Lalos. He looked up and tried to find the characteristic glittering in the sky of Silky's flying conjuration. Makaal would wager every lyst he had ever seen that his cheery long-horn sage persona was just an act. The elderly zusag clearly knew more about what was happening—how else do you assemble more than one Rover in a single place at once?

He sighed and gave up looking. The supposed history of zusag told that their rise to civility was entirely due to their uncanny ability to hide away. Though, Silky had a preternatural ability to pop up right next to you when you genuinely had something to ask, so it didn't matter much. Makaal looked over at Mo instead, the starling's full attention set on creating new equipment for the Rovers.

Partnering with the Rovers had been the calling he knew Mo needed. It had been ages since he last saw them so engaged. Without the need to work on supplies for an entire clan, they had been languishing. It made him feel guilty to strip them of purpose, but it was at their insistence that they travel together in the hopes of spreading their... limbs? Tendrils? However a starling best flourishes.

And flourish Mo had! Makaal considered himself as inept at martialism as he was adept at mercantilism, but even he felt he might be able to stand next to a clan guard with the stunning equipment the starling was crafting...

maybe. Best not to try; after all, Mo had a vague grasp of the inherent value of things. Fortunes and pittances would be exchanged for entirely the wrong reasons without him to keep it all in check.

A flapping noise pulls Makaal's attention back to Grandpaw, where the glittering aerios had materialized. Think of the beast and he will come, it seems. "I've completed my scouting and it would seem we have two peaks that lie before us, my troupe!" he chirped. "The storms surrounding Uzem's Throne have only grown in intensity, which warrants a second incursion on our part. Perhaps whatever force that was agitating the addax will have revealed itself." Makaal scoffed, less excited to rush back into the headwinds that had left Mo and him stranded and in need of rescue by Silky and his Rovers in the first place.

"Alternatively, I do believe these trials have served as a potent enough crucible to temper you for a journey unto the Unsouled Barrens. One way or another we'll need to pay it a visit to discover the reason for its recent... expansion." Mo and Makaal both turned their heads in shock at the avatar; its expression forever implacable. Braving the storms wrought by Uzem sounded like a picnic in a sunlit meadow compared to having to set eyes on that forsaken place.

Mo lifted a claw up to the starling core they kept wrapped in their tendrils, soothing themselves by rubbing against it gently. "Is that the correct choice, Silky?" they asked. Makaal agreed with their hesitation. The biggest clan settlement in Lalos, turned into a savage and deadly stretch of flesh and bone almost overnight. It had been decades, but even now the creatures that spill from the Barrens cause trouble for anybody near the center of the continent.

The aerios shrugged (as best as it could with a pair of wings and incomplete body). "I believe the tribulations that lie ahead are equally treacherous regardless of the path we take. This would be the first time a group of Rovers are tested against the Unsouled Barrens and I

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find myself very interested in the results.” Silky replied. Makaal wasn’t sure he agreed, but he didn’t feel confident questioning the sage any further. The Rovers had certainly proved their capability to him, if nothing else.

You have been left with two choices: The Storms Above or The Monsters Below. Chorus is filled with peril no matter the direction you face, but it is wise to remember that the unseen threat is no less dangerous as well. Consider the rest of your journey with care.

Special Rules

Mo and Makaal

Open the Merchant level 2 deck and add it to the shop.

Adversary Ether Field

If you have the milestone “Subdued the Ahma” marked on your campaign sheet, for Quest 3-4 mark  for  and  for .

If you have either of the milestones “Dispatched the Sovereign” or “Dispatched the Advocate” marked on your campaign sheet, for Quest 3-4 mark  for  and  for .

Adventure

Before you embark on your next quest, you can travel to the Zydero Reef and battle the Hydra that is terrorizing the beach. Proceed to page 40 of the campaign book.

Choice

A Investigate the Unsouled Barrens.

Place the Bonespire sticker, B-3, onto the map.

Open up the quest box 3 / 7 and unpack the standees.

Proceed to page 42 of the campaign book.

B Help the King of Storms.

Place the Uzem’s Shrine sticker, D-4, onto the map.

Open up the quest box 4 / 8 and unpack the standees.

Proceed to page 54 of the campaign book.

The Island of Doctor Mo

Introduction

Scratchpad of alchemist Zesat

The starlings have taken to their assigned roles with fervor. This is good! Nu has ether sensitivity like nothing I've ever seen. The diligence of Mo rivals even the best of the students I've seen. They work together as a fine keb rasska pair. I believe Mo has even begun growing simulated keb limbs. Such flattery!

Perhaps there can be a chance for resting in the future. They'll take over the clan's crafting circles before they even realize. As they should. I think they learned from the best!

The starling, Mo, seems to prefer spending more time toiling away at the saddle of equipment than anything else. As Silky guides you through new ether channeling exercises, the starling sneaks a peek when they think nobody is paying attention. Their interest is warranted—Prime Rovers are not named often, and to see a group of them earn their accolades together is an extreme rarity.

Mo sets down their tools and turns to face your group properly. “If you're really searching for a way to score your shells, perhaps you could travel to my clan's harvesting grounds. I'm quite familiar with the zyderos gathered from the barrier island and I think your talents with ether would serve quite well in utilizing it.”

Silky studies Mo for a moment. Two unblinking entities made of pure ether. The silence stretches between them, until Makaal breaks first and swats playfully at Mo. “I think you could already guess, but that little reef tends to be rather dangerous most of the year. What I think Mo means to imply is that the Rovers may find it a pleasant distraction after... what just happened.”

The aerios moves a wing to stroke an imaginary beard, before remembering his actual body is completely disconnected from the conjuration. “I hadn't accounted for such a far-off detour to the west, but... perhaps there is merit. I admit, I'd like to see what you have planned! Hand-crafted and uniquely-attuned etheric constructs are also worth a favor.

Journeying to Zydero Reef means several days of travel, during which Silky and Mo discuss the conditions of the ocean and what might be awaiting on the island during this season. Though really the only thing that matters, in your case, is ensuring that the creatures currently spawning on the island don't spread their way back to the mainland.

Setup



Take Intermissions ▶ Go to 16
▶ Go to 24-25.

Victory Condition



Slay the Hydra.

Round limit: 8 ⌚

Challenges



- 1 If there are no dyads on the map, the Hydra gains +2 to all of their attacks.
- 2 Dyads gain +4 .
- 3 Bulwauros lose their trait.

Special Rules



Ferrorsands

The magnetically charged sands are in constant conflux.

You will notice several lines with arrows showing direction of movement drawn on this map. These arrows represent the flow of magnetic sands within the Zydero Reefs. At the start of both the Rover and Adversary phases, all units a part of the Rover faction are pushed along these lines in the direction of the arrows. Take note that some lines will push you into the Zydero reefs.

The Zydero reefs are hard as iron, jagged, and deadly. Any unit that suffers impact damage for being pushed or pulled into a Zydero Reef suffers an additional +1 .

The adversaries within this encounter are native to the Zydero Reefs and ignore the effects of Ferrorsands.



Terrain



It costs units 1 additional movement point to enter a space within 1 of this object.



Units within 1 of this object gain +1 to the first attack they perform during their turn.



Barrier terrain is Zydero Reefs.

Codex Links



175

Before the start of the first round, read “Zydero Reef” 84.

176

If an urn is slain, read “Mineral Shell”, 84.

177

Immediately when the Hydra is slain, read “Gathering Sands”, 84.



Quest 3

The Tomb

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Introduction

Ozendyn whipped his sword through the air, flinging the gore free of the blade before returning it to its sheathe. His neck rippled and he couldn't keep the smile from his face. Gargaki, the pet coruscopod, a creature that had been part of his sacred order since before his own birth, was eager to cleanse the fetid meat from the dead monster. He nodded and his companion leapt forth to begin its feast.

Ozendyn longed for the past when he still had others to turn to; he and Gargaki held a deep bond now but its kind were exceedingly rare, and as the sole guardian that still drew breath, he had no means to learn how to nurture the coruscopod's growth besides what it consumed during the daily excursions across the Barrens. He chuckled at the idea that he could miss receiving lectures from a zusag, or the banal challenges issued to him by his tihfur friends.

After the past few weeks, there was no doubt about it. The Barrens were creeping further and further, seemingly in every direction. Had Ozendyn's entire life not been a constant battle against the Unsouled such a realization would have crushed him utterly. He could imagine the tales scholars would tell-of how The Wake and the dying wails of its final members joined the resurgence of the Unsouled Barrens. A suitably dramatic end but not one Ozendyn would willingly accept.

He sighed and turned his gaze up to the horrible monument of flesh, bone, and catastrophe that towered above everything at the heart of the Barrens. An ever-helpful warning to the smarter beings of Lalos, yet he couldn't help but resent anybody who could rest their eyes on such a beacon of despair and still turn away. The usual swarms of broken vessels-shrieking tendrils of pure Morph and malicious intent-flitted about the heights of the ivory tower. Yet something was different this time.

Something sharp, well-defined, and gleaming radiantly was circling the tower. Much brighter than the dull glow of the vessels that called it their home, and a fair bit more swift. With a start Ozendyn realized that it was a Crux conjuration. Had another batch of dim-witted associates decided to test themselves in an expanse that only taught lessons of death and despair?

He started whistling. First one tune, and then another. Whistle-songs zusag schools use to communicate with one another while in stealth. By the third tune, the gleaming shape shot through the sky towards him. An avian conjuration! In a few heartbeats, the glowing bird had reached where he was standing and circled around him as it descended.

"Greetings! What might an intelligent folksman such as yourself be doing in this dreadful retreat?" said a tinny voice. Ozendyn looked around, aware that zusag often traveled using techniques to hide themselves from sight, before turning back to the conjuration.

"What needs to be done. I am Ozendyn, the last Sentinel of The Wake."

Campaign Link



Go to "Peering Over The Rim"  44.

Quest 3 • Encounter 1

Peering Over the Rim

Introduction

Transcribed musings from “Silky,” resident Fundamentalist of the Mist clan.

Ah, the Unsouled Barrens. We say seeing is believing, but in this case one can see the dreadful locale from any reasonably tall perch. It's been long enough now that some of you have come to accept it as a “natural” part of Lalos—it's been there for your entire life after all—but allow me to correct you: There is nothing natural about it. There is of course a distinction between “natural” and “intentional”, but that is a different story for a different time. For now we carry on with our lesson about the creatures found within—and how you might best circumvent the region when traveling across the continent, lest you be drawn into the perennial conflict of The Wake.

Silky located someone surviving in the wasteland of death remarkably quickly. Better still, said someone is a battle-hardened veteran who is ready to lend his aid to your endeavor to fight your way to the Bonespire. Both Mo and Makaal cling tightly to Grandpaw as you all breach through the wooded trail into the outer reaches of the Unsouled Barrens' region of influence. The thick stench of old meat immediately assails you.

An older, somewhat ragged human follows behind the aeries. Strangely, he doesn't cross the threshold where the desolate rock meets the woods. Wrapped around his shoulders is a bright shawl that undulates gently. “Truly a caravan of Rovers? Will wonders never cease?” he says. “It is a sight for sore eyes! I am Ozendyn, the single fool that remains to stand against the tower of ivory.”

The last of his fellow warriors perished in the months prior as the Barrens first underwent its new growth. Makaal bows deeply and apologies for not routing past the region to barter equipment more frequently. Ozendyn dismisses the apology and waves his hands

while laughing, joking that the merchant's latest delivery is his best yet.

“If you really are to assist as your teacher claims, then we have no time to waste.” He explains one of the forces causing the expansion of the Barrens are newly formed nesting heaps for the stomaw flesh beasts. Destroying one nest isn't likely to stem the tide, but it's more than Ozendyn is capable of on his own.

Marching through the Unsouled Barrens is always a uniquely harrowing experience. Each footstep carrying with it a crunch, a squelch, or something muted beneath a piercing shriek in the distance. It is rare that a Rover has to involve themselves with creatures native to the region; the monsters of the Barrens have a distinct lack of a survival instinct. They're quick to fight amongst themselves to the point of mutual destruction, or fall prey to the more coordinated and slightly less frenzied beasts of Lalos should they escape outside of the wastes.

That doesn't mean you are any less prepared for the task ahead, however.

Setup



Take 3/7 ▶ Go to 17 ▶ Go to 26-27.

Tiles: 4x Hatchery

Victory Condition



Destroy the Monstrous Growth at .

Round limit: 8

Loss Conditions



Lose if Ozendyn is slain.

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Challenges

- 1 When a stomaw is placed on the side of the map, roll an ether dice from the general pool. On a result of  or , set its standee vertical instead of sideways.
- 2 At the end of the Start Phase, the Monstrous Growth recovers ♥ X, where X equals the number of stomaw on the map.
- 3 Rovers within ↗ 1-3 of the Monstrous Growth count as being adjacent to an adversary, for the purposes of the stomaw trait.

Special Rules

Ozendyn

Ozendyn is a character ally to Rovers. For this encounter Ozendyn will only use the “Picket” side and will not flip.

A Sea of Gnashing Teeth

A seemingly endless horde of necrotic monstrosities are pouring out from the wastes. There are six ether icons on the edges of the map. These icons represent possible spawn locations throughout the encounter.

When a stomaw is slain, place it off to the side of the map on its side. During the start phase, for each stomaw that is both off to the side and flipped vertically, roll an ether dice from the general pool, then spawn that stomaw at the space with the ether icon corresponding to the result that was just rolled. Then, for each stomaw that is both off to the side and placed on its side, flip them vertically.

Adversaries

There are spaces marked dekaha / ashmak. The enemy that is spawned changes depending on the special rule block you are referencing.

Terrain



Non-flying units that enter jagged bones suffer ⚡ 1.



Non-flying units that enter jagged bones suffer ⚡ 1.



There are ether nodes on the map marked with a  icon. The ether type of these nodes changes depending on the special rule block you are referencing.



Monstrous Growth at  is a special object and has R*12 ♥. Rovers treat the Monstrous Growth as an enemy and no faction treats it as an ally.

Changed World

If you completed Quest 1, you will use special rule block A. If you completed Quest 2, you will use special rule block B.

A



Terrain: Units that end their turn within ↗ 1 of this object suffer ⚡ 1.

Enemies: Ashmak

B



Terrain: It costs units 1 additional movement point to enter a space within ↗ 1 of this object.

Enemies: Dekaha

Codex Links

48

The first time a stomaw is slain, read “Between its Glistening Teeth”,  27.

49

If the haunt is slain, read “Whose Art Sublimely Shines”,  27.

50

Immediately when the Monstrous Growth is destroyed, read “Free From the Flesh”,  28.

Midst of the Black Seas

Introduction

Entry within The Barren Quire from “Earlong,” self-appointed Scribe of The Wake.

Does the screaming cause them fear as well? Is that what makes their behavior so erratic? If every time we opened our own mouths we frightened ourselves, how long could we go before tearing each other apart?

There were people here once, or so I was told. It’s not as though we have a library anywhere. Even this codex is hardly organized, not that I’m helping there. Greatest clan in Lalos, built at the very heart of the continent.

Heart. When the Bonespire pulses—a heartbeat? Is it that simple? As simple as successfully replacing my own heart.

Ozendyn gently closes the codex and binds it back on his hip. He has read it cover to cover multiple times over the last year, but with the arrival of the Rovers its passages held more significance than ever. Passed down from Scribe to Scribe over the lifespan of The Wake, each one expanding it, chronicling their endeavors and dwindling optimism as their mission outlived the order in the end.

The Rovers had come in like a blaze and tore their way through a brood chamber, hardly resting as they carried detritus to the merchants following in their trail. That sort of feat would have taken a team from The Wake days of planning and careful execution. When they first met, Silky had been blindingly confident in his team’s

capability. The zusag’s unique construct afforded him a perspective on the Barrens that Ozendyn hadn’t heard from anybody other than the eldest members in his order. Silky suggested myriad ways in which his group could finally complete Ozendyn’s mission, and hadn’t wavered once under the barrage of confused questions about how such things were possible.

He would not be mollified with just one display of strength, overwhelming though it had been, and so he brought the group deeper into the Barrens for what he felt would be the only way to truly be convinced. Scattered across the region in a wide perimeter surrounding the Bonespire were cracks in the ground from which turbulent Morph ether vented into the open air. These geysers were often the source of more frightening monstrosities that roamed the Barrens, weaving together rock, bone, and malice into violent creations.

If Silky felt his team had any real chance in a direct assault against the source of this madness, Ozendyn wanted to see how they fared against one of the most dangerous creations borne from it. Dubbed “scour” by a former member of his order, the beasts live up to their name. The creature’s flesh is burned from their still-shifting bones through proximity to powerful bursts of ether. The heinous fluids they generate melt the otherwise rocky landscape they reside upon.

Silky was excited to hear about the monsters in detail, labeling it as “the perfect test of faith”. It sounded more like insanity to Ozendyn, but he was more than happy not to have to participate in this “test” with the scour.

Setup



Take 3/7 ▶ Go to 18 ▶ Go to 28-29.

Tiles: 4x Hatchery

Victory Condition



Slay the Scour.

Round limit: 8

Challenges



- 1 The Scour gains +R*6 .
- 2 After the turn where the Scour suffers from any source, spawn 1 broken vessel at 2 of it, closest to the nearest Rover.
- 3 The Scour gains +1 when targeting an enemy with half or less .

Special Rules



On Advance

Adversaries in this encounter use the On Advance mechanic, which is found on page 47 f the rulebook.

Terrain



Non-flying units that enter jagged bones suffer 1.



Units that trigger bursting tar traps suffer 3.



Units within 1 of this object gain -1 to the first attack they perform during their turn.



If there are 3 or more Rovers, place a dice at node , and if there are 4 or more Rovers, place a dice at node . In this way, there can be 2, 3, or 4 nodes on this map, depending on Rover count. This affects the Scour's trait.

Codex Links



51

The first time a broken vessel is slain, read “A Strange Spirit Stalks”, 28.

52

If the urn is slain, read “Capacity for Detachment”, 28.

53

Immediately when the Scour is slain, read “Monstrous, Unnatural, Colossal”, 29.

Paralyzed Memories

Introduction

Entry within The Barren Quire from “Mockhorn,” Scribe of The Wake.

The weapons we employ against those of Bazhar’s dominion are strongest when infused with Crux. While Fire can always be relied upon to wreak destruction, the Unsouled are brought about through pure Anima, and so the fundamentally opposing force will prove a more effective means of... unmaking.

This will prove challenging if the situation here remains as it stands, or worsens. Crux aligns itself with both the intangible and the symmetrical. Conjurations with their inherent temporal instability satisfy the former, and we zusag have spent generations refining the latter. Without the time or the capacity for such arts, one is left with forged weaponry, all of which are naturally very tangible. Also very difficult to create more from rock and bone, at least for those of us that remain.

If you are reading this, remember to keep your weapons pristine where and when possible, but above all keep your weapon balanced. Everything you do to create a more coordinated structure gives the Crux that much more strength to adhere to before it wanes.

It was beyond belief—a notion too absurd, yet here Ozendyn stood. Silky had proven his team of Rovers could stand in the face of overwhelming strength and still claim victory.

What had he lacked? His comrades? The Wake was a clan older than Ozendyn, yet for all the years it spent deadlocked with the Unsouled Barrens, they had been whittled away down to the last.

Flapping drew his attention—Silky’s aerios descends to hover nearby, facing the Bonespire instead of the remnants of one of the single greatest dangers Ozendyn had known throughout his life.

“Breadth. Vision. Resources,” Silky began, still facing the undulating tower that mocked Lalos. Ozendyn tilted his head back to listen. Then, with a mixture of anger and confusion churning away inside of him, he asked “You... are suggesting that things could have turned out differently?”

The construct shook its avian-head. “What I suggest is that we combine our knowledge and come to a solution for this long-standing problem for everybody,” Silky replied carefully, motioning to the text strapped at Ozendyn’s waist. “You spoke of treatises on Crux infusion. Mo, our talented crafter, has an acute sense for ether. I have experience in leyline manifestation, among other zusagcraft. My Rovers have strength forged in conflicts neither of us can conceive of on an individual basis. You have lived through it all for decades. Our horns are yours, Sentinel.”

Ozendyn blinked, stunned by the indomitable pragmatism of the sage. He looked upon his lyst-burned tattoos and etchings of his sword, lacking the typical sheen they held when properly infused. “The bark, or fruit, of an azoth was the reagent my elders relied upon here in the Barrens. I know of one nearby, but it has been claimed by a rogue addax-spawn that bears none of their usual countenance. Its antlers, alongside the azoth’s harvest, should grant us the necessary components.”

This time, he didn’t stop to wonder if Silky’s Rovers would be up to the task.

Setup



Take 3/7 ▶ Go to 19 ▶ Go to 30

Tiles: 4x Hoard

Victory Condition



Slay the Crown.

Round limit: 8 ⌚

Loss Conditions



Lose if Ozendyn is slain.

Challenges



- 1 The azoth gains +1 .
- 2 When the azoth is slain, spawn R Dyad hatchlings in spaces the azoth occupied.
- 3 After any action where the crown suffers damage, it performs:
Logic: Retreat. 3

Special Rules



Ozendyn

Ozendyn is a character ally to Rovers. For this encounter Ozendyn will only use their “Picket” side and will not flip.

Terrain



Non-flying units that enter thick bramble suffer 1.



Units within 1 of this object gain +1 to the first attack they perform during their turn.

Codex Links



54

If a Rover enters into a space with a hoard tile, remove the tile and read “Ornamental Fruits”, 29.

55

The first time a dyad hatchling is slain, read “Slithering Malice”, 29.

56

Immediately when the crown is slain, read “Crown of a Shocking Eikon”, 30.

A Malign and Particular Suspension

Introduction

Bazhar stirred. Bazhar opened one, two, three, five, eight, thirteen, twenty-one eyes. Bazhar could now see. Bazhar's tendrils were the lace that tied him to the world. Bazhar's ether was the dust that outlined his home. Bazhar unraveled. Bazhar could now feel. Bazhar was the connected locus of Lalos.

Bazhar staggered as his awareness snapped back into a singularity. He flexed his limbs and slowly panned his vision across his "domain"—the rotten scar of flesh that he had wrought through the continent. Or, that he was still spreading, it seemed now? He searched his unconscious recollection for what would have prompted a sudden expansion of his body even further.

Bazhar heard the distant boom of thunder, and with it brought an answer. Across the mountains, the addax had been... driven to frenzy? Bazhar could understand how his slumbering mind would have perceived a sudden deluge of storms as a threat to defend against, but not why the creature would so dramatically shift from a century of following the same pattern.

Bazhar continued searching his dreams for other details. Shame flared as he saw the demise of the clan that acted as his warden. All but one of its members had been caught in the waves of new offspring that followed his body's growths. He had never truly expected the clan to be capable of exacting the punishment he knew he deserved, but Lalos would be marred even further without them to cull his progeny.

Bazhar dredged further. Being forced to relive moments linearly was always torture for him, as it inevitably meant he would reach the present time and be compelled to relive every one of his past failures once more.

Bazhar stopped, catching a gleaming avian many times in his recent memories. What was that? Zusag, surely, but... it had shown itself many times over several years. What did it intend?

Bazhar, under an odd compulsion and with tortured effort, stretched his awareness into his immediate surroundings. There. Not just the avian. His final warden, and another group besides. Rovers? Rovers had living charges to care for, not his dying husk of a body. The avian must be leading the warden and Rovers to his heart.

Bazhar let his awareness grow hazy again as he resumed recounting himself. A calm filled his extremities that he hadn't felt since the earliest days of consciousness. A comfort that perhaps Chorus would pull itself from the brink. A certainty that he could finally share his story with somebody after so long.

Bazhar slept.

Setup



Take 3/7 ▶ Go to 20 ▶ Go to 31.

Victory Condition



Complete three floors, getting to the top of the tower.

Round limit: 5 ⌚

Loss Conditions



Lose if Ozendyn is slain.

Challenges



- 1 Rovers remove all ether dice from their personal pool when transitioning into a new floor.
- 2 The on floor 2 gains +R*5 ❤️.
- 3 You have only 4 rounds to complete floor 3.

Special Rules



Ozendyn

Ozendyn is a character ally to Rovers. Ozendyn begins the encounter on their “Picket” side. Once during this encounter, at the start of the turn of the Rover who controls Ozendyn may choose to flip them over to the “Crucial Sentinel” side. At the end of this turn, flip Ozendyn back over to their “Picket” side

A Fixt Monument

You must scale the Bonespire quickly before your crux-infused reagents lose their potency. To scale the tower and win this encounter you’ll have to complete 3 different floors.



For each floor, you’ll have 5 rounds to complete it.

You are on the ground floor and must ascend a precarious series of stairs. Slay all enemies to clear the floor and proceed to the next floor.

Codex Links



57

The first time a fell cradle is slain, read “Combined to Inculcate”, 31.

58

At the end of the round where all adversaries are slain, including the broken vessels that spawn from slaying a fell cradle, read “In The Dank Twilight I Climbed”, 31.

Fathomless Chaos

Introduction

Ozendyn tried unsuccessfully to calm himself. All these years, the name “Bazhar” in The Wake’s writings had been referring to someone, not something. Though something abominable might be more accurate, looking upon the monster towering before him. Throughout the years the name had been written less and less often as its meaning became less relevant to his clan.

He should strike now, while the monster is vulnerable... but before he could commit, Silky’s aerios positioned itself in front of the starling and began to speak. “These names. Are you able to speak more of them? Henzya is ancient, by my records, but neither of the other names hold meaning.”

Bazhar whipped his spiked tail in irritation. “When Navel was inhabited by others, it was Henzya. A grand commune at the heart of Lalos—the richest gathering of intellect and culture, possibly in all of Chorus. Tihfur of stout four-legged disposition that could repel all predators, keb rasska whose industriousness could have seen us from shore to shore, and humans whose passion for life could have been the bridge to a true dynasty.”

Ozendyn could scarcely believe such a fantasy, but Silky’s avatar was practically vibrating with excitement. Silky continued to prod. “‘When Navel was,’ you said. Where we are now, this desolate realm, you call Navel? You call yourself Bazhar, the ‘Father of Navel?’”

Bazhar signaled assent with one hand, and dissent with the other. “Bazhar was the name granted to me as a newborn vessel. I came into existence somewhere within the bounds of Henzya, to which I am told there was great jubilation the likes of which have never been seen before or since. That was all before I reached consciousness.” Silky nodded, aware of the life cycles of starlings. “We still use the term to refer to Inarcane Morph starlings,” Silky replied.

Bazhar paused before speaking. “You do not need to hear the full story of my time within Henzya. The point... is that all of our philosophers and practitioners were of the opinion that more starlings, more vessels, could be wrought with higher concentrations of Morph.”

“NO!” screams Mo from the saddled arkenyn. They shudder violently, clawing at the crystal wrapped in their tendrils, and drawing their legs into themselves.

“Clever casteling. What sort of life have you led to see the story’s end so quickly?” Bazhar rumbled.

Silky clicked and said in a low whisper, “Butcher of Henzya.”

Bazhar’s tendrils began to writhe wildly. “Yes. While sources of Morph are certainly present throughout Lalos, the best source... was already within reach. Tihfur, keb, human, all much more potent sources of ether than wild beasts or ancient caverns. Through their sacrifice, I would become the Navel for my offspring.”

Punctuating Bazhar’s story, a broken vessel screeched its way out from beneath the lip of the Bonespire’s peak. “Unfortunately, each and every one of them are... stillborn. Broken. Unsuitable. I slaughtered my friends, my family, my future, and for what?”

Bazhar twisted his entire shape to face Ozendyn in full, limbs reemerging from his central mass instead of rotating normally. “Your family were to be my wardens—the last kith from the families of Henzya—but now there is only you.

Judge me as you will.”



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Setup



Take 3/7 ▶ Go to 25 ▶ Go to 38/39.

Victory Condition



Slay Bazhar.

Round limit: 5

Loss Conditions



Lose if Ozendyn is slain.

Challenges



- 1 Bazhar Caller gains +2 as long as there are other adversaries on the map.
- 2 Increase the damage and push effects of Bazhar Charger's trait by +1.
- 3 When Bazhar Absolute spawns broken vessels, they spawn R of them instead.

Special Rules



This is a 3 phase fight. Each phase has its own round limit.

Ozendyn

Ozendyn is a character ally to Rovers. Ozendyn begins the encounter on their "Picket" side. Once during this encounter, at the start of the turn of the Rover who controls Ozendyn may choose to flip them over to their "Crucial Sentinel" side. At the end of this turn, flip Ozendyn back over to their "Picket" side.

Bazhar

This broken creature is powerful and can withstand incredible damage. Read each statistic block carefully, including traits, to understand what Bazhar is capable of.

Codex Links



Immediately after the turn where Bazhar Caller is defeated, read "Many Pairs of Legs", 36.



Quest 4

Burden of Uzem

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Introduction

Transcribed musings from “Silky,” resident Fundamentalist of the Mist clan.

What would Lalos look like if our settled addax was of a different comportment? It is likely that the Thunder Mesa would not exist at all. Would that desert of static peril instead be a rich, volcanic loam? Would the clans presiding there be any different? Or would we have found ourselves at the mercy of a yet more dangerous stretch of inhospitable terrain wrought by the power of an addax?

For decades, the gargantuan tree at the heart of Lalos has earned many epithets—“Uzem’s Throne,” “The Seat of Storms,” “Thundering Peak,” and others still lost to time. The important detail is that it is where the ancient addax of Lalos has made his home. While the first foray your party took to the region had not been particularly fruitful, the continued storms billowing from the valley suggest that not only is Uzem present, but under particular duress.

Over generations the storms formed by the addax took on a regular pattern. Had Uzem not been recorded as the source of those storms, one might even mistake them for a natural weather cycle. A thunderhead forms over the colossal tree in the central valley, builds into a rainstorm that travels southwest, before eventually becoming a dry barrage of lightning that hammers the landscape. These expressions of Uzem’s ether affinity have had considerable effect upon the continent itself. They’re treated as part of the cycle of seasons in the area and the clans there have grown accustomed to temporary migrations or sheltering to withstand them.

Much of the southern half of Lalos is referred to as the “Thunder Mesa,” a stretch of desert filled with substantial crystals of Air ether that crackle with electric potency. The clans that reside in the savannah north of the desert proper have lived with the yearly cycle of these storms, viewing them as a boon for the growing season. None view the addax as a particular menace—so much as just a force of nature to curve their lives around. Some even

grow up unaware of its specific presence and consider “The Seat of Storms” as a less-than-literal name for the meteorological phenomenon. If the unpredictable storms are not quelled, those clans may be driven to an end in short order.

Silky clears his throat. Quite the odd sound as it reverberates forth from his aeries. “Slaying the addax is... no longer an inconceivable feat, given your strength as Rovers working together, though certainly not the preferred first, second, or even really third course of action. Investigating why Uzem has suddenly started to produce a strange and chaotic series of storms may prove more fruitful. After all, the addax has never been known to be a particularly aggressive creature on its own. The same can rarely be said of its progeny however. Crowns are a territorial and fickle bunch of therans on the best of days. Do take care if we encounter any!

“That being said, the only thing we can do is forge onward and upward to see if we can’t solve this particular problem ourselves. I have faith in your growing capabilities as a team to stand against the coming storm.”

Campaign Link



Go to “The Clouds Roll On”  56.

The Clouds Roll On

Introduction

Two starlings of the Zyderite clan share thoughts.

Mo, the ether always feels. Feel with the ether, rather than feeling for the ether!

Nu, the other crafters can barely perceive these energies. Teaching them something like “feel with the ether” is absurd. Is there something else? Flows? Cycles?

Mo, just... this alchemy, this crafting, is there always such rigidity? Surely there is instinct, impulse, intuition?

Nu... of course, just consider that few have such keen reactions. They require direct guidance before they can develop such awareness.

Mo's tendrils lash uncomfortably as the Rovers lead the party closer and closer to Uzem's Throne once more. Something in the storm feels deeply unsettling, even more than when Makaal had tried to travel through this valley just before encountering Silky. It was tinged with... Emotion? Instinct? That couldn't be right—energy didn't come with sensations like that. It sounded like the sort of thing Nu might have said. Mo drags a tendril over the cracked remnants of their sibling wrapped at their head. Was there something else to the rains? Perhaps something else was stirring the memories, but to react like this meant it couldn't be anything good.

Silky had suggested a much more treacherous, but direct route for their return to the shrine in the valley. Makaal had seemed unperturbed, but Mo wasn't as comfortable with the suggestions. It was likely safer than a trip through the Unsouled Barrens, at least. A travel plan that can be summarized as “climbing the nearby mountain and relying on travel through the air along the caps of fulgurshrooms” as a way to reach the thickest part of Uzem's Throne... it was certainly faster than climbing from the bottom, but what faith the old zusag placed in everyone!

A broad presence suddenly assaults Mo's senses. “Stop!” they cry. The Rovers dismount Grandpaw and take combat stances with practiced ease. Mo couldn't help but be surprised at the amount of trust laid upon this instinct, but there would be time to explore that later. “Those massive ether crystals... something connects them? ...is connected? Someone or something hopes to stall us. Makaal, this is something for the Rovers to handle; let's retreat.”

Makaal gave Grandpaw a pat, prompting him to lead them away from the cliff where the large ether crystals resided. Mo strained to perceive what tingled at their senses. The best they could tell was that the crystals contained far more ether than expected, and it was far more active than large crystallized ether should be.. Whatever it was, the Rovers would likely be a match for it. Their strength was a marvel Mo had only experienced at the hand of malefactors that stole their power from others. Had Silky known of their strength before? Or was this his own grand architecture?

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Setup



Take 4/8 ▶ Go to 27 ▶ Go to 40-41.

Victory Condition



Slay Uzem's Anxiety.

Round limit: 8 ⌛

Challenges



- During the end phase of each round, Uzem's Anxiety performs:



Treat the push as coming from the nearest ether cluster

- After Uzem's Anxiety spawns, treat all other adversaries as occupying a . This is a permanent effect.

- Replace the end phase effect from the The Screaming Storm special rule with:



Special Rules



Quiet the Storm

Potent ether threatens to exacerbate the raging storm buffeting the ridge line. You need to draw the ether from the crystal to dispel it. There is a wind ether node cluster and a crux ether node cluster. All Rovers must end the round adjacent to one of these clusters to summon Uzem's Anxiety.

Terrain



Non-flying units that enter jagged bones suffer 1.



Units within 1 of this object gain +1 .



Units within 1 of this object gain +1 to the first attack they perform during their turn.

Codex Links



75

The first time a streak is slain, read “The Fearless Flight”, 38.

76

If an urn is slain, read “Perfectly Heartless”, 38.

77

During the end phase, if all Rovers are adjacent to the wind ether node cluster or the crux ether node cluster, read “With A Bitter Look”, 38.

Earth, Food, Raiment

Introduction

“Gather up!” cried the lead of the forward party. Her streak companion squawked loudly to emphasize the shout. Five elite ether channelers rounded up in front of her, with each of their own adjutants and menagerie behind the line they formed. Each one had been selected for this mission due to their unique affinities—a major component of what they would need to subdue the King of Storms and siphon his ether.

“This is no ordinary hunting excursion! Our usual methods won’t work, and that’s why everyone here has been assembled for the task. Eztu cleared our path for us initially with her... particular talents managing a galeaper brood, and the rest of our folks have been busied with the addax-spawn to give us this chance.” She paces back and forth as she debriefs the group.

“We have our tools, we have our orders. We rip out his ether and make it ours one bite at a time. Let’s bring a measure of peace to our southern families, and prove to Master that we’re more than ready for bigger prey!” A dozen or more humans and beasts erupt in cheers before beginning their preparations for the eventual descent into Uzem’s Shrine.

Mo and Silky are deep in conversation. Makaal scratches behind Grandpaw’s ears idly. He has enough trouble keeping up with Mo when the starling gets into one of their creative moods, and the words flying between the pair barely resemble language as he knows it. Mo is curled over a particularly long and rough-looking spear as Silky’s aerios hops from limb to limb, in a rather poultry-like fashion, whipping his wings and emphasizing certain regions of the spear with Mo nodding along.

Before the merchant can get too lost in his reminiscing, Mo excitedly calls the group over. “With Silky’s help I think we’ve achieved a way to cross the fulgurcaps without getting caught off guard like before. I can still sense the same presence that... consumed the crown here. Slightly different, but I think it’s all from the same source: Uzem. We believe something has caused Uzem to... fracture his power of storms. That’s why the storms aren’t behaving as they usually would and why my body feels so disrupted by the rains. There are multiple lesser ‘conjunctions’ each discharging their powers without a guiding force.

“As the addax grows from the crown, and a crown is aspected to Crux, we should be able to use Crux ether to draw out his power. Crux always seeks balance, and so his disparate facets are attempting to anchor themselves to the next closest thing to the addax: his offspring. I don’t think we can stop this from happening, but we can possibly control the place where it happens. As you travel the fulgurcaps, look for a potent source of ether and thrust this spear at its base. It should attract the facet—or perhaps the crown it has attached itself to.” Mo holds out the spear to the Rovers, now adorned with myriad geometric carvings and glowing with the faint hue of ether-infused power.

Setup



Take 4/8 ▶ Go to 27 ▶ Go to 42-43.

Victory Condition



Slay Uzem's Endurance.

Round limit: 8

Challenges



- 1 While a Rover carries the Dowsing Spear, all of their movement actions are reduced by 2 instead.
- 2 When Uzem's Endurance spawns, it spawns in the vine space furthest from the most Rovers instead.
- 3 After Uzem's Endurance spawns, treat all other adversaries as occupying an . This is a permanent effect.

Special Rules



Settle the Earth

Uzem's Endurance is hidden somewhere beneath the fulgurcaps. You need to draw Uzem's Endurance from out of the ground to defeat it. To do this, you must bring the Dowsing Spear within 1 of the earth ether node cluster.

At the beginning of the encounter, decide which Rover will carry the Dowsing Spear, represented by a hoard tile on that Rover's class board.



While a Rover carries the Dowsing Spear, all of their movement actions are reduced by 1 and their actions become actions, and they gain the following ability:

Throw Dowsing Spear: Select one Rover within 1-3 and place the Dowsing Spear on their class board.

Note: Throw Dowsing Spear is an ability, so it requires an ability activation to use.

Terrain



Units that end their turn within 1 of this object recover 1.



Units within 1 of this object gain +1 to the first attack they perform during their turn.

Codex Links



If the haunt is slain, read “If Only One Hides It”, 40.



At the end of the round, if the Rover that is carrying the Dowsing Spear is within 1 of the earth ether node cluster, read “With The Grasses Waving”, 40.

Power Of Disseminating

Introduction

Water is a challenging element; Mo knows it in a way only a being literally made of Water-ether can. Deep under the sea the only choice is to contend with its existence. Here atop one of the tallest structures on Lalos, the starling finds a certain irony in the similarities the great tree has with the deepest depths. Light can barely penetrate its way into the sea; the foliage of the great boughs are nearly as effective at creating a pall of darkness. Currents and riptides in the sea mean you have little choice but to be carried where the waves take you. The massive roots of the tree that form Uzem's Throne likely have the same effect on the ground, and those who dwell upon or within it, below. Between it all is a wealth of unique flora that grows to rely upon the difficult environment cultivated by the uncaring brutality.

Life truly is symmetrical.

Mo clings tightly to Grandpaw's back with their many legs as the group bounds smoothly from mushroom to mushroom. As the Seat of Storms draws close, Mo is shocked to see just how tremendous the ancient structure truly is. It now occurs to the starling that the hovel they had hidden in with Makaal hadn't been a true chamber; but merely a hollow in one of the roots. Reaching the true sanctum of the addax apparently entails scaling the entirety of the shrine and descending from the top. It is fortunate the enormity of the tree means that what appears to be a sheer vertical climb is actually an almost approachable series of holloways and wide boughs that wrap around the structure. It isn't going to be simple by any means, but Mo feels much less concerned with the logistics of climbing from bole to canopy.

Instead, Mo knows it is going to be a different kind of challenge. The storms have only gotten worse and the rain forceful enough to pose an obstacle all on their own. This time there is no doubt about the presence responsible for the deluge. Even with the barest of understanding on how, Mo can feel the emotional tint

to the ether in the rain. As an avatar of storms, Air and Water are likely the arcane elements Uzem resonates with the strongest, and why Mo can feel that influence even without understanding what it was initially.

As Grandpaw finally lands the party atop a stable branch, Mo secures the finishing touches on their project, satisfied it will serve the Rovers well enough. "The next conjuration of Uzem is going to be more of a contest than its weaker aspect of Earth back on the fulgurcaps. I've fashioned these grapple-lines for each of you. Hooks wrought from galeaper claws, ropes of terranape vine, all fastened together with the pinions of streaks, and finally reinforced with the respective ether—they should fare even when completely drenched. If you feel you're at risk of losing your footing in the middle of combat, these should help you secure yourselves until you've steadied again."

The starling watches the Rovers hike further up the great boughs.

Setup



Take 4/8 ▶ Go to 28 ▶ Go to 44.

Tiles: 3x Bursting Bells

Victory Condition



Slay Uzem's Woe.

Round limit: 7

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Challenges



- 1 During “Seat of Storms” Ascension, set the Round Limit to 3.
- 2 Increase the damage Rovers suffer from Raging Rapids by +1 ⚡.
- 3 After Uzem’s Woe spawns, treat all Rovers as occupying a ⚡. This is a permanent effect.

Special Rules

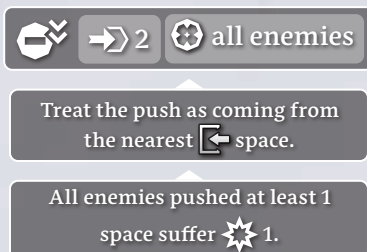


Tame the Rapids

Uzem’s Woe is trying to wash you away with a deluge and keep you from the inner sanctum of the “Seat of Storms”. All Rovers must make it to an space in order to ascend the “Seat of Storms” and fight Uzem’s Woe.

Raging Rapids

Uzem’s Woe is trying to wash you from the tree. While climbing the tree, Uzem’s Woe assails you. At the end of each round it performs:



Special Supply

For this encounter, all Rovers gain the following ability:

Enchanted Rope:



Note: Enchanted Rope is an ability, so it requires an ability activation to use.

Terrain



Units that trigger bursting bell traps suffer ⚡ 3.



It costs units 1 additional movement point to enter a space within ↗ 1 of this object.



Units within ↗ 1 of this object gain +1 ⚡ to the first attack they perform during their turn.

Codex Links



82

When all Rovers occupy an space, the round immediately ends, then read “With Many Tears”, 41.

That Uneasy, Dissatisfied Feeling

Introduction

Mo and Makaal banter as they travel a nondescript road.

Makaal scratches his head in thought. “So you’re suggesting that ether has... flavor?” he asks. “Isn’t that obvious? Morph, Water, Earth, you know. The whole bag of them.”

Mo’s tendrils wobble as they consider how to respond. “It’s more specific. This was difficult for me, but Nu’s particular senses were something not all that uncommon amidst humans and tihfur... supposedly?” The starling digs into one of the leather pouches strapped to Grandpaw and pulls out a round ball—a firegrit explosive. “Gatherings of ether differ from each other. The Fire ether contained in one of our explosives might behave slightly differently compared to another. One may reach higher while another reaches further. Nu suggested this was the case for everything. Lands would quake because the Earth ether... felt a certain way.”

Makaal squints back at Mo before returning his attention to the path, keeping his eyes out for wayward signs of danger. “Would being able to tell how ether ‘feels’ make your crafting any better?”

Mo waves an arm in resignation. “I wish I could tell you.”

Makaal tightens his grip on Grandpaw’s barding. Heights have never really bothered him, but this wasn’t just the trail of a mountain pass, this might as well have been the literal top of the world. No matter how much the old sage might protest its veracity, nothing so far had dissuaded Makaal from the common wisdom of “lightning strikes that which is tallest.” To make matters worse the entire hollow seems to be a nursery for wrathbones—detestable creatures that make any region they inhabit their own personal oven.

Still, for all of his woes, what an incredible opportunity! Who else could claim to have visited the Thundering Peak? As if to answer his question, a morose roar bellows from the heart of the shrine. Deep below, the

Star Hunter clan can be seen attempting to subdue the immense form of Addax Uzem. Even in its exhausted state, a single wave of its head sends forth powerful bursts of elemental energy in every direction.

One such motion casts off a much brighter and menacing wave of energy. Uzem’s facet of destructive power—one heavily aspected to Fire. With a spiraling trail of pure anger and resentment, it razes its way out of the heartwood and up to the crown that had no opportunity to escape the avatar of its father’s rage. Makaal takes his opportunity, grips Mo to his side, and ushers Grandpaw back down beneath the scorching blasts ripping their way across the peak of the great tree.

Once more the merchant and his entourage are huddled together in the hollow of a bough in Uzem’s territory. He can’t help it—Makaal bursts into laughter at being trapped in this same situation once again. Grandpaw and Mo whirl on him in surprise.

“Mo, did I ever tell you how the trees outside the Thunder Mesa reproduce?” Makaal prompts. Mo shakes their head. “They reach a point in their lives where they dry out and become kindling for the next heat wave or lightning storm. Once they catch aflame, the wood pops and spreads their seeds across the savannah. I hadn’t really thought too much about it before now. Maybe that’s how they fight back against pests and vermin. They burn themselves, and everything within, before they’re eaten away.”

Setup



Take 4/8 ▶ Go to 30 ▶ Go to 45.

Victory Condition



Slay the Uzem's Fervor.

Round limit: 8

Challenges



- 1 During the end phase, Rovers must dim all non- dice in their personal and infusion pools.
- 2 Uzem's Fervor gains +1 to all of their attacks when occupying a .
- 3 At the beginning of round 2, and each round after that, when placing dice according to the Burning Bright special rules, place 3 dice instead of 2.

Special Rules



Burn Bright

Uzem's Fervor is burning away the corruption within its inner sanctum. The "Seat of Storms" is old and dense and will survive the flames, but you will not. Place a ether dice off the map above the column containing the starting flag icons and the columns immediately to the left and right. Treat all spaces in a column with a dice above it as containing a .

During the start phase of round 2, and each round after that, place two more ether dice off the map, above the columns that are immediately to the left of the current left most column with a ether dice above it.



In this way, a raging fire is traveling from the Rover spaces toward the fire ether node cluster.

Ether fields can still be placed into spaces that are affected by this special rule. A space containing any ether field tile ignores the effects of this special rule. However, if an ether field tile is removed from a space that would be affected by this special rule, treat that space as containing a again.

Terrain



Units that end their turn within 1 of this object suffer 1.



Units within 1 of this object gain +1 to the first attack they perform during their turn.

Codex Links



84

Immediately when Uzem's Fervor is slain, read "Basis Of Optimism", 42.

Manifold Is Their Kindred

Introduction

Mo pulls themselves into as tight a ball as possible. Jeering, screaming—violence in all directions.

“Just be small. You are not prey, you are just a rock adrift in the waves. Like Nu taught. Nu... why couldn’t you have stayed small? It’s okay, it’s okay. You’re with me now. I won’t let them take you away from me. I’m sorry.”

The bloodthirsty members of the Star Hunter clan charged over the coast without a care for self preservation, bolstered by the opening salvo rendered by their leader, the Eclipse. They had one goal: Kill anybody that crosses their path. All the better should it be their true prey of starlings—more ethereal cores ripe for the harvest.

Uzem’s body lies still—curled in on itself in pure exhaustion. The Star Hunter party cheers in triumph. With a commanding bark the leading stormcaller pushes his crew aside and steps up to begin harvesting his share of power from the prone addax. His face splits apart in a grin that reaches ear to ear as he prepares a crystal of ether to thrust into Uzem.

Shrieking, screaming—instant violence. The moment the stormcaller’s crystal touches Uzem’s hide, one of the addax’s Crucial conjurations materializes and burns away the human where he stands. In a flash, other facets charge through the sanctum, piercing every Star Hunter they come in contact with. Obliterating each and every one of the depraved humans with the power of the King of Storms fourfold; their bestial companions left with no recourse but to cower in the face of such overwhelming power.

You are content to remain held aloft with your hooks until the carnage subsides. Silky lowers himself to be audible over the raging flames, blustering winds, and rumbling walls. “More good news, more bad news. I think you can already guess as to what I consider the bad news—Uzem’s anima has gathered enough energy to manifest without a host. The good news is this

newfound corporeality means you should be able to damage them enough until they reintegrate with Uzem himself. You will... have your work cut out for you on that front.”

True to his word the four aspects of Uzem’s power are doing their utmost to merge back with the comatose addax. Each one trying to leap, charge, or swing their way into Uzem’s body—to little effect. Silky confirms that if the conjurations are dissipated, the energy should return back to the original host properly.

As each of you descends into the inner sanctum, the manifestations of Uzem’s power collectively regard you with unreadable intent. The winds that carry stress and excitement, the thunder that quakes with stubbornness and pride, the rain that begets sadness and ambition, the lightning that burns with rage and passion. These are the regents that comprise the King of Storms, and you shall be judged on their terms.

Setup



Take 4/8 ▶ Go to 31 ▶ Go to 46-47.

Victory Condition



Slay the King of Storms.

Round limit: 10

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Challenges



- 1 The King of Storms's attacks dim the ether dice that correspond to the icon on their standee in the personal and infusion pools of their target(s).
- 2 Adversaries are treated as occupying the positive ether fields that correspond to the King of Storms forms that are active.
- 3 Rovers are treated as occupying the negative ether fields that correspond to the King of Storms forms that are active.

Special Rules



Hail the King

The King of Storms is trapped in an ethereal conflux. You must tame all aspects of this conflux to free the King and restore the environment. The King of Storms has four forms, each with their own hit points, abilities, and traits. All four forms will have to be defeated to win this encounter.

The first form The King of Storms takes is randomly determined at the beginning of the encounter. Randomly stack one copy of , , , and tiles. Remove the top tile from the stack; this is the form The King of Storms takes. Spawn this form in the ether node space that matches its element.

For example, if is removed, spawn The King of Storms (Water) form in the water ether node space. Use The King of Storms standee with the water icon in the upper right corner, and use a normal one hex base.

Maintain this stack of ether field tiles, as this will be used again later in the encounter.



At the beginning of round 3, and each odd round after that, spawn another The King of Storms. To determine its form, remove the tile from the top of the stack created earlier.

All forms of The King of Storms add +X to each attack they perform, where X equals the number of The King of Storms forms that have been defeated.

Terrain



Units within 1 of this object gain +1 .



Units that end their turn within 1 of this object recover 1.



It costs units 1 additional movement point to enter a space within 1 of this object.



Units that end their turn within 1 of this object suffer 1.

Codex Links



85 Immediately when all four forms of The King of Storms are defeated, The King of Storms is slain, then read, “Never Forgives The Dreamer”, 42.

Chapter 3

A Consequence

Special Rules



Mo and Makaal

Open the Merchant level 3 deck and add it to the shop.

Adversary Ether Field

If you have the milestone “Vanquished the Absolute” marked on your campaign sheet, for Quest 5-6 mark  for  and  for .

If you have the milestone “Rejoined the King of Storms” marked on your campaign sheet, for Quest 5-6 mark  for  and  for .

Adventure

Before you embark on your next quest, you can travel to the Test of Mettle Arena. Proceed to page 68 of the campaign book.

Consequence



- A** If you have either of the milestones “Dispatched the Sovereign” or “Dispatched the Advocate” marked on your campaign sheet, it’s time to help the Yenshif.

Place the Alad Ahma sticker, A-6, onto the map.

Open up the quest box 1 / 6 and unpack the standees.

Proceed to page 84 of the campaign book.

- B** If you have the milestone “Subdued the Ahma” marked on your campaign sheet, it’s time to venture to the Crystal Caves.

Place the Crystal Cave sticker, C-5, onto the map.

Open up the quest box 2 / 5 and unpack the standees.

Proceed to page 72 of the campaign book.



Before Quest 5/6 • Intermission

Mind Of My Mind

Introduction

Scratchpad of Thought Caser Kivri — Recorded Exercises

“Stay focused, fighters! Feel the frost’s chill, the shiver sliding over skin. Steel yourself! Move forward, stay fast, stay firm. Vanquish fear, then visualize victory. Sift through the noise, sharpen those senses, then strike—swiftly, silently, surely.

Embrace the silence. The faintest frequency reveals everything. Feel the rhythm, the sensations of the field. Precision strikes slice through even the strongest shields. Save your strength—force, flow, ferocity.”

Makaal takes a shuddering breath as he scratches behind Grandpaw’s ears, eliciting pleased grunts from the arkenyn. The Rovers had completed another impossible task and Makaal wasn’t entirely sure what the future held as a result. Based on Silky’s behavior, the worst had yet to come, and Makaal felt as if he should at least try to contribute to the preparations.

The merchant reached down into an inner pocket of his cloak. After a few moments of digging, he felt what he was searching for, and pulled out a small, carved portion of chitin. Mo immediately twisted their attention toward Makaal and several of their tendrils seemed attracted to the chitin. “Silky!” the merchant called out, trying to draw the attention of the elder zusag away from his current round of scouting.

A few beats later the aeries glides into view. He descends upon Grandpaw’s head, to which the arkenyn chuffs and twitches his head ever so slightly in complaint. Makaal holds up the carved icon for Silky to inspect. “Call it a merchant’s intuition, but I feel as if things are about to get much more dangerous. Never let it be said I’m not prepared!”

Mo suddenly claps. “That’s a ration chit! It must be for a different clan though, as I don’t recognize the print. Why would you have one of those, Makaal?” the starling asks. Makaal’s face takes on a smug grin.

“I helped make a supply run for a clan that, if I remember right, is rather close by! This isn’t just any old ration chit; it’s the ‘call in a favor’ chit. The clan boasts about the skill of their Thought Caser.” Makaal turns to face the aeries, still wearing his smug expression. Silky leans forward to inspect the piece of chitin even closer.

“A keb rasska Thought Caser? Makaal, my boy, you would put a clan of the Mouth to absolute shame! This is an excellent idea, yes, yes, most excellent indeed! This is a perfect opportunity for our Rovers to stretch their legs even further. A full battle played out in a shared mental environment! No Claw-built sparring arena could ever hope to compare. Let us depart immediately!”

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Setup



Take Intermissions ▶ Go to 32 ▶ Go to 48-53.

Tiles: 3x Crumbling Columns

Victory Condition



Attempt to survive up to 3 waves of adversaries.

Round limit: 6

Challenges



- 1 Set the Round Limit to 5 for all waves.
- 2 You can't use items.
- 3 After wave 2 starts, during the end phase of each round, Rovers suffer 1.

Special Rules



Mind Palace

This encounter will see you battle up to three waves of adversaries to earn an increasing pool of lyst. There are a total of six possible waves you can fight and two ways to determine which wave you will take on.

First, you can reference the table on the next page and select which wave you would like to take on. You can only face each wave once.

Second, if you want an increased challenge, you can randomly determine which wave you will fight. To do this, stack one copy of , , , , , and tiles. Remove the top tile and reference the table below, spawning the wave that corresponds to the tile removed.



After you select which wave you will be facing, flip to the page in the adversary book listed in the leftmost column of the table on the next page, and follow the spawning rules.

There are six ether icons on the edges of the map that represent possible spawn locations throughout the encounter. When a wave is selected, spawn each adversary for the Rover count you are playing at. i.e. If you are playing with 4 Rovers, spawn all adversaries for 4 Rovers, 3 Rovers, and 2 Rovers. To do this, for each adversary roll an ether dice from the general pool, then spawn that adversary at the space with the ether icon corresponding to the icon that was just rolled.

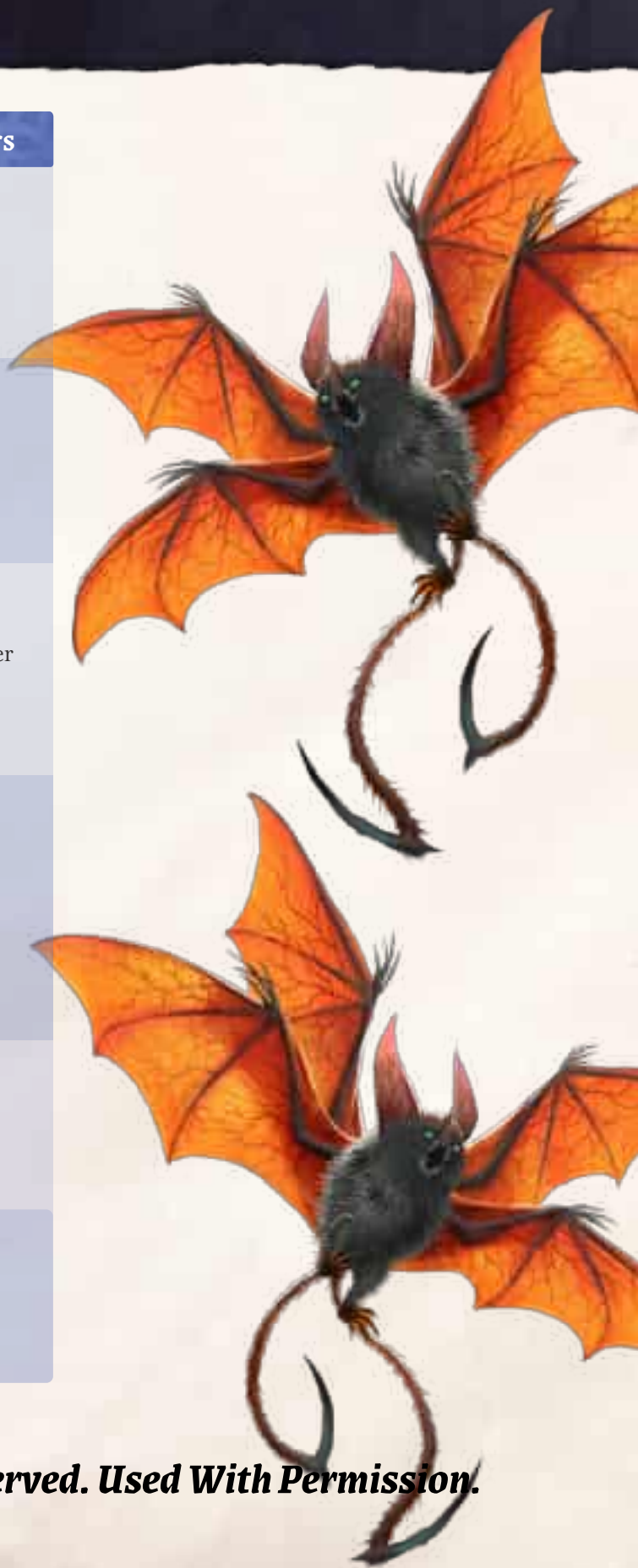
Lastly, there are several ether nodes around the map. When you spawn a wave of adversaries, place ether dice on these nodes that correspond to the ether field of the wave you just spawned. "That is, if you spawned the wave of adversaries, place ether dice onto the nodes. If there are ether dice already on these nodes, replace them with the new ether dice. If there is a non-flying unit on an ether node, move that unit to an unoccupied space as close as you can to the ether node.

Because this encounter takes place within your mind palace, any items consumed during battle will be returned at the end of the encounter.



Mind Of My Mind

Wave	2 Rovers	3 Rovers	4 Rovers
  Pg 48	Ashemak Ashemak Wrathbone Wrathbone Nahoot	Ashemak Ashemak Nahoot	Wrathbone Nahoot
  Pg 49	Briarwog Briarwog Onisski Onisski Sek Sek	Briarwog Onisski Sek	Briarwog Onisski Sek
  Pg 50	Zinix Zinix Bulwauros Bulwauros Grovetender Grovetender	Zinix Bulwauros Grovetender	Zinix Bulwauros Grovetender
  Pg 51	Streak Streak Streak Kifa Kifa Kifa Dekaha Dekaha	Streak Kifa Dekaha Dekaha	Streak Streak Kifa Kifa
  Pg 52	Terranape Gruv Dyad	Gruv Dyad	Terranape Dyad
  Pg 53	Sek Sek Nahoot Nahoot	Sek Nahoot	Sek Nahoot



Terrain



Non-flying units that enter a polluted pool space suffer ⚡ 1.



Units that trigger crumbling column traps suffer ⚡ 3.



Units that end their turn within ↗ 1 of this object suffer ⚡ 1.



Units that end their turn within ↗ 1 of this object recover ♥ 1.



It costs units 1 additional movement point to enter a space within ↗ 1 of this object.



Units within ↗ 1 of this object gain +1 🛡.



Units within ↗ 1 of this object gain +1 ⚡ to the first attack they perform during their turn.



Units within ↗ 1 of this object gain -1 ⚡ to the first attack they perform during their turn.

Codex Links



Q 178

Before the start of first round, read “**The Arena**”, 📖 85.

Q 179

At the end of the round where the first wave is defeated, read “**One down**”, 📖 85.

Q 180

At the end of the round where the second wave is defeated, read “**Two down**”, 📖 86.

Q 181

At the end of the round where the third wave is defeated, read “**Victory!**”, 📖 86.

Q 182

Immediately when all Rovers are downed or if you exceed the number of rounds for your current wave, read “**We were so close**”, 📖 87.

Quest 5

Problem of Our Laws

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Introduction

For a brief moment, a moment barely long enough to find rest within, everything in the eastern valley of Lalos is calm. The sky undarkened by creatures rife with corruption, the clouds withholding the heavy rains of late, the air mercifully still.

Grandpaw startles awake in a fit of wheezing and braying. Makaal is sent rolling from his sleep curled beneath the arkenyn. Mo moves to check on them but immediately crumples to the ground while clutching themselves. With the rest of you roused by the sudden commotion and already in battle stances, the threat will be met with force.

But another moment passes—there isn't a threat. Grandpaw is snarling upwards at an empty sky. Mo and Makaal are collecting themselves. What happened? As you all look around at your camp, the world grows quiet. No chirping, no buzzing, no calling. Grandpaw's rumbling is now a silent pantomime. Mo gesticulates wildly but nothing can be heard.

Another moment passes—now the world is chaos. A roar so loud, so dreadful, that each of you falls to the shaking ground. Your thoughts are rendered mute as the sound wraps around your bodies in a choking grasp. And then it stops. What should have been cause for every avian to take flight is met with complete and total submission as the skies remain empty and quiet. A fleeting sensation of fear and triumph punctuate the blanket of silence.

The valley takes in a collective breath and everything that should have happened occurs all at once. Avians screech their way into the air, the forests come alive with hoots and hollers, the rush of river waters returns, and a certain gleaming aerios comes into view.

Silky circles above the camp a few times before descending. "Curious. Most curious!" he chirps. "Would you believe me if I told you the past several minutes never happened?" Makaal scoffed as he helped Mo stand upright. "Well, I should be more clear. What you felt just now was true, but contained something of a... lie of omission." Silky continued. "There was no sound. No quake. Nothing happened here, but something did indeed happen. When you've come to your senses, break camp and we'll head for the eastern mountain peak as soon as possible—I'll explain on the way."

According to Silky, what happened in the valley was a mass-scale psychological assault. A manufactured set of sensations akin to what a keb could render using Morph, but across most of eastern Lalos. Silky was already on the edge of the effect range and noticed the discrepancy between what he was perceiving in the flesh versus what his shared senses with the conjuration reported.

The keb rasska clan that marched through the valley has apparently achieved whatever they came to this mountain range to accomplish—or, perhaps, just the two queens that lead the clan. In either case, you can only hope it's not too late to put a stop to it before it gets any more out of hand.

Campaign Link



Go to "A Poor Translation"  74.

A Poor Translation

Introduction

Silky keeps his flight path tight to your group as you ascend the strangely brittle mountain path. Where some parts of the trail are solid, others would see your march plunge straight through the soil. Despite the difficulty this adds to the hike, it also serves to help ground your travel as you suffer through more psychic assaults of varying strength. Anything that feels as if the ground is shaking is clearly a fiction being presented by your thoughts as the trail would be visibly collapsing were it a real quake. Whenever the sound leaves your voices, it is Silky's gleaming presence that helps guide the march onward towards caves that lead you down into the heart of the mountain.

Once the final incline is crested, a swathe of sparkling soldiers stand prepared to intercept your path. At their vanguard stands the tallest rasska among them; a stocky woman clad in the most resplendent of the crystalline armor they all share. She flashes a predatory grin and swings her arms wide, motioning with unrestrained bravado. "Thus she proclaimed! Femii, Great Sovereign, commanded this guard for assembly. Those that stand before us seek contest. Should there be further doubt of Femii's authority, this shall serve as proof! She surely sees everything." The large rasska woman finishes her proclamation with a heavy clap. Reverent whispers of "Sovereign" echo throughout the rest of the soldiers.

The speaker turns to examine each of you. "Slaughter them," she hisses. She spits violently at the ground in front of her before turning back to disappear into the caverns. A host of therans and entomans march forward to fill her position in the formation. Behind them the gleaming eyes of a Morphic controller focus unwaveringly upon you. In fact, not a single person or creature waiting ahead moves now that the large woman had departed.

Were it not for the visible signs of breathing, one might mistake them for warriors carved from stone. The Principle soldier at the rear stands absolutely motionless. The rasska crouched under him inching forward almost imperceptibly—all instinct purged from their expression but raw predatory urge. The footsoldiers and retinue of beasts are so bizarrely and singularly focused on your group that they don't even react to a lone Urn punching its way out of the loose soil right in the center of their formation.

In complete unison, every soldier raises a blade and the creatures raise their claws. All of them stalk forward together, everyone in perfect lockstep. All the more concerning is just how outrageous the sight is. The limbs of the therans dragging along as they fail to stride properly, the tails of the entomans churning dirt in their wake, the limbs of the keb rasska dangling uselessly at their sides.

Diplomacy is no longer an option.

Setup



Take 2/5 ▶ Go to 33 ▶ Go to 54-55.

Tiles: 3x Crumbling Columns

Victory Condition



Slay all adversaries, not including the urn.

Round limit: 8

Challenges



- 1 Bulwauros ignore the effect.
- 2 If a Rover deals 0 damage with an attack, place a in their space.
- 3 When rolling the damage dice for adversary attacks, treat a result of as +1 .

Special Rules



Mastered Beasts

Fight your way through the Keb Raska forces, slaying all adversaries to win. However, pay close attention to the bulwarous and wrathbone traits. While the Zisafi Principle is alive, the bulwarous and wrathbone are more resilient and deadly.

Terrain



Units that trigger crumbling column traps suffer 3.



Units that end their turn within 1 of this object suffer 1.



Units that end their turn within 1 of this object recover 1.

Codex Links



87

The first time a bulwarous is slain, read “Unknown Nourishment”, 44.

88

If the urn is slain, read “Letting Them Devour”, 44.

89

At the end of the round where all adversaries not including the urn are slain, read “Beyond a Certain Point”, 44.

A Cage in Search

Introduction

Where normally the scouting is done from above, as an unusual change of pace, Silky opts to lead your party through the spiraling and dense network of tunnels more directly. The clan's zisafi are relying purely upon Morphic fashions of detection, sensing for organic and mental activity, which render the zusag's sparkling aerios ironically undetectable as a disconnected proxy.

Significant construction decorates the inside of the mountain. While some of the tunnels are natural, many have been smoothed out and strutted, some connected forcefully with additional excavation, and many of the wider chambers contain full installations of caches, barracks, smithies, and more. The clan's operation here is no temporary affair—the construction is clearly intended to give way to a more permanent settlement.

Eventually you all spill out at the edge of a chamber that radiates with fluorescence bouncing around myriad crystalline growths. Not just growths on the walls either; there are massive entoman creatures whose shells are made entirely of the same crystals seen around the chamber. Based on how their limbs easily punch into the rock of the cavern walls, they are the source of at least some of the tunneling.

Towards the back of the chamber, a handful of poorly-equipped keb rasska can be seen angrily motioning and hissing at their fully-decorated zisafi minders. While too far to translate accurately, it's more than obvious that a disagreement of command is taking place based on the sharper words echoing around the walls. The

officers, gleaming with their pastel crystals, barely react to anything being said or signed by the lower-ranking members. After a few minutes of whispered-planning between yourselves and watching for any patrols that might discover your position, one of the grunts loudly interrupts all of the arguing and leaps at one of the implacable commanders, "THE SOVEREIGN LIES!"

Immediately the zisafi set upon the arguing sek with swift and precise action. Uninterested in further communication, the eyes of each officer flare with Morphic power as they seize control of the soldiers' bodies and force each of them into kneeling positions with their faces pressed into the dirt. After each zisafi has forced the argumentative faction into submission, they all suddenly rise in perfect unison.

It would seem that not everybody agrees with whatever is happening in this subterranean commune. You weren't going to make it through this chamber without a fight, but perhaps disrupting the psychic control of the commanding officers will leave you with a better chance. If nothing else they'll be too busy exercising their control over their underlings to attempt the same with you.

Setup



Take 2/5 ▶ Go to 34 ▶ Go to 56-57.

Tiles: 3x Crumbling Columns

Victory Condition



Slay all adversaries.

Round limit: 8

Challenges



- 1 Zisafi Taskmasters have +4 .
- 2 Seks gain +1 to all of their attacks.
- 3 Each time a Rover places an ether field in an enemy space, they place the same ether field in their own space.

Special Rules



Enslavement

For this encounter, seks represent a clan forced into enslavement by the cruel zisafi taskmasters. On the map each pairing of zisafi and sek are marked with an elemental icon as a note. Zisafi can command their specifically enslaved target. While the seks are part of the adversary faction, take note of their trait. They have a special defeat state. If the zisafi the sek is enslaved to is slain, that sek regains their wits and leaves the battlefield (they are defeated and removed from the map).

Keep track of the number of seks you are able to free from enslavement during this encounter.

Terrain



Units that enter or end their turn in fire suffers 1. Wrathbone ignores this effect.



Units that trigger crumbling column traps suffer 3.



Units within 1 of this object gain -1 to the first attack they perform during their turn.



Units that end their turn within 1 of this object recover 1.

Codex Links



90

The first time a skara is slain, read “Means of Intoxication”, 44.

91

At the end of the round where all adversaries are slain, read “Sleep-Walkers, Not Evildoers”, 45.

Apathetic, Witless, Fearful

Introduction

Kelo remembers a day after the conquest of their previous clan by the Ezmen Queens—

“Sister, speak of the past clan?” Kelo asked idly. Saras croaked for a moment. “Certain for this?” she prodded. Kelo waved an arm in assent. Saras let out a slightly longer croak this time, gathering her thoughts. “Sandstone was the clan that hatched us. Searing sands with calm winds. Cool shelter beneath the sun with the chambers that the clan created with bricks cast of the sand that carried us. Consider the scales that dress us; so much different than the others of Ezmen clan. This marks us as ilk of the sun and sands. Legacies of the ancestors that survived migration across those dangerous wastes. Scaleless folk even mixed with us! Though... can’t recall much of them.” Saras’ tail drew small pictures in the dust near Kelo, illustrating the single family of humans that had settled with the clan during her own childhood. He found that interesting and wondered what it would have been like to grow with them.

“Distantly beneath the sands—places that felt needless for the clan as sandcrafters—was the skara that slumbered, completely concealed. Could have gone countless generations without ever discovering it. The queens came with their clan. They... somehow recognized this, the slumbering skara. That was just after the season’s hatch, with cute little Kelo! Kept this cute mite for myself, called them brother. The parents felt sorry for the solitary skink called Saras.” she laughed, drawing a crude rendition of a tall pair of keb—Kelo’s birth parents. A small rasska jubilantly held up an even smaller keb next to them. He remembered fondly how often Saras would support him with her own body.

“The queens shredded the lands so they could expose the tunnels beneath. They found their quarry. Everything else was... incidental. Casualty. Scores of kifa, furious Gruv... The queens saw something with us, kept us safe, took us with them.” Saras shuddered, the twitching of her tail brushing her drawings aside. “Perhaps this was luck. Perhaps, misfortune.”

Saras looks on at her little brother and feels a swell of pride. While still small for his age, they both know now it was because he hadn’t had the chance to tap into his power. These days he’s shedding and growing constantly—his shell more lustrous with each day. Even now he is busy wielding Morph and bringing every creature in this chamber under his direction. The power of the skara to enhance Morphic communion is truly impressive. If she could match his progress in her own martial training, they would for sure earn the right to be labeled Toll Bearer. Perhaps they would even join Advocate Marii as another escort to Sovereign Femii! Saras isn’t so fond of the idea, but Kelo has his thoughts set on it, and so she will support him. She isn’t certain about the path the clan is taking. Many of her fellow officers have been so thoroughly weaved by Sovereign Femii that they resemble little more than toys she barely remembers from her youth.

Though... by now she and her brother have worked to further the goals of the clan too much to stop. This is to be their home now, forever more. Her brother and her have their orders. The Rovers can not be allowed to disrupt the clan’s construction. They will be put to the sword—stripped of scale and shell—as any other dissident would.

Setup



Take 2/5 ▶ Go to 35 ▶ Go to 58-59.

Tiles: 4x Crumbling Columns

Victory Condition



Slay Kelo and Saras.

Round limit: 8 ⌚

Challenges



- 1 Each time a Rover deals 3 or more with an attack, they drain an ether dice in their personal supply, if able to.
- 2 Skara have +2 .
- 3 Kelo takes two turns each round. Roll the ability dice to determine a new ability before Kelo's second turn.

Special Rules



Saras

Only Saras can be targeted for now. Kelo is attached to Saras and is using Saras to hide from your attacks. Kelo still takes turns each round. Perform all of Kelo's abilities from the Kelo and Saras standee

You will have to slay both Kelo and Saras to win this encounter. Once you slay Saras, you will get a chance to attack Kelo directly. Move quickly.

Terrain



Non-flying units that enter jagged crystals suffer 1.



Units that trigger crumbling column traps suffer 3.



Units that end their turn within 1 of this object recover 1.



Units within 1 of this object gain -1 to the first attack they perform during their turn.

Codex Links



92

Immediately after the action where Saras is slain, read “The Only Truth is Longing”, 45.

Fearless, Powerful, Surprising

Introduction

Marii grinds her teeth as she looks out over her perch at the Rovers assembling in the antechamber. She had hoped her sister's lieutenants could accomplish their one and only job when she left them at the mountain pass, but even that was too much. She spits out a broken fang and considers what options remain. Kelo and Saras were one of the stronger cards she had to play and it hadn't worked half as well as she had hoped. An unbidden sigh escapes her lips as she thinks about the sibling pair. She isn't sure how much longer Femii needed to coax the svaraka from its cocoon, but she would put down every last chip to make it happen. Surely it was going to break free soon, how else could she explain the headache threatening to pop her skull?

She examines the soldiers left to her command. A claw of her best martial warriors, a fin of Femii's dedicated mentalists, and a few skara hatchlings besides to bolster the mentalists' influence. At this point she trusted the zisafi to keep to their own devices, but she wouldn't hesitate to slaughter them should they try to pull any of their tricks on her own platoon. Femii has eyes and ears everywhere now, but Marii had been clear that her personally trained soldiers were to fight on their own terms.

She and her retinue are as well-equipped as could be managed in the short time the clan has been in this mountain. The upper echelon of the clan had all grown quite greedy and petty amongst themselves once the skara hive was confirmed to be real and fully uncovered. Femii had quashed that particular train of thought quite brutally and given Marii full command over the armory. Where her sister had forever sought the material for its Morphic-focusing capabilities, Marii is just as satisfied with its physical prowess in both offense and defense.

Ezmenite would be the solution to everything. Femii could train and work alongside her host of mentalists to use it to subdue the manic creatures of Chorus, and Marii would ensure each member of their soon-to-be-world-spanning clan could have a suit of armor as full and resplendent as her own. Maybe then she could convince her sister to stop shattering the minds of those who didn't see the world as they did.

Before Marii can finish collecting her thoughts and arrange a proper strategy against the Rovers opposing her, something at the back of her mind twinges and the zisafi supporting her troupe immediately draw their weapons and begin stalking forth. It would seem her sister has grown even more impatient. That is something else Marii had never been quite able to help her sister with throughout their lives. It was going to be very important for the Sovereign to be capable of dealing with her subjects with a... level scale.

Setup



Take 2/5 ▶ Go to 36 ▶ Go to 60-61.

Victory Condition



Slay Marii.

Round limit: 8

Challenges



- 1 Her People Love Her triggers when Marii has suffered 12, 24, 36, and 48 damage. This does mean more sek and zisafi spawn at all Rover counts.
- 2 Adversaries gain +1 while within 0-1 of a .
- 3 Rovers trigger the effects of while within 0-1 of the tile and Rovers cannot replace with a different ether field.

Special Rules



Crystalline Armor

Marii is armored in resplendent crystalline and nearly unassailable.

Marii has R tokens on her statistic block. These tokens are not discarded at the beginning of her turn.

Crystalline Spears

Seks and zisafi have been equipped with crystalline spears, empowering their attacks (this is reflected in their stat blocks).

When a Rover slays a sek or zisafi, that Rover gains a Crystalline Spear. To indicate this, place a hoard tile on your class board.

Each time a Rover attacks, you may remove one crystalline spear (hoard tile) from your class board to gain +1 to that attack. After attacking Marii using a crystalline spear, remove one token from her statistic block.

She Loves her People

Marii loves her people and will avenge them when slain.

Each time a sek or zisafi are slain, place one dice on Marii's statistic block.



When there are R dice on Marii's statistic block, remove R dice (return them to the general pool) and place a on her statistic block.

Her People Love her

Marii's people will rush to their queen's side in her time of need.

After the turn where Marii has suffered a total of 18, 36, and 54 damage, spawn one sek and one zisafi at 2 from Marii, closest to the fire ether node.

This means adversaries will spawn once for 2 Rovers, twice for 3 Rovers, and three times for 4 Rovers

Terrain



Non-flying units that enter jagged crystals suffer 1.



Units that end their turn within 1 of this object suffer 1.



Units within 1 of this object gain -1 to the first attack they perform during their turn.

Codex Links



Immediately when Marii is slain, read “No Salvation Should Come”, 46.

More Worthless Than Freedom

Introduction

Years of work. Years of suffering. Years of wrangling thoughtless brutes from fin to foot every step of the way. Finally FINALLY I can begin. You are Rovers. You should know the pains of your lessers not understanding! You can share in my relief at no longer having to convince imbeciles to accept what's good for them. I can simply force them to see! Allow me to erase the weight of your responsibilities.

EXASPERATION

SUPERIORITY

PLEASURE

The keb perched atop the titanic creature effortlessly weaves her thoughts through your own. Before you are swept away in the undercurrent of her emotional broadcast, a great echoing howl brings you to your senses. Grandpaw gallops his way back into the chamber, a flailing Mo and Makaal in tow. Held aloft in Mo's tendrils are various rough slabs of ezmenite, each covered in gleaming Crux runework and riveted with leather straps.

Makaal leaps off Grandpaw and hurriedly secures a slab to each of you using the straps. He speaks rapidly as he works, trying to relay the information imparted to him by Mo and Silky, but he stumbles and stammers over much of it as he fearfully shifts his vision back and forth from you to the massive creature within spitting distance. As he secures the last of the slabs to himself he offers you a bow and a prayer. As Makaal steers Grandpaw back into the tunnels away from the monumental creature, Silky reappears.

"I cannot say for certain that these warding plates will perform as needed. I will do my best to stay within proximity to bolster the glyphs impressed upon them. This whole endeavor has been... quite strange for me, disembodied as I currently am!" Silky chirps. "The keb woman is using the creature's carapace to amplify her Morphic control. We can also use it to stymie her locally, but we're going to have to solve the... bigger issue. I suspect she's been molding the creature since it first

hatched. Separating them should be the first order at hand; it should disrupt their synchronicity and shutter the noetic resonance. That's... a tall order, however." Despite his humorous tone, even Silky couldn't hide his unease.

As it stands the only way forward is up—up the spine of a mind-bogglingly huge creature. Sheer climbs are nothing new by now, but climbing generally doesn't involve a moving surface. The immense proportions of the beast mean that the idle motion of its tail brings it in and out of the chamber entirely, loudly scraping along the inner walls of the entire cavern. It's a dangerous approach but should offer the quickest and simplest route to begin your endeavor to take down the Sovereign.

SURPRISE

ANGER

ANNOYANCE

Insolence. Impudence. So be it. If you would debase yourselves to literally crawl among my scales as some meager parasites, allow me to show you just how insignificant you truly are. Perhaps the change in perspective will help you to see reason in the futility of your resistance.

Your bodies are immediately pinned to the crystals that comprise the immense beast's carapace. The force of wind whistling around you threatens to render you insensate. All around you the mountain is literally collapsing. Boulders scatter off of the creature as though they were pebbles in a dust storm. Each impact threatens to dislodge you from your perches with the force of the tremors resonating off of each stalagmite of the leviathan.

After a few moments, the wind pressing against your bodies settles from organ-crushing to merely deafening. With a consistent atmosphere you can all rise from your crumpled positions to a steady balance along the monster's hide. Keeping that balance is now the most important priority—the beast has broken free of the entire mountain and is now gliding far, far above Lalos. Everything you are fighting for; so easily obscured beneath the enormity of the Sovereign's mount.

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Setup



Take 2/5 ▶ Go to 37 ▶ Go to 62.

Victory Condition



Slay the Svaraka.

Round limit: 7

Challenges



- 1 Ignore the gruv's trait. It gains +3 .
- 2 Femii has +R*4 .
- 3 The Svaraka's abilities lose the **On Advance** mechanic. This means the Svaraka takes its turns normally, performing its abilities immediately.

Special Rules



The Svaraka

This is a 3 phase encounter. Each phase has its own round limit.

Crystal Nerves

You are on the back of the Svaraka and must ground the creature first in order to defeat it.

The crystal objects on this map are crystal nerves. You will need to destroy R of them to advance to the next map and progress the encounter. Place a dice on each crystal object. Units in the Rover faction can target crystal objects as if they were enemies. They have 4 and 4 each. Once a crystal nerve has been destroyed, remove the dice from it to represent its destruction. A crystal without a dice is treated as an open space.

Terrain



Non-flying units that enter jagged crystals suffer 1.



Units that end their turn within 1 of this object recover 1.



Units within 1 of this object gain -1 to the first attack they perform during their turn.

Codex Links



95

At the end of the round where R crystal nerves have been destroyed, read “**Control Me Without Pause**” 47.

Quest 6

The Tell-Tale Heart

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Introduction

O, spectral choir of grief and shade, in this dark serenade conveyed

The messengers, with wings so black, in harmony with death's cold track.

Gray, pallid, sombre. What should be a forest of deep greens and flashes of vibrant chromatics instead falls to the color of stone and decay. Even the sound of twigs and dead leaves crunching underfoot feels muffled, lending to an unnatural sense of stillness. A morose serenity blankets the woods as pitch-black nektari flutter amidst the trees.

Grandpaw, always with his nose for trouble, rears back in sudden shock. His snout practically peeled back on itself as he snarls and swipes furiously at his nose, literally working to beat back the scent that just assaulted him. Eventually it reaches the rest of your group; a fiercely pungent smell that reeks of noxious waste and spoilage. Nothing stands out as the obvious source of the olfactory offense. On one side of the trees, it smells only of dirt and leaves. On the other, something that only brings hurt to mind.

Silky led your party back east to the Taharik after your last undertaking, where the tihfur messenger visited you shortly after your departure from the Seat of Storms. While some guilt lingers at not immediately diving into the request, the entire forest could have easily been ruined had the Ezmen queens managed to escape the mountains with those immense creatures under their control. The colorless keb, who fashioned herself sovereign of all, may have had even worse things in mind.

Unfortunately, it means that other concerns are now spilling forth into and out of the Taharik. Sable avians are occasionally seen breaking through the forest's canopy—the shaking and falling of distant trees following after. Were it not for the light produced by the presence of Silky's conjuration, your trek would seem unnaturally dark. Despite the sun's best efforts its rays find trouble penetrating the murk that now grips the entirety of the Taharik.

You are not welcome here.

Campaign Link



Go to “**Into That Darkness Peering**”  86.

Into That Darkness Peering

Introduction

Less “bubbling” and more “gurgling” are the sounds of the nearby stream, if it can still be called that. Its water heavy and black—the entire surface rendered completely opaque. Mo, Makaal, and Grandpaw have taken up the march at the rear at what they hope will be a safe distance. One of the aimless nektari has drifted close enough to Mo for them to capture with one of their tendrils. Uncharacteristically, its first response is one of physical violence, rather than the traditional response of spore-casting. After being released in surprise the entoman returns to its haphazard flight through the trees. “Morph,” Mo begins. “The creature was practically bursting with Morphic ether.”

By now the literal buzzing of their hives can be heard clearly, which means it’s time for the merchants to find safety as your survey begins in earnest. Normally a region home to tihfur clans would have regular patrols and wildlife-culling before overgrowth could create a dangerous environment. The level of neglect here speaks to years of deterioration, which makes absolutely no sense. It’s been days; weeks at worst.

Before you and Silky can get lost in a debate about the reason for the shocking amount of regrowth, an entire copse of rotten trees wrenches itself from the ground and moves along the brackish stream, stealing your attention entirely. A grovetender, though its countenance is entirely wrong. Grovetenders are silvans that style themselves as carnivorous predators in an effort to protect the pollinators that keep their bodies healthy and promote reproduction. This behemoth specimen looks neither healthy nor much like a silvan any longer.

With each quaking step it takes, the other silvans react in tandem. Slow undulations become frantic writhing as the grovetender ambles and draws forth more polluted water into itself. The pale weeds also seem to bear only a faint resemblance to thriving dekaha. It feels as if the entire grove has fallen to some strange delirium. When you draw too close to one of the larger trees, the dekaha’s natural sensations finally discover your existence. Their vines arc and prime to defend their territory. Simultaneously the massive grovetender begins crashing its way through dying trees towards you.

Were the scene not so morbid, it would be almost quaint. This is exactly the kind of task you were trained for as Rovers.

Setup



Take 1/6 ▶ Go to 40 ▶ Go to 66-67.

Tiles: 3x Hatchery, 1x Nektari Hive

Victory Condition



Slay Hokmala.

Round limit: 8

Challenges



- 1 While the Corrupted Nektari Hive is on the map, at the start of each adversary phase, spawn R corrupted nektari swarms within 1 of it.
- 2 Dekahas gain +2 .
- 3 Terranapes always gain the benefit of their threshold augments.

Terrain



Non-flying units that enter a polluted pool space suffer 1.



An incredibly deadly river of poisonous sludge runs through the map. Poisoned water spaces have a white border and follow all the rules of open air spaces.



Units that trigger hatchery traps suffer 3.



It costs units 1 additional movement point to enter a space within 1 of this object.



Units within 1 of this object gain -1 to the first attack they perform during their turn.



Corrupted Nektari Hives are special objects and have R*2 .

Codex Links



100

If the Corrupted Nektari Hive is destroyed, read “Dipped in Folly”, 50.

101

Immediately when Hokmala is slain, read “All The Night Tide”, 50.

Atmosphere of Sorrow

Introduction

“HE’LL MAKE YOU ANYTHING YOU WISH TO BE!”

A crowd of tihfur stalk their way through the trees of the grove. Some laugh, others dance, and a few even try to sing. The words are choking and halted; their throats caught between their avian shifting. Most of them are focused on a woman towards the far end of the settlement. She screeches and swings violently at any who draw close.

This lone villager seems worse off than the notably twisted members of her faction attempting to surround her. Her wiry frame is corded in broken feathers and stretches of oozing hide where the shifting seems to have gone awry. Her left side is covered in skin-carvings that pulse with potent Morph ether. The muscles writhe and are unable to fully settle on one side of her shift or the other. With each pulse of her heart the blanket of miasma flowing through the forest roils —spreading further.

A few of the tihfur leaping through the trees make a point of letting the ether wash over their bodies. Each one takes a manic delight as it causes their entire body to twitch unnaturally. Mouths peeled back in ecstasy, wings fluttering in joy, talons ripping at their feathers in a daze. All of it a disturbing scene to say the least. This is nothing like the more primal rituals that tihfur clans engage in; this is simply madness given physical shape.

“String me up to bleed,” Silky curses. “Is this what has become of the Yanshif clan? How in the world could things have grown so dire so quickly?!”

His utterance kills the jubilations of the crowd of monstrous tihfur instantly. Besides the frantic woman at the outer reach, every last member (regardless of where they stood or perched) slowly turns to face you in unison. Every trio of eyes is on you. Each visage on display is curled in visible disgust.

“A MYSTERY OF MYSTERIES!” “FRESH MEAT!”
“PLUCK AND STRIP!” “THEIR BODIES SING!”

A cacophony of squawking cries and jeers explode through the clearing. Their emotional outbursts fill the air as they descend upon you. Even the wildlife seems caught up in their temper as malformed streaks, kifa, and even a premature rakifa demolish the branches of trees to join the fray. This spread of Morph is pressing the entire forest into rapid and distorted development at the cost of its natural vitality.

Setup



Take 1/6 ▶ Go to 41 ▶ Go to 68/69.

Tiles: 4x Hatchery, 2x Nektari Hive

Victory Condition

Slay all adversaries.

Round limit: 8 ⌚

Challenges

- 1 Zeepurah will always attack Rovers if they are within range of her attacks.
- 2 Treat kifa as occupying a 🟡. This is a permanent effect.
- 3 At the end of each round, Rovers must flip one ether dice in either their personal or infusion pool to its 🌀 face.

Special Rules

The Yanshif

Zeepurah has been consumed by corrupting hatred. She is feral, attacking all creatures she perceives as enemies, including you, but all may not be lost. Zeepurah is part of her own faction, The Yanshif, which is an enemy to both the Rover and Adversary factions. Units a part of the Yanshif faction follow all the adversary logic rules found in the rule book. This faction gains priority after the Adversary faction has gone.

You may be able to save Zeepurah from the corruption. The encounter is over when all adversaries are slain. If Zeepurah is the last remaining enemy on the map, the encounter will end and she will still be alive. You may want to pursue this effort, though it will be challenging.

Though Zeepurah is indeed your enemy, you can still target her with positive effects, such as healing actions.

Terrain



Non-flying units that enter a polluted pool space suffer ⚡ 1.



Units that trigger hatchery traps suffer ⚡ 3.



Units within ↗ 1 of this object gain +1 🛡️.



Units within ↗ 1 of this object gain -1 ⚡ to the first attack they perform during their turn.



Corrupted Nektari Hives are special objects and have R*2 ❤️.

Codex Links

🔍 100

Each time a Corrupted Nektari Hive is destroyed, read “Dipped in Folly”, 📖 50.

🔍 102

If Zeepurah is slain, read “Into the Sepulchre”, 📖 50.

🔍 103

At the end of the round where all adversaries are slain, read “Eulalie”, 📖 51.

Like a Shattered Mirror

Introduction

Every step deeper into the Taharik comes with some sort of added challenge. Unstable footing, gnarled tree roots, shrouds of Morphic spores, pools of muck and grime. Requiring even more care is the swirling moat of rancid Morph essence surrounding the ruins of a tihfur village. Displaced soil and collapsed trees give you a viable crossing, but its presence is deeply unsettling, and not even your ether-fortified bodies would withstand a plunge into its depths for very long.

Many of the homes that were once suspended in the treetops now lie shattered and broken in heaps on the forest floor. Rotten timber surrounds the ruins having either pierced or become buried in the wreckage of the hovels. Distressed tihfur monstrosities shuffle through the village, kicking at fallen carvings or digging through mounds of garbage.

Swirling overhead and haranguing the tihfur are faintly glowing beings of pure Morph. Each time they make contact with one another, the malformed starlings begin to screech uncontrollably as the tihfur pulls away and cackles. Silky gasps and lets out a stream of curses, more quietly than before. “Broken Vessels... that’s what Mo was sensing. I’ll put it this way; the only place, literally the only place, that we know of their appearance is the Unsouled Barrens. Which means to see them not only outside of the Barrens, but this far from it, suggests dire circumstances. We must hurry, Rovers. Time is very much not with us here.”

Silky performs a quick flying survey and circles back to point out areas in the village worth investigating. He urges you to find the potential source of the Morphic surge, suggesting that it may have originated here within the Yanshif’s now-broken homes. Silky emphasizes the importance of time, and that no matter what you discover, you cannot stay here as the concentration of Morph is growing and poses too substantial a risk to everyone’s bodies.

Setup



Take 1/6 ▶ Go to 42 ▶ Go to 70-71.

Tiles: 4x Hoards

Victory Condition



Search Taharik for relics that contain deep memories and return to a space.

Round limit: 8

Challenges



- 1 Remove the hoard tile from the rubble closest to the starting spaces. The Haunt has taken something of value. When it is slain, follow the **Lost Memories** special rule.
- 2 If there are 2 Rovers, the round limit is 7. If there are 3 or 4 Rovers, the round limit is 6. This changes the trigger event for the codex link “A People Lost”.
- 3 Adversaries that attack an enemy occupying a gain +1 to that attack.

Special Rules



The Yanshif

Zeepurah has been consumed by corrupting hatred. She is feral, attacking all creatures she perceives as enemies, including you, but all may not be lost.

Check your campaign log, if “Zeepurah was slain.” is recorded, do not set up Zeepurah at the beginning of the encounter and the remainder of this special rule is not active.

Zeepurah is part of her own faction, The Yanshif, which is an enemy to both the Rover and Adversary factions.



Units a part of the Yanshif faction follow all the adversary logic rules found in the rule book. This faction gains priority after the Adversary faction has gone.

Though Zeepurah is indeed your enemy, you can still target her with positive effects, such as healing actions.

You may be able to save Zeepurah from the corruption in a later encounter if you're able to find all three relics.

Lost Memories

The hoard tiles represent the remnants of the Yanshif people. To loot these hoard tiles, a Rover has to end their turn on the hoard tile.

The contents of hoard tiles are randomly determined. To do this, at the beginning of the encounter stack one copy of , , , , , and tiles. When a hoard tile is looted, remove the top tile of this stack and reference the Codex Links on the next page, reading the link with the icon of the ether field tile removed.

Consumed by Corruption

Taharik has been lost to the Ahma's corruption. There are six ether icons on the bottom edge of the map. These icons represent possible spawn locations throughout the encounter.

When an adversary is slain, place it off to the side of the map on its side. During the start phase, for each adversary that is both off to the side and flipped vertically, roll an ether dice from the general pool, then spawn that adversary at the space with the ether icon corresponding to the result that was just rolled. Then, for each adversary that is both off to the side and placed on its side, flip them vertically.



Like a Shattered Mirror

Terrain



Non-flying units that enter a polluted pool space suffer 1.



An incredibly deadly river of poisonous sludge runs through the map. Poisoned water spaces have a white border and follow all the rules of open air spaces.



Units within 1 of this object gain +1 .



Units within 1 of this object gain -1 to the first attack they perform during their turn.

Codex Links



106

If the haunt is slain, read “Grains of the Golden Sand”, 52.

107

If was removed, read “While I Weep”, 52.

108

If was removed, read “How They Creep”, 52.

109

If was removed, read “To The Deep”, 52.

110

If was removed, read “A Tighter Clasp”, 52.

111

If was removed, read “Binds Me Still”, 52.

112

If was removed, read “Of Good and Ill”, 53.

113

If Zeepurah is slain, read “The Stars Never Rise”, 53.

114

If during round 8 all Rovers end the Rover phase on an entrance space without having collected all three relics, read “Can Ever Dissever My Soul”, 53.

115

If all Rovers end any Rover phase on an entrance space with all three relics collected, read “Feel the Bright Eyes” 54.



The Pitiless Wave

Introduction

Marshes aren't known for smelling nice even without undue contamination. Waste. Decay. Rot. Death. A festering cauldron whose contents cling to the air itself long before anything can think to sample its vile brew. Each step ejects more of the foul haze upwards. Carried on the wind is a palpable force that presses upon you and leaves your voices hoarse. Tears well up in Grandpaw's eyes but he doesn't give voice to his suffering—likely in the hopes of not inhaling more of the fetid air than necessary.

This marsh stands as the border between the Taharik and the southernmost swamp along the coast of Lalos. Normally it would be where the tihfur clan would hunt intruders and harvest reagents from its fertile wetland. Today it is an open-air sepulcher, festooned in the adornments of the briarwog brood that calls it home. Decaying silvans add their own splash of sickly color to the vista.

Pulsating stone masses crest the surface of the swamp waters at the far end of the marsh. An immense briarbull presides over the rotten cesspools, his hide mired in violet and ebony hues, his spines dripping with a venom no doubt all the worse for the inclusion of the Morphic miasma. A lone briarbull rutting in a single marsh couldn't be the source of this wilde-spread pollution, but slaying it is a boon to anything that enjoys breathing clean air and drinking clean water.

Setup



Take 1/6 ▶ Go to 43 ▶ Go to 72-73.

Tiles: 1x Nektari Hive

Victory Condition



Slay Zipahudi the Briarbull.

Round limit: 8

Challenges



- 1 Zeepurah will always attack Rovers if they are within range of her attacks.
- 2 Zipahudi gains +2 movement points to all of their movement actions and their passive gains +1 . When Zipahudi moves, it wants to move within 1 of the most enemies that it can.
- 3 When rolling the damage dice for a Rover attack, treat a result of as -1 .

Special Rules



The Yanshif

Zeepurah has been consumed by corrupting hatred. She is feral, attacking all creatures she perceives as enemies, including you, but all may not be lost.

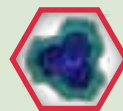
Check your campaign log, if “Zeepurah was slain.” is recorded, do not set up Zeepurah at the beginning of the encounter and the remainder of this special rule is not active.

Zeepurah is part of her own faction, The Yanshif, which is an enemy to both the Rover and Adversary factions. Units a part of the Yanshif faction follow all the adversary logic rules found on page X in the rule book. This faction gains priority after the Adversary faction has gone.

Though Zeepurah is indeed your enemy, you can still target her with positive effects, such as healing actions.

If you have all 3 relics from encounter 6.3 - “**Like a Shattered Mirror**”, you gain an optional **Victory Condition** for this encounter. Read “**Dream Within a Dream**”, (page 54).

Terrain



Non-flying units that enter a polluted pool space suffer 1.



An incredibly deadly river of poisonous sludge runs through the map. Poisoned water spaces have a white border and follow all the rules of open air spaces.



Corrupted Nektari Hives are special objects and have R*2 .



Units within 1 of this object gain -1 to the first attack they perform during their turn.

Codex Links



117

Each time a Corrupted Nektari Hive is destroyed, read “**Dissemble no More**”, 55.

118

If Zeepurah is slain, read “**Hope Has Flown Away**”, 55.

121

Immediately when Zipahudi is slain, if Zeepurah was slain at any point during this quest, read “**They Can Only Shriek**”, 57.

119

Immediately when Zipahudi is slain, if Zeepurah is alive and if dice were not placed onto each of the drained ether nodes, read page “**Agony of Desire**”, 56.

Illimitable Dominion Over All

Introduction - Ahma Corrupted

*So heed the call of midnight's choir,
And shun the miasma's ghastly mire,
For in its grip where shadows dwell,
One might be lost within the spell.*

Two monstrous avian creatures squat in the middle of the swamp atop a mound of gathered corpses. You see streaks with their necks twisted, briarwogs with their limbs shredded, terranape with their legs crushed, and plenty of other indeterminate prey mixed between. Squelching, sloshing, slurping. Enjoying their banquet of rotten flesh, the two monsters wear similar expressions of delight.

One of the pair is truly massive. A cloak of manifold wings spans from shoulder to tail, each one cast in razor pinions. A naked skull protrudes from its spine, its ivory length splattered in the fluids of its kills. Three eyes of pride, fever, and adoration trail from its meals to the partner it shares them with. Every so often it preens the smaller of the pair, who must be the woman you pursued here, which involves ripping free one of her pin-feathers in a spray of ichor that coats them both.

Circling the scene is a host of broken vessels, each adding their "voice" to the cacophony of birdsong emanating from the monstrous pair. Their tendrils undulate wildly as they heedlessly crash into one another. For all of the viciousness they demonstrated in the village, they seem much less distressed amidst this macabre display.

Mo holds out their limbs and their tendrils sway in the putrid, but placid, breeze. "That's... words fail to describe just how strange this flow of ether is. That large beast is for certain the source of the chaos. There's... something flows between the tihfur. I think it's weakening itself to empower its mate. Please, exercise caution, Rovers."

Introduction - Ahma Enraged

*Over the land a curse was cast,
A silent echo from the past,
And as the black birds took their flight,
They bore away the waning light.*

**"MY MUSE,
WHAT HAVE YOU DONE,
I CANNOT FINISH THE SONG,
HOW CAN WE LEAD THE FLOCK?"**

In the depths of the swamp stands a monstrous ashen avian. Their long tail lashes out into the dark, the sharp feathers along its length casually shredding the brittle flora surrounding it. A pale skull with three eyes of wrath, woe, and despair survey their surroundings. The monster twists its skull unnaturally, adding percussive snapping and popping to the sounds of its screeching Yanshif cohort.

**"HEAR ME,
LISTEN TO MY SONG."**

Shrieking tones emanate from the hollow visage of the monster. The collected Yanshif fall one after the other in reverent bows. Miasma flows into each of them, their bodies beginning to swell and their plumage taking on a new sheen of gleaming ebony. Fluttering nektari descend in droves to add their own wingbeats to the undulant dirge.

**"WE ARE AHMA,
YOU ARE NOT WELCOME!"**

A whirlwind of razor-sharp feathers explodes across the swamp. Every member of the procession screams as their bodies are assaulted by the energy that rends the flesh from their bodies to build upon the creeping cloud. Your only choice now is to fight against the chaos made manifest.

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Introduction - Ahma Desperate

*Each rustle in the spectral gloom,
Foretold of tales within the tomb,
And shadows danced with twisted grace,
As darkened fate worked to interlace.*

Frantic splashes erupt in the midst of the swamp. A bleached skull with three eyes of worry, fear, and regret are cast upon you. The skull clatters and wobbles with uncertainty, as it searches for something within you. Whatever the monster seeks, it is not here, and it proceeds to slam its face into the brackish fluid below. Gurgles and pops echo through the swamp as the fluid fills the hollow spaces of the skull. When it resurfaces, a briarwog is held between its massive beak. A vicious snap rends the creature asunder as its innards are consumed by the grotesque abomination.

**“WHERE IS MY MUSE?
WHAT HAVE YOU DONE?”**

The source of the chaos lies here at the heart of the swamp. What was once tihfur is now only scourge, blanketing the region in an endless plume of Morph. There is some hope—the ritual you enacted has had a clear effect on the environment. While the waters of the swamp immediately surrounding the beast are brackish and dark, they take on a more natural green the further away one looks. Even the ever-present nektari seem to have recovered some faint hues of color to their bodies.

Mo nods as they curl their tendrils around themselves. “It is as I said. Resonance was the key. The Morph was connecting their bodies; trapping the ether elsewhere has reduced its influence.” Silky quietly congratulates the starling. They depart back towards the marsh where Makaal and Grandpaw remain, leaving you to contend with the ailing heart of the stagnant force.

**“Z E E P U R A H,
I B E G Y O U,
G I V E M E Y O U R S O N G !”**

Illimitable Dominion Over All

Setup



Take 1/6 ▶ See special rules ▶ See special rules.

Tiles: 4x Hatchery

Victory Condition



Slay the Ahma.

Round limit: 10

Challenges



1 Adversaries are immune to the effects of morph nodes. Rovers can not take ether dice from morph nodes, and are affected by them when within 1-2.

2 The Ahma gains +1 .

3 Adversaries gain +1 to their attack when targeting an enemy that occupies .

Special Rules



The Yanshif

The state of Zeepurah changes the profile you will use for the Ahma during this encounter.

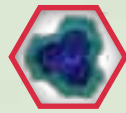
Check your campaign sheet milestones, if “Zeepurah was slain” is marked, proceed to page 74 of the adversary book, page 44 of the map book.

Check your campaign sheet milestones, if “Zeepurah was contained” is marked, proceed to page 75 of the adversary book, page 45 of the map book.

Check your campaign sheet milestones, if “Zeepurah was lost” is marked, proceed to page 76 of the adversary book, page 46 of the map book.

Though Zeepurah is indeed your enemy, you can still target her with positive effects, such as healing actions. This encounter will be easier if you slay her, but it is not required to win.

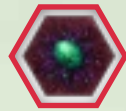
Terrain



Non-flying units that enter a polluted pool space suffer 1.



An incredibly deadly river of poisonous sludge runs through the map. Poisoned water spaces have a white border and follow all the rules of open air spaces.



Units that trigger hatchery traps suffer 3.



Units within 1 of this object gain -1 to the first attack they perform during their turn.

Codex Links



122

If Zeepurah is slain, read “In a Mad Expostulation”, 58.

125

Immediately when Ahma (Enraged) is slain, read “A Horror They Outpour”, 59.

124

Immediately when Ahma (Desperate) is slain, read “The Palpitating Air”, 59.

126

Immediately when Ahma (Corrupter) is slain, if Zeepurah was slain, read “Evil is a Consequence of Good”, 60.

123

Immediately when Ahma (Corrupter) is slain, if Zeepurah is alive, read “A Clamorous Appealing”, 58.



Chapter 4

A Consequence

Special Rules



Mo and Makaal

Open the Merchant level 4 deck and add it to the shop.

Adversary Ether Field

If you have the milestone “Conquered the Svaraka” marked on your campaign sheet, for Quest 7-9 mark for and for .

If you have the milestone “Zeepurah was slain”, “Zeepurah was contained”, or “Zeepurah was lost” marked on your campaign sheet, for Quest 7-9 mark for and for .

Adventure

Before you embark on your next quest, you can travel to Kaleido Caldera. Proceed to page 102 campaign book.

Consequence



- A** If you have the milestone “Rejoined the King of Storms” marked on your campaign sheet, it’s time to venture into the Bone Wastes.

Place the Bonespire sticker, B-3, onto the map.

Open up the quest box 3 / 6 and unpack the standees.

Proceed to page 105 of the campaign book.

If you have the milestone “Vanquished the Absolute” marked on your campaign sheet, it’s time to travel to Uzem’s Shrine.

Place the Uzem’s Shrine sticker, D-7, onto the map.

Open up the quest box 4 / 8 and unpack the standees.

Proceed to page 117 of the campaign book.



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Hunting Of The Kaleido

Introduction

Notes from Tuor's bestiary

Were the kaleido's movements more predictable, we could at least estimate a timetable for when and where certain latitudes might be in danger. Not only are the kaleido's movements rather difficult to determine, but the constant release of her urn offspring are almost as devastating. Give her one solid day of activity and she's created a massive hollow that could collapse an entire field, with her progeny creating enough culverts to practically divert a river.

Getting close enough to study her in detail is a lethal endeavor for certain, to say nothing of the potential devastation she's already carved beneath the northern stretch of Lalos. I truly hope there wasn't a commune somewhere along her path; if there was, they're assuredly all dead. I don't think Tuor is in danger specifically, though we are right on the edge of one of her potential tunnel routes which may cause difficulty with future construction.

This is a difficult problem to solve. I can't begin to calculate just how many warriors would be necessary. We know of two clans at direct risk from her migrations, but I doubt even the combined efforts of three clans would be enough without significant casualties. I am leaving the orange indicator in this entry for now.

We may want to consider upgrading to red upon later review.

Silky resisted every instinct in his body pushing him to celebrate. Apex. His own personal collection of accounts had only ever recorded a single Apex Rover. Here he was fostering a new generation of them. He just wished it didn't have to come at the expense of so much peril. On that note...

"Mo, how would you like to experience the greatest challenge of your life as an artisan?" he prompted. The starling tilted their head in consideration. "The greatest challenge, so far?" they tease back. Silky chuckles softly.

"Even better, you get to exact a bit of revenge on an old nemesis..."

Setup



Take 7/8 ▶ Go to 47 ▶ Go to 78.

Tiles: 4x Crumbling Columns

Victory Condition



Slay the Kaleido.

Round limit: 12 ⌚

Challenges



- 1 When the Kaleido attacks a Rover, they must drain all 🔥, 🌪️, 🌿, and 💧 ether dice in their personal or infusion pools.
- 2 All adversaries are treated as occupying the positive ether fields on the Kaleido's statistic block.
- 3 Adversaries are immune to the effects of fire and water nodes. Rovers can not take ether dice from fire and water nodes and are affected by these nodes while within ↗ 1-2.

Special Rules



Ethereal Shell

The Kaleido is a mature urn and has absorbed great quantities of lyst making it impervious to all damage. You can not damage the Kaleido's ❤️ yet.

You will have to shatter the Kaleido's resilient multilayered shell four times to make it vulnerable to damage. For now, when you attack the Kaleido you are instead targeting its resilient shell. Treat this shell as having 3*R ❤️ and 🛡️ 3.

Exposed Innards

All units part of the Rover faction are treated as occupying the negative ether fields that are on the Kaleido's statistic block.

The Kaleido is treated as occupying the positive ether fields that are on its statistic block.

Terrain



Units that trigger crumbling column traps suffer ☀️ 3.



Units that end their turn within ↗ 1 of this object suffer ☀️ 1.



Units that end their turn within ↗ 1 of this object recover ❤️ 1.



It costs units 1 additional movement point to enter a space within ↗ 1 of this object.



Units within ↗ 1 of this object gain +1 🛡️.

Codex Links



🔍 183

Before the start of the first round, read "Kaleido Caldera", 📖 87.

🔍 184

Immediately when the Kaleido's shell has suffered 3*R or more damage, read "Fractured", 📖 88.

🔍 185

Immediately when there are four ether fields on the Kaleido's statistic block, read "Shattered", 📖 88

Quest 7

The Last Test

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Introduction

Mo settles their attention on the Rovers flanking either side of Grandpaw. Their pace is matched almost perfectly with one another and their positioning reflected as unconscious mirrors. Ether radiates off of their figures in periodic bursts. Creatures not attuned to ether so directly wouldn't have understood, but the Rovers undeniably had significant presence even without the ability to immediately perceive it. The relatively quiet journey from the eastern reaches of Lalos was a perfect example; nobody simply hikes across the length of the continent without scores of predators attempting to make a meal of them. Despite this obvious truth the number of beasts remaining that were foolish enough to challenge their traveling party numbered in the single digits.

Once more Mo wonders how much of this could have been orchestrated by Silky. He was clearly even more shrewd than any of them had realized. Did he also predict the evolution of his Rovers in this fashion? Was the path to true strength something so simple as repeated, and concerted, applications of ether? One of Mo's tendrils snaps as if to cast away the thought. There had to be more to it, otherwise every major clan would have warriors whose strength was as robust. Even roaming starlings would themselves become monstrous!

Then again, it was something witnessed with the addax. The timescale was much broader, supposedly, but a crown could rise to prominence through repeated channeling of ether until it became part of their essence—so the wizened zusag had explained regarding the origins of Uzem. The King of Storms predated Mo's formation and would likely survive after the starling wasted away down to mere slivers of lyst for some future traveler to ply from the world. It was comforting, in a grim way, and Mo was glad they had managed to stabilize the beast's rampant ether in the end.

Grandpaw suddenly begins to growl and his pace becomes unsteady. Mo realizes why several moments later. In that same primordial cunning the starling had just attributed to the beasts avoiding their own party, the ever-wary arkenyn perceived the malefic disturbance in the unsensed ether long before any sapient mind could grasp its deleterious undercurrents. Mo had dreaded this moment and their slight vindication is submerged in the bitter taste of fear as the Unsouled Barrens comes into view. Once-vibrant trees that marked the edges of its reach stand decrepit and decaying. Some unseen malignance had crept into their roots, poisoning the very essence of their being.

How does one contend with the terrors in a region where even the soil itself decries your every step?

Campaign Link



Go to “The Oldest And Strongest Emotion”  106.

The Oldest and Strongest Emotion

Introduction

Entry within The Barren Quire from “Earlong,” self-appointed Scribe of The Wake.

I once heard a theory that the need for sustenance, the sensation of hunger itself, is a symptom of a lack of fulfilling connections. Nonsense, of course, emotion alone is far from an effective source of energy.

But... perhaps there is some merit to the notion that physiology manifests some aspects of psychology. What does that say of an entire stretch of land where everything within hungers endlessly?

It was bedlam, unrestrained and frenzied. Ozendyn tries his best to keep from being overwhelmed, sprinting between boulders and ruins in a desperate bid to find a moment of reprieve from the oppressive collection of furious monstrosities massing in the Barrens by the hour. A brief sensation of calm washes over him as his coruscopod companion returns from its last meal, quickly slithering its way up his leg and around his body. Gargaki never seems as troubled by the creatures as its human is. Likely because fewer things consider the coruscopod as tempting a meal as they find Ozendyn. The benefits of one's flesh being suffused with Crux ether, he supposes.

It has only been a few days since Ozendyn spotted the troop of human mages make landfall and begin a focused hike from the outskirts of the Barrens straight towards the Bonespire. Ozendyn has trailed them, relying on his experience surviving the region to remain undetected, but their path across the region has been so brash and violent that his efforts at stealth were all but wasted. Blasts of scouring flame, seizing lightning, and slicing frost halted the offense of every stomaw and vessel that crossed the mages' line of fire. Their march formed a valley of desolation that led more of their clan to their daily sites of camp. Once their numbers totalled some two dozen or more, their assault on the Bonespire began in earnest.

Ozendyn barely remembers what happened afterwards—except for the running. The clan of crystal-impaled humans had awoken something within the Bonespire, and the entirety of the Unsouled Barrens was attacking back in response. Scores of monstrosities had clawed their way from every corner of the Barrens. It now teems with enraged creatures that seek the death of every last intruder, one way or another.

Loud braying steals Ozendyn's attention from the stalking monsters slowly gathering outside of his current place of rest. That wasn't a sound anything of the Unsouled Barrens would produce. Gargaki wobbles in response to the noise as well, perturbed by the unusual sound. Without warning, his sight is overwhelmed by a blinding radiance emanating from a shimmering, avian apparition—a zusag conjuration, if his experience was anything to go on. “Good, we've arrived in time. I believe a mutually beneficial arrangement is in order for us both! Spare us both the surprise at hearing my voice though, I doubt we have the time to fuss over the particulars.”

The source of the unusual braying then made itself known as it appeared on the horizon. It was an arkenyn, far from its usual stomping grounds, adorned in a variety of accoutrement and mounted by a pair of people wedged between the boxes and bags. Striding confidently at their side were what Ozendyn could only assume were hired guards, but their auras were far too impressive for simple mercenary work.

The vanquishing of creeping abominations is a straightforward task, one much more to Ozendyn's preference as opposed to fleeing from a horde. Based on the expressions showing amidst the warriors, it seems they share the sentiment.

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Setup



Take 3/7 ▶ Go to 48 ▶ Go to 80-81.

Tiles: 4x Hatchery

Victory Condition



Slay all adversaries, not including the haunt.

Round limit: 8

Challenges



- 1 When Countdown to Doom triggers, Rovers also suffer X, where X equals the number of ether dice in that Rover's personal pool. This damage can not be blocked by line-of-sight rules.
- 2 The recovery effect of Countdown to Doom gains +2 .
- 3 Rovers can't benefit from the effects of crux nodes and can't take ether dice from them. Adversaries are affected by crux nodes when within 1-2.

Special Rules



Countdown to Doom

A dark ether is pulsing from the Bonespire, tormenting the land. The source of this dark energy is marked on the map as coming from . During the start phase of rounds 2, 4, 6, and 8 all Rovers suffer 2 while all adversaries recover 2. Units that are not within line-of-sight of the source of the dark ether ignore this special rule. Spaces that are not within line-of-sight of have been marked with a white outline to make these unaffected spaces easier to identify.



Ozendyn

Ozendyn is a character ally to Rovers. For this encounter Ozendyn will only use the "Picket" side and will not flip.

Terrain



Non-flying units that enter jagged bones suffer 1.



Units that trigger hatchery traps suffer 3.



Units within 1 of this object gain +1 to the first attack they perform during their turn.



Units within 1 of this object gain -1 to the first attack they perform during their turn.

Codex Links



130

If the haunt is slain, read "The Thing That is Hidden", 62.

131

When the azoth is slain, read "The Poison of Life", 62.

132

Immediately when all adversaries are slain, including the broken vessels that spawn from slaying a fell cradle, but not including the haunt, read "A Dangerous Road", 62.

Flee From The Light

Introduction

Entry within The Barren Quire from “Mockhorn.” Scribe of The Wake.

Structure is at the heart of any effort to stem chaos. We find ourselves at the heart of an unrelenting stretch of systems that feed off of one another to generate an endless amount of disorder. To combat this we must each become systems of order within ourselves. Our spirits must be indomitable in the face of an uncaring expanse of hunger and greed.

Structure requires support. We must individually be the stanchions of a greater whole. Together we will illuminate the churning dark, one battle at a time. Such is the foundation of The Wake. Every member we take on will suffer as they're molded to a part of the greater shape. This process cannot be forced nor expedited. Their unique contours must be accounted for within our framework. That they would serve at all—this first brick is the most important.

“Talented at tumbling into trouble.” That was what their mother had told the triplets time and time again. There was also never a situation they couldn't squeeze out of! Such was the justification for journeying into the blackened heart of Lalos and seeing just how far they could push themselves. The desire to abscond with their findings was replaced with a desire to know more as they slipped their way through the patrolling monsters of the Barrens. Terrifying tales told over and over to try and discourage merely looking in the direction of the wasteland too closely, but nobody would ever answer their questions related to the sheer mystery of the place.

Perhaps something could be said for listening to their elders in this case. While plenty of interesting treasures and stories lay buried here, the dangers they were warned about were practically worse than the tales. Dodging the tendrils of broken starlings, escaping the

jaws of monstrous maws, and keeping their wits about them as they explored one end of the waste to the other. If not for sympathy and pity for the warrior Ozendyn, they likely would have fled the region days prior.

Said sympathy had its limits. Ozendyn was clearly desperate and wanted—needed, really—allies in his fight against the endless trickle of monsters throughout the Barrens. There certainly used to be others, but the triplets could guess what had happened based on the increasing frenzy of activity across the wastes. Any desire to join the dwindling warrior clan was stymied by the stark reminder that this was a place of death and desolation.

But the triplets were always looking for an opportunity to ease the warrior's burdens, and what a surprise when the latest opportunity came. Ozendyn showing up to the nest they had been scouting with a full complement of warriors! Who could pass up a chance to rub it in the ears of friends and family that they went to the most dangerous place in Lalos and not only came back, but with the experience of fighting alongside Rovers?

Setup



Take 3/7 ▶ Go to 49 ▶ Go to 82-83.

Tiles: 2x Hatchery

Victory Condition



Survive for 7 rounds.

Round limit: 7

Loss Conditions



Lose if Ozendyn is slain.

Challenges



- 1 Querists flee after suffering a total of 3 or more damage.
- 2 When Countdown to Doom triggers, Rovers must reroll all ether dice in their personal and infusion pools.
- 3 When the Scour spawns, Ozendyn is injured. Return him to the nearest starting space. Ozendyn can no longer perform or actions, and current can't exceed half of their maximum .

Special Rules



Countdown to Doom

There are six ether icons placed on the edges of the map. These icons represent possible spawn locations throughout the encounter.

When an adversary is slain, place it off to the side of the map. During the start phase of rounds 2, 4, and 6, for each adversary that is to the side of the map, roll an ether dice from the general pool, then spawn that adversary at the space with the ether icon corresponding to the result that was just rolled.

Ozendyn

Ozendyn is a character ally to Rovers. For this encounter Ozendyn will only use the “Picket” side and will not flip.

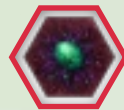
Balatronists

The querists are part of their own faction, The Balatronists, which are allies to Rovers and enemies to adversaries. Units a part of The Balatronists follow all the adversary logic rules in the rule book. This faction gains priority after the Adversary faction has gone.

Terrain



Non-flying units that enter jagged bones suffer 1.



Units that trigger hatchery traps suffer 3.



Units within 1 of this object gain -1 to the first attack they perform during their turn.

Codex Links



The first time a stomaw is slain, read “Guarantee of Dark Morbidities”, 63.



The first time a broken vessel is slain, read “A Placid Island of Ignorance”, 63.



The first time a fell cradle is slain, read “Violation of the Order of Nature”, 63.



At the end of round 4, read “What Has Sunk May Rise”, 63.



At the end of round 7, read “Almost Nobody Dances Sober”, 64.

Practical Consequences

Introduction

Two starlings are fleeing from a band of ruthless humans. The sparse trees and hills between the starlings and their clan's commune will take at least another hour to cross at their current pace. As crafters and minders, the starlings haven't spent time learning how to fight or flee. As hunters and killers, the humans know best how to pursue and engage. Gleaming ether crystals embedded into their bodies are a testament to their practice.

Both starlings let their tendrils wrap together, communicating all of their ideas and emotions to each other in an instant. Pessimism and optimism in equal measure. No matter what happens, they'll be together forever.

Those thoughts never falter, even when the humans manage to capture one of the starlings and strip them of their ether piece by piece. When their core is fully exposed and wrenched from the body that formed around it. When the cries of their sibling echo across the coast and draw their clan's guards out in force.

Screeching and howling fills the air as you trek deeper along the writhing landscape. A gruesome scene is laid out—one which finally gives some context to the heightened pandemonium spreading across the Barrens. The Star Hunter clan, likely emboldened by their failure to harvest Uzem's energies, have migrated to a more familiar source of power to them: starling cores. One of the distorted humans bellows a laugh as he grips a broken vessel by the tendrils and ruthlessly thrusts his swollen arm through its screaming jaws. The veins of the man's arms begin to glow a dull purple, and soon the screaming of the vessel is replaced with the strained groans of the human.

Crunching and tearing follow as he wrenches his arm back out of the broken vessel. Held in his hand is a small, jagged core of pure Morph. He drops the limp starling to the ground which quickly melts away without its etheric core holding its form together. The human lets out a victorious roar as he impales the core into his chest, the muscles beneath his flesh writhing as they soak in

the ether. His reptilian companion-beast, hosting their own jagged core impaled within their head, hisses a declaration of rage before they both leap towards the next vessel nearest to them.

Mo responds with their own series of emotional outbursts, not caring about the circling monstrosities drawn to the commotion. The crafter wraps all of their tendrils around the core they've carried, doing whatever they can to keep it hidden. Makaal attempts to reach Mo but is met without any sort of reaction. He shakes his head. "We'll stay back here for now. I don't think I need to ask you for this as a favor," he says, motioning his head towards the party of cackling humans chasing down their prey.

Ozendyn shakes his head solemnly as he draws his blade from its sheath. "The Unsouled are feral dangers that need culling, but for a clan to debase themselves so thoroughly in a bid for power... Rovers, what is happening over the rest of Lalos?" he asks. Silky perches on his shoulder opposite to Gargaki and waves a wing across the scene. "Open wounds that have turned to infection. Let us be the healing agents tonight."

Setup



Take 3/7 ▶ Go to 50 ▶ Go to 84-85.

Tiles: 4x Hatchery

Victory Condition



Slay all adversaries.

Round limit: 8

Loss Conditions



Lose if Ozendyn is slain.

Challenges



- 1 When a harrow gains a  dice, they recover all of their .
- 2 During odd rounds, Star Hunter units gain +1 .
- 3 Countdown to Doom grants an additional +1 .

Special Rules



Countdown to Doom

A dark ether is pulsing from the Bonespire, tormenting the land. During rounds 2, 4, 6, and 8 all Broken Vessels and Fell Cradles gain +1  to all of their attacks.

Ozendyn

Ozendyn is a character ally to Rovers. For this encounter Ozendyn will only use the “Picket” side and will not flip.

Star Hunters

Harrows, wrathbone, and dyads are part of their own faction, Star Hunters, which are enemies to Rovers and adversaries alike. Units a part of Star Hunters follow all the adversary logic rules in the rule book. This faction gains priority after the adversary faction has gone.

Harrows want to take the ether from broken vessels and fell cradles to empower themselves in their macabre rituals.

Immediately when a broken vessel or fell cradle are slain by a Star Hunter unit, place an ether dice from the general pool into the damage tracker slot of the harrow that is nearest to the slain starling.

Terrain



Non-flying units that enter jagged bones suffer  1.



Units that trigger hatchery traps suffer  3.



Units within  1 of this object gain -1  to the first attack they perform during their turn.

Codex Links



The first time a harrow is slain, read “The Physiology Of Fear”,  64.



Immediately when all adversaries are slain, including the broken vessels that spawn from slaying a fell cradle, read “Inchoate And Rudely Fashioned”,  65.

Sleeping Abnormalities

Introduction

A starling scholar walks along the central spiral road of Henzya. They have grown accustomed to the growth of their lower body and the additional limbs. Henzya is absolutely sprawling, and they feel bad for the humans without a draught companion to help with the myriad elevation changes and long paths. The tihfur had been right about this region of foothills being made for those with long legs and longer lives. Their form feels right to the scholar, and now they could be one of those who offers their back to weary citizens and fellow students.

A starling scholar walks along the central spiral road of Henzya. It really could be considered the navel of Lalos. Etheric conditions are rich and the starling is confident in its ability to capture the energy they had collected. The blood of its people flows perfectly along the carved stone. Its rolling hills a perfect, natural cistern for the matter they will continue to gather and disseminate. He feels bad for the keb that had to endure the psychic torment of the city's liquidation, but the starling has worked to ensure he uses his now prodigious strength to end everyone's lives swiftly and mercifully.

Why was it that starlings do not reproduce? Bazhar was certain it is just a failure to cultivate the right sort of environment. He can't wait to welcome his new siblings into a nursery all their own. Lessons learned from his time among the peoples of Henzya would give him the wisdom he needs to care for and impart wisdom to all that emerge from his Navel.

As you cross the threshold into the Bonespire, an inexplicable dread presses into you, thick through the air. The walls—a fetid amalgamation of stone and living tissue—pulse faintly, imbued with a loathsome semblance of life. Veins, slick and glistening, weave through the masonry, feeding some unseen, incomprehensible purpose. The stone, where untouched by the grotesque flesh, is weathered and blackened. Much of it is etched with runes that wriggle with uncomfortable motion when looked upon directly.

A lone human paces amidst a scattering of other bodies. Their cloak is torn and bloody, their skin is gray and pallid. They stare up at the antechamber's ceiling as they walk. The tower itself is watching, its every sinew and stone a sensory organ attuned to this unwelcome intrusion. Somewhere far above, a low, rhythmic vibration begins to hum, faint but undeniable, resonating through the walls and floor like a heartbeat—slow, ponderous, and unnervingly patient.

“YOU ARE LATE, WARDEN.” A voice erupts from the human.

“THEY CAME FOR MY CHILDREN.” Another voice from a body on the floor.

“DISGUSTING PARASITES FEEDING ON MY FLESH.” The lips of the humans move in grotesque synchrony, yet they seem only an echo of the words. It begins as a low, guttural murmur, the kind that rumbles through the depths of a cavern, but soon swells into a cacophony that seems to emanate from the walls, the floor... The true source of the sound comes from everywhere at once within the tower.

“YET THEY WOKE ME FROM MY SLUMBER AND LEFT ME WITH NO CHOICE BUT TO TEACH THEM. WHAT SURPRISE, THEN, WHEN I PLUCKED THE THOUGHTS FROM THEIR FLESH AND WAS STRUCK WITH INSPIRATION I HAVEN'T FELT IN DECADES.

“COME, OZENDYN, LAST OF HENZYA'S FOLK. IS YOUR MISSION STILL JUST?”

Setup



Take 3/7 ▶ Go to 51 ▶ Go to 86-87.

Tiles: 3x Magical Trap

Victory Condition



Slay the Borrowed Vessel.

Round limit: 8 ⌚

Loss Conditions



Lose if Ozendyn is slain.

Challenges



- 1 The attack action granted to the Borrowed Vessel by Countdown to Doom gains +3 ⚔️, 🛡️, and ➡️ 3.
- 2 While there is at least one harrow on the map, Borrowed Vessel gains +2 🛡️.
- 3 Harrows gain +2 movement points to all of their movement actions.

Special Rules



Countdown to Doom

A dark ether is pulsing from Bazhar's outer ritual deck, tormenting the Bonespire. During the start phase of rounds 2, 4, 6, and 8 all harrows perform:



The Borrowed Vessel performs:



Ozendyn

Ozendyn is a character ally to Rovers. For this encounter Ozendyn will only use the "Picket" side and will not flip.

Terrain



Units that trigger Magic traps suffer ⚡ 3. When a Magic trap is triggered, roll an ether dice and place the ether field that corresponds with the result of the roll in the space the trap was in. A result of crux or morph places an adversary ⚙️ or ⚙️, respectively.

Codex Links



Immediately when the Borrowed Vessel is slain, read "A Loss Of Identity," 📖 65.

Behind Every Masterpiece

Introduction

Bazhar stretches his attention across the entirety of Navel. Clusters of sinew and cartilage jutt upward, like skeletal trees bent under the weight of some unseen despair. From these grotesque protrusions hang flayed, membranous sacs, translucent and quivering, as though straining to contain the malformed creatures writhing within. Occasionally, one of these sacs bursts with a wet, nauseating pop, spilling forth its foul progeny—things that crawl and slither on too many limbs, their flesh a patchwork of eyes, mouths, and grasping tendrils.

He suppresses his revulsion, which sadly grows easier with each passing day. He had been so sure that the cultivators and alchemists were correct. All his siblings should have needed was a region rich in Morph and they would spread freely through the first natural home for his kind. Instead, he has simply spread himself throughout Navel. He has turned himself inside-out and selfishly claimed whatever animate forces were present here for his own abominable propagation.

“They are fragile vessels,” Bazhar croons, his tones an echoing symphony of gloom from various mouths. “Their forms, brittle shells of pure Morph, fractured under the weight of becoming in a region so starved of life. Yet it is with these frayed threads that I can weave, their essence may blend, and my children may finally experience... true birth.”

A tendril lifts one of the broken Star Hunters aloft. A ream of sharp bones erupt from the tendril. With one swift motion, the now-dismantled human body falls away to reveal a pair of gleaming starling cores. As soon as the cores are exposed, the broken vessels swirling about the Bonespire take immediate notice. They move with an unnatural grace, tendrils reaching out not to grasp but to merge, their ends tapering into needle-like filaments that pulse with a sickly light.

“Each core is a sealed consciousness. Instead of paltry sublimation, my caste can finally achieve full realization. These stolen memories are the fertile

soil. From their past ruin, my children can find root, and together, they shall form the living lattice of my regretful design. In the unraveling of these scavengers, a unity shall be forged. Their flesh, a medium; their minds, a foundation; their screams, the call of rebirth!” Bazhar cheers.

Ozendyn’s brow is slick with sweat. The only option is to fight, but the situation weighs down upon him. Henzya, Bazhar, these are all things he has read about but hasn’t ever really believed to be anything but legends passed down within his clan’s order. He looks at his weapon, imbued with ether using methods both old and new.

He is here to carry out his mission. Bazhar’s revelations are all the more reason to press on.

Setup



Take 3/7 ▶ Go to 52 ▶ Go to 88-89.

Tiles: 2x Magical Trap

Victory Condition



Slay Bazhar.

Round limit: 10

Loss Conditions



Lose if Ozendyn is slain.

Challenges



- 1 When Countdown to Doom triggers and Rovers suffer damage, that damage is increased by +1.
- 2 You have two fewer rounds to complete this encounter. When starting this encounter, set the round counter to 3. This does adjust the effect of Countdown to Doom.
- 3 Adversaries are immune to the effects of morph nodes. Rovers can not take ether dice from morph nodes.

Special Rules



Ozendyn

Ozendyn is a character ally to Rovers. For this encounter Ozendyn will only use the “Crucial Sentinel” side and will not flip.

Countdown to Doom

Bazhar radiates malevolent energy. They’re creating an army of corrupted ether.

While Bazhar creates his macabre forms of living ether, they do not act like a traditional adversary and do not take turns during the adversary phase. At the start of the adversary phase, reference the following table, executing the effects based on the current round count. Slay Bazhar quickly before you are overwhelmed.

There are six ether icons placed throughout the map. These icons represent possible spawn locations throughout the encounter. When an adversary would be spawned, roll an ether dice to determine its spawn location.

Round 1: Place  in all Rover spaces.

Round 2: All Rovers suffer  1. Clear all ether fields in spaces occupied by Bazhar. Spawn 3 corrupted forms.

Round 3: Place  in all Rover spaces.



Round 4: All Rovers suffer  2. Clear all ether fields in spaces occupied by Bazhar. Spawn 3 endless hunger.

Round 5: Spawn 1 broken reflection.

Round 6: All Rovers suffer  3. Clear all ether fields in spaces occupied by Bazhar. Spawn 3 corrupted forms.

Round 7: Spawn 3 endless hungers.

Round 8: All Rovers suffer  4. Clear all ether fields in spaces occupied by Bazhar. Spawn 2 broken reflections.

Round 9: Spawn 3 corrupted forms.

Round 10: All units of the Rover faction are slain. Their ether is corrupted and they become broken reflections. The encounter is lost.

Terrain



Units that trigger Magic traps suffer  3. When a Magic trap is triggered, roll an ether dice and place the ether field that corresponds with the result of the roll in the space the trap was in. A result of crux or morph places an adversary  or , respectively.



Units within  1 of this object gain -1  to the first attack they perform during their turn.

Codex Links



Immediately when Bazhar is slain, read “Blasphemously Surviving Nightmares”,  66.

Quest 8

The House Of Judgement

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Introduction

Makaal runs a hand along Grandpaw's furry head as he evaluates the Rovers following nearby. At first the opportunity for Mo to focus on their talents, and potentially see a bit of profit, was a compelling reason to join alongside their wild adventure across Lalos. But with each encounter Makaal finds himself regretting that decision more and more. Before all of this he believed himself to be well-traveled and more experienced than the average clansmen; now he desperately craves the simpler life of occasionally tussling with a zinx or crossing a dyad pit.

Thick, dark storm clouds are billowing out across the skies from the gargantuan pale tree that marks where this harrowing adventure first began. Makaal knows that Silky has always intended to set his Rovers upon Uzem's Throne in a bid to wrest control of the skies back from the worsening conditions over the past months, but it is another thing to be faced with the reality of it all. Uncontrollable bodily distortions, mental subjugation of entire clans, mindless beasts of flesh and claw—Makaal was certain no ordinary person would hear these tales and believe a word of it had they not lived it themselves. He couldn't be sure this wasn't all some nightmare he was due to wake from.

A sense of calm washes over him as he considers just what his concerns actually are. Silky, cagey as he is about his wider schemes, genuinely seems to only care about solving some of the biggest problems Makaal could never fathom. His method of cultivating a group of Rovers to achieve the results demonstrated was... maybe questionable, but Makaal feels a sense of pride with his part in it all. Conquering the Unsouled Barrens! He'll have to make sure Silky records his name when penning that legendary feat.

His reflections are cut short by shouting overhead. Too preoccupied with their flight, a group of Star Hunter stormcallers blasts overhead, leaving sparks and vapor in their wake. They too are headed directly for Uzem's Throne. This literal burst of activity can only mean bad things. Silky's aerios pulls away and begins to follow behind the humans, pulling the rest of the group into a staggered chase.

If Makaal never sees another drop of rain again, it will be too soon. Hopefully his clan forgives him for wishing for a dry season.

Campaign Link



Go to "Wind-Bitten Ancient Elms"  118.

Wind-Bitten Ancient Elms

Introduction

Two starlings are fleeing from a band of ruthless humans. In the shadows of a forest that glows faintly under the light of a pale moon. They rush desperately, their forms rippling with an iridescent sheen. Each step of their undulating limbs leaves behind faint trails of bioluminescence, a sorrowful mark of their escape. Their tendrils, delicate and translucent, intertwined with a frantic urgency, conveying emotions too deep for sound—fear, sorrow, and above all, a vow to endure.

A single human rises above the trees, each limb run through with the crystalline remains of his successful hunts. Their figure obscures the moonlight, casting a jagged shadow across the canopy. Twin howls fill the air, and the flash of a smile slips across The Eclipse's face.

On one side stands the Star Hunters, draped in robes that shimmer like rain-soaked silk, their hands raised in defiance of the sky. Each motion of their crystal-impaled hands conjures winds that howl like lamenting ghosts, and rain that cascades in crystalline daggers. "How sublime," murmurs one woman, her cold eyes gleaming. "This power will be mine. Perhaps they'll call me The Queen of Storms!" She snaps at the ghostly wisps of electricity still lingering in the air, each filament absorbing into the crystals impaled into her limbs. She giggles to herself all the while.

With each spark she absorbs, the air around her begins to twist and spiral with greater fervor. Her companion spreads its wings wide, bearing the disposition of a violent storm, and takes to the sky—trailing threads of wind produced by its plumage. It circles above her, absorbing as much Air ether as it can, every mote causing its feathers to grow more sharp and lustrous. Lesser beasts crowd around, enthralled by the power on display.

Their foe, gleaming and unyielding, is a crown infused with almost pure lightning. Its antlers branch like a storm itself, crackling with threads of azure and white. Each step it takes scorches with an electric afterglow, leaving smoldering scars on the ground. The beast moves, not with the clumsy tread of theran life, but with the elegance of power incarnate, each leap a dance step that challenges its adversary.

The crown turns its luminous gaze upon the empowered avian, and for a beat, time seems to halt. Then comes the fury—a bolt of lightning, a crack so sharp it cleaves the sky. The human's protective energies absorb the strike but falter under its might, billowing like a poorly-hitched tent. The outspoken Star Hunter laughs and swings herself about in joyful defiance of the crown's resistance.

The keb rasska have a phrase for this situation—"The foe of another foe, is often friend."

Setup



Take 4/8 ▶ Go to 53 ▶ Go to 90-91.

Victory Condition



Slay the Squall.

Round limit: 8

Challenges



- 1 Treat the Squall as occupying a . This is a permanent effect.
- 2 Adversaries ignore as a tie breaker and prefer to attack the Breath of Uzem if they are closest. Further, adversaries gain +1 when attacking the Breath of Uzem.
- 3 When the Squall attacks a Rover, they must drain all ether dice in their personal or infusion pools.

Special Rules



Uzem's Prodigy

The Breath of Uzem is part of their own faction, the Uzem, which are allies to Rovers and enemies to adversaries. Units a part of the Uzem follow all the adversary logic rules in the rule book. This faction gains priority after the Adversary faction has gone.

Terrain



Units within 1 of this object gain +1 .



Units within 1 of this object gain +1 to the first attack they perform during their turn.

Codex Links



The first time a streak is slain, read “Birds of a Feather”, 67.



Immediately when the Squall is slain, if the Breath of Uzem is alive, read “Exhale”, 67.



Immediately when the Squall is slain, if the Breath of Uzem was slain, read “It Must Be Wednesday”, 68.

The Desolated Home

Introduction

The pain is exquisite, sharp and all-consuming, as though the world itself were tearing him apart and remaking him in the same moment. The starling core sinks deeper, its glow intensifying, and veins of molten ore begin to spread across his skin, tracing the pathways of his body like burning rivers. He gasps, but no sound emerges, for his voice is now but an echo in the cacophony of stone and soil.

The ground beneath him trembles, the very landscape shifting in answer to his agony. Stones rise unbidden, forming jagged spires around him. The Star Hunter's eyes, now glowing with the pure ether of Earth, open to meet the horizon, and he stands—transformed, terrible, transcendent. He raises his hand, and the land obeys; cliffs crumble, roots surge upward from the depths, and the air itself seems heavy with the promise of adamant might.

The fulgurcaps sway with an uneasy tremor, their sanctity violated by the presence of the Star Hunter. His figure is dark and angular, cloaked in robes that writhe as though woven from soil and stone, and his eyes burn with an unnatural glow—the malevolent gaze of a man who sees the world not as a home, but as a tool to be bent and broken.

Before him lies the remains of the aspect of Uzem, its form now crumbled into a lifeless heap. Its antlers, fractured and dull, glint faintly in the wan light, while beside it, the massive obelisk of ether juts from the fungus, its light pulsing erratically like a dying soul. The human's lips curl into a smile—thin, cruel, devoid of mercy. His entomans skitter and stalk around him, subdued through raw elemental might.

He lays one hand upon the carcass, and its remnants begin to glow faintly, the ether within it awakening once more, only to be devoured. The energies of Earth surged up his crystal-ridden arm, lighting the veins in his skin with a sickly brilliance. His body jerks as he absorbs it, his head snapping back with a guttural laugh that echoes through the clearing like the shattering of stone.

Then he throws himself against the ether node, pressing both hands against its jagged surface. A cacophony of sounds fills the air—a chorus of shattering, groaning, and screaming, as the crystal's light drains into him, flooding his body with adamant power. His laugh deepens, echoing through the reach, a sound so cold and predatory that even his companions recoil.

He intones, “The Thunder Mesa stretches like a scar across the face of our past, a cruel reminder that even the great Addax can wield power with the carelessness of a child crushing a flower. But within it is left a great wealth of power to be claimed. So, I shall teach Uzem how it feels to have a home turned into a display of strength.”

Setup



Take 4/8 ▶ Go to 54 ▶ Go to 92-93.

Victory Condition



Slay the Tremorcaller.

Round limit: 8

Challenges



- 1 Rovers can't benefit from the effects of earth nodes and can't take ether dice from them. Adversaries are affected by earth nodes when within 1-2.
- 2 Harrows gain +1 movement point to all of their movement actions and are immune to and effects.
- 3 Onisski have +3 .

Terrain



Non-flying units that enter jagged bones suffer 1.



Units that end their turn within 1 of this object recover 1.



Units within 1 of this object gain +1 to the first attack they perform during their turn.

Codex Links



147

The first time a harrow is slain, read “Not Enough Ether”, 68.

148

If the urn is slain, read “Mineral Shell”, 68.

149

Immediately when the Tremorcaller is slain, read “Rock On”, 69.

Excess of Their Thirst

Introduction

“Patience,” the stormcaller murmurs. The harrow following him nod, their eyes fixed on the infused crown, every muscle coiled as if the tension of the moment has seeped into their very flesh. The crown’s body seems fluid, yet defined, as though sculpted from the purest spring. Its antlers curve like delicate waves frozen mid-crest, their glow illuminating the mist that clings to the wood. Every movement is a rippling of liquid grace.

At the man’s subtle gesture, the various dekaha rooted throughout the hollow’s ceiling begin to stir. Their vines creep forward with deliberate intent. They strike first, their tendrils darting through the air with a serpentine swiftness, wrapping around the crown’s delicate legs. The creature rears, its body splashing apart for an instant before reforming, an elegant cascade that leaves glistening droplets hanging in the air. It makes a bolt back towards the upper ring of the hollow, but the harrow surge forward, their feet churning the slowly flooding hollow into a frenzy. One throws a weighted net, rife with jagged crystals of Earth ether, which falls over the crown’s glowing body. The creature bucks and thrashes, its antlers flashing with bursts of crystalline water that are cast like shards of ice, but the net holds firm.

He raises his hands, and the pools around the crown rise in answer, liquid tendrils forming a swirling cage. The enthralled dekaha reaffirm their hold, their vines pulsing as if drawing strength from what they ensnared. The crown lets out a mournful cry, a sound like the wail of a distant tide, before collapsing into stillness, its form dimming but not dissolving. The Star Hunter kneels beside it, placing an impaled hand on its glistening flank. His complement, still panting from the chase, watch in silence as the stormcaller closes his eyes and begins to draw from the crown’s ether, the pools around them trembling as the energy flows into him.

Mo holds out an arm, stopping everybody at the face of the bough trickling with water. “I sense them, but... we were too slow. I feel the ether and its turmoil, even within these small streams.” They concentrate for a moment, their tendrils slowly unspooling and floating towards the rivulets of water cascading down the bark.

“The Hunter seems to have almost completely wrested control of Uzem’s energy from its progeny. I suspect your task will be easier if you could somehow cull it, but I find myself feeling... sympathetic. Perhaps you can find a way to sever their connection and preserve the crown?” Mo posits as they fashion a set of climbing hooks out of the galeaper talons and fungal threads harvested from the fulgurcaps.

“No mercy for the wicked, Rovers,” Makaal proposes.

Setup



Take 4/8 ▶ Go to 55 ▶ Go to 94-95.

Tiles: 2x Bursting Bells

Victory Condition



Slay the Wavecaller.

Round limit: 8 ⌚

Challenges



- 1 When an adversary triggers the effect, remove that tile. When an adversary triggers the effect, they recover 2.
- 2 When the Wavecaller is within 1-2 of the Tears of Uzem they gain +2 .
- 3 The Tears of Uzem gains +1 to all of their attacks.

Special Rules



Uzem's Prodigy

The Tears of Uzem has been enslaved by the Wavecaller and is part of the adversary faction. Try to slay the Wavecaller without slaying the Tears of Uzem.

Terrain



Units that trigger Bursting Bell traps suffer 3.



It costs units 1 additional movement point to enter a space within 1 of this object.



Units within 1 of this object gain +1 to the first attack they perform during their turn.

Codex Links



When the Wavecaller is slain, if the Tears of Uzem is alive, read “**Hope Floats**”, 69.



When the Wavecaller is slain, if the Tears of Uzem was slain, read “**Flotsam**” 70.

The Ancient Gilmmer Burn

Introduction

At the apex of the great hollow tree, where its ancient heart opens to the starlit sky, the Fire-imbued human stands, her silhouette framed by the glow of a creature wrought in pure flame. The crown, now a radiant marvel of incandescence, flickers and dances as though composed of living embers. Its antlers spiral upward like tongues of fire frozen mid-reach, illuminating the gnarled walls of the hollow with a flickering, golden light. Each step it takes scorches the bark beneath, leaving smoldering prints that whisper of a fury untethered.

With a deliberate motion, she thrusts her spiked heel into the bark, the starling core at its tip flaring to life. A low hum reverberates through the tree as the etheric nodes begin to pulse, their light syncing to the rhythm of her breath. One by one, they crack and splinter, releasing streams of molten energy that arc toward her, spiraling around her form like fiery serpents.

The woman's lips curl into a thin, wicked smile as she steps forward, her arm channeling a spiral of flames that erupt from her hand. The flames snake toward the crown, not to harm it, but to encircle it, forming a blazing cage. The conjured pyre dances with her movements, responding to her will as if they are extensions of her being. The crown lunges and thrashes, its antlers crackling as it releases bursts of searing light, but the cage tightens with every motion.

Silky grunts and glides back down to where the Rovers and merchant pair are still climbing the highest lips of The Seat of Storms. “We’ve been on the back foot every step of the way here. I would never have guessed in a hundred years that the Star Hunters would accumulate enough power to truly challenge an Addax within their own domain. Perhaps I should have paid more heed to how they were able to establish a galeaper matriarch all that time ago.” He sighs.

“I believe there is a pattern for us to exploit here. Each of Uzem’s progeny have inherited his rage at the clan, this should be no different. Fire often bests Air in direct clashes of ether, we can use this to our advantage. If we restore the etheric nodes, the crown should be able to regain strength and fight back against its tormentors.” The aérios nods as he delivers his plans, confident as ever.

Makaal hums as he listens to Silky’s plan. “The Star Hunters have been journeying in and out of the Thunder Mesa for years now. I suppose they’ve been feeding from Uzem in one way or another all this time. Can we use that against them?”

“Precisely,” Silky responds. “As ever, Rovers, we’ll be relying on your strength. You’re almost certainly powerful enough to contend with yet another power-drunk ether-caster directly, but we seem to be presented with an opportunity to continue to engender ourselves with Addax Uzem, should it still draw breath. I say we do what we can to earn a King’s favor,” he suggests with a chuckle.

Setup



Take 4/8 ▶ Go to 56 ▶ Go to 96-97.

Tiles: 6x Wildfire

Victory Condition



Slay the Embercaller.

Round limit: 8 ⌚

Challenges



- 1 When a Rover attacks the Embercaller or a wrathbone, place a in their space.
- 2 Rovers trigger the effects of when within 0-1 of a tile.
- 3 While sealed, the Rage of Uzem suffers R+1 at the end of each round.

Special Rules



Uzem's Progeny

The Rage of Uzem is part of their own faction, the Uzem, which is an ally to the Rover faction and an enemy to the Adversary faction. Though the Uzem faction is an enemy to the adversary faction, all adversaries ignore the Rage of Uzem for now. Units a part of the Uzem faction follow all the adversary logic rules found in the rule book. This faction gains priority after the Adversary faction has gone.

The Rage of Uzem is currently sealed by powerful ether and is unable to act. This encounter has a bonus objective that involves the four Drained Ether nodes on the map. These nodes work differently from the other ether nodes you have encountered up to this point.



When a Rover is within 1 of a Drained Ether node, that Rover can spend 1 movement point to place a dice from their personal supply onto the node.

If R Drained Ether nodes are turned into fire nodes, the Rage of Uzem is unsealed and acts normally during the Uzem faction phase. Adversaries no longer ignore the Rage of Uzem and will target it as an enemy.

Codex Links



- 152 Immediately when the Embercaller is slain, if the Rage of Uzem is still sealed, read “**Quenched Rage**”, 70.
- 153 Immediately when the Embercaller is slain, if the Rage of Uzem was unsealed and is alive, read “**Rage Unleashed**”, 71.
- 154 Immediately when the Embercaller is slain, if the Rage of Uzem was unsealed and slain, read “**Smothered Flames**”, 71.

Nurse in Wavering Memories

Introduction

The shrine lies beneath a sky that simmers with muted anger, heavy clouds violet and ash-gray swirling above like the echoes of a storm long spent but not forgotten. Deep within its heart stands Addax Uzem, a figure of now-faded majesty, his once-regal form diminished. His body, fractured and flickering, seems cobbled together from shards of stormlight and trailing wisps of cloud. His antlers, though cracked and worn, still spark with feeble arcs of lightning that fizzles into the air with quiet defiance. He is no longer the tempest given flesh, but the breath before the final thunderclap—a dying storm still potent enough to shatter continents.

The Star Hunters encircle him, their eyes alight with the avarice of those who believe they can plunder a King. Their bodies glow faintly, tethered by crude leashes of ether that siphon the remnants of Uzem's power into the starling cores embedded within their bodies. The air trembles with their collective groans. "It's almost done!" one man snarls, his voice thick with triumph.

The King of Storms rears, and though his body shudders with the effort, the skies respond. The first bolt of lightning lances downward with a sound that splits the world, shattering the circle and sending the humans sprawling. The arc of light leaps from one to another, coursing through their bodies with merciless precision. They scream, but their cries are drowned by the deafening roar of thunder that follows, rolling through the valley like the echo of a leader's verdict. The storm's fury, drawn from the last vestiges of Uzem's strength, is a purging inferno—neither righteous nor cruel, but absolute.

When the final human falls, reduced to a smoldering husk, the clearing, too, falls silent. Uzem sways on his feet, his form flickering as though he might finally dissolve into the air. Yet he remains, battered but unbroken, his cracked antlers still glowing faintly in the dim light. From the shadows at the edge of the hollow, the clan's beasts begin to emerge. They move hesitantly, their steps laden with both grief and reverence. They offer their silent loyalty to the being whose power has humbled their masters. The skies do not clear—the air is still bitter with hate.

The aerios makes one more lap around the upper rim of the shrine and returns to settle along an edge, peering down at The King of Storms pacing wearily deep within the inner sanctum. "Uzem has been torn asunder, aspects of his being split across reflections of Crux that sought out the closest thing to their original host, and so his progeny had been caught in the conflict. It seems our efforts managed to buy him enough time to strike back, but not enough to reclaim his splinters. We can buy time for the Crucial aspects, but should that not succeed, be prepared to quell the coming storm with your own power."

Setup



Take 4/8 ▶ Go to 57 ▶ Go to 98-99.

Victory Condition



Harmonize The King of Storms.

Round limit: 12 ⌚

Challenges



- 1 Each time a Rover places an ether field in an enemy space, they place the same ether field in their own space.
- 2 The King of Storms gains +X to all of their attacks, where X equals the number of ether nodes that have been harmonized.
- 3 Adversaries will continue to spawn, even when their associated ether node has been harmonized

Special Rules



The King of Storms

The King of Storms is in pieces and must be put back together. They are living ether enthralled by disharmony, wreaking havoc on the battlefield.

This is a unique battlefield that will ask a lot of you. The King of Storms can not be affected by any Rover faction action for any reason.

There are 4 ether clusters, one for fire, earth, water, and wind. Though these ether clusters still have effects like most other ether nodes, Rovers can not remove the ether dice from these clusters.



In order to reunite The King of Storms, each ether cluster will need to be harmonized.

The fire ether cluster can be targeted with actions by Rovers as if it were an enemy. The cluster needs to suffer R*12 damage to be brought into harmony. Check your campaign log, if the “Rage of Uzem was unsealed”, Rovers gain +1 to all of their attacks targeting the fire ether cluster.

The earth ether cluster can be targeted with actions by Rovers as if it were an ally. The cluster needs to recover R*6 damage to be brought into harmony.

The water ether cluster needs Rovers to fight against the current. Rovers must enter into R*2 spaces within 1 of the cluster to bring it into harmony. Check your campaign log, if the “Tears of Uzem Lives”, Rovers gain +1 movement point to all of their movement actions that begin within 1 of the water ether cluster.

The wind ether cluster needs Rovers to prevent R*6 damage while within 1 of the cluster to be brought into harmony. Check your campaign log, if the “Breath of Uzem Lives”, Rovers gain +1 while they are within 1 of the wind ether cluster.

Once these four tasks have been completed, the King of Storms will be brought into harmony.



Nurse in Wavering Memories

Special Rules



Elemental Adversaries

Adversaries are associated to an ether cluster; ashemaks to the fire cluster, bulwarous to the earth cluster, briarwog to the water cluster, and galeapers to the wind cluster.

When an adversary is slain, place it off to the side of the map on its side. During the start phase, for each adversary that is off to the side, flipped vertically, and their associated ether cluster has not been harmonized, spawn that adversary at ↗ 2 from their ether cluster, closest to the nearest Rover. Then, for each adversary that is both off to the side and placed on its side, flip them vertically.

Terrain



Units that enter or end their turn in fire suffers ☀ 1.



Units that end their turn within ↗ 1 of this object suffer ☀ 1.



Units that end their turn within ↗ 1 of this object recover ♥ 1.



It costs units 1 additional movement point to enter a space within ↗ 1 of this object.



Units within ↗ 1 of this object gain +1 🛡.

Codex Links



🔍 155

Immediately when The King of Storms has been harmonized, read “Equipoise Regent”, 🔍 73.



Chapter 5

Era Shattered

Special Rules



Adventure

Before you embark on your next quest, you can travel to the Skyward Plateau. Proceed to page 132 of the campaign book.

Campaign Link



You have done what you can for the tribes of Lalos. The Star Hunters have attacked Era, the great floating city.

Place the Era Shattered sticker, E-8, onto the map.

Open up the quest box 9 and unpack the standees.

Proceed to page 134 of the campaign book.

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Wanderlust

Introduction

For years, the clan had rumors of a great beast that wandered the mountains. Adults would tell the story to children to ensure none ever went hiking alone. When the tihfur finally discovered the marl-starling that had haunted their legends, it was a strange day. He was surprisingly docile for a starling that had been devoid of personhood for so much of his development. Perhaps his immense size had played some part in that? Few beasts dared challenge a walking boulder.

Not only was he docile, but he was quite tolerant of the clan as they led him back to their village. Children would climb his rugged surface and swing from his vines. Adults would seek out the shade of his enormity during the day. The haunting tale of the great beast of the mountain disappeared practically overnight, replaced with songs about the gentle giant Hra.

Hra became the clan's guardian for a time. He developed his sentience slowly. It was a day of celebration when he finally spoke his first words. But as any starling does, it was eventually time for Hra to depart. Yet Hra never actually travels beyond the mountains—if you ask him, he claims to be “searching”. Searching from one end of the mountain range and back, day after day, month after month, year after year.

To this day, ballads of the gentle giant are passed along the clans that live in the mountains.

Mo found themselves drifting in and out of an uncharacteristic fatigue. An immensely potent haze of Earth-ether was challenging the starling's Water-aspected senses. Before Mo could ask for a break to deal with its effects, an unidentifiable roar fills the valley. It tinges the ether haze with anger and fear. Mo knew the sensation all too intimately. Star Hunters had found their prey.

“That’s not a beast—it’s a starling!” Mo shouts. “We have to hurry!” Without so much as checking to see if any of you are prepared for the sudden sprint, the starling ushers Grandpaw ahead on a full gallop. Surprisingly, it’s much easier to keep pace than it used to be, with the gathered strength flowing through your bodies.

Plumes of dust choke out the mountain path ahead. With each stumbling step the huge starling takes, more dirt shoots into the air around it. Surrounding him is a party of Star Hunters, eager for the bounty they had discovered. His form towers above the humans—a colossus of stone and soil, veins of tree roots snaking over and through his body. His four legs, gnarled trunks coated in a layer of rock, smash into the ground, sending shockwaves through the dirt. Cracked boulders and shards of metal are cast at the humans, causing them to scatter before the immense starling.

“We’re here to help!” Mo shouts.

Setup



Take Intermissions ▶ Go to 58 ▶ Go to 100-101.

Tiles: 4x Bursting Bells

Victory Condition



Slay all adversaries.

Round limit: 8

Loss Conditions



Lose if Hra is slain.

Challenges



- 1 When the encounter begins, Hra suffers half their in damage.
- 2 Hra's attack loses the effect.
- 3 When rolling the damage dice for adversary attacks, treat a result of as +1 .

Special Rules



Hra

Hra is a mysterious earth aligned Starling who appears to be an ally to you and enemy to the Star Hunters. They are a part of their own faction, Hra, which is allied with Rovers, enemies with adversaries, and gains priority before the Rover faction.

Hra has 10*R hit points. As traits, they have 1, all push and pull effects targeting Hra are reduced by 1, and boulder objects within 1-2 of Hra are treated as barrier spaces.

Hra follows all the adversary logic rules found in the rule book. During their turn, Hra performs the following ability:



Ignore all movement penalties.



Terrain



Units that trigger crumbling column traps suffer 3.



Units that end their turn within 1 of this object recover 1.

Codex Links



187

Immediately when all enemies are slain, read “Hey There Big Guy”, 89.

Quest 9

While Mortals Sleep

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Introduction

It's the drifting that bothers him most. Era does not strive or struggle. It does not bend or break or claw for meaning the way he has. The way Andiron, and every other beast of the world, does. He has spent what feels like lifetimes amassing his power, forging it from agony and ambition, turning his very bones into conduits of ether so pure it burns him from within.

Yet they are still tethered. Chained to Chorus and all its sordid, unrelenting weight.

Through the highest reaches of the sky above Chorus, Era drifts onward. The archipelago moves like a memory in slow-motion, pulled by unseen forces, its jagged islands cloaked in the etheric gossamer of Air. Era is not a place meant for flesh and blood; it is claimed by starlings. At the heart of the largest island stands... Era, a magnificent tree. Whether the name for the great tree, or the name for the chain of islands came first, none can, or care to, say. Its roots coil deep into the floating island, anchoring the fragment of land against worldly forces that seek to scatter it to the cosmos. Its branches reach upward and outward, fracturing into a thousand glowing petals that seem to drink in the dim light of distant stars.

For those that have had the great fortune to somehow visit Era and can speak plainly of it, they tell of innumerable crystals that decorate the entirety of its grounds. Era is both home to starlings, and a grand cemetery. It is a place of pilgrimage for powerful starlings—one to experience something truly all their own, devoid of the necessity to mimic terrestrial life. As starlings come and go, live and die, they impart their ether across the islands and into the roots of Era, enhancing its affinity ever more. It is said that Era holds the secrets of the world, but there are no seekers on Era. Those that live there do not desire answers. They exist in stillness, in contemplation of the great, indifferent forces that shape all things. Era, untethered, drifts onward.

Naturally, this means that those without the capacity to visit it, fantasize the most about what splendors it could possibly contain. Scholars, alchemists, and killers all the same. Silky is familiar with some of the stories brought back from Era. The floating islands have a natural orbit around Chorus, and he is certain one of the other clans probably has a calendar for its passage over other continents. It hasn't occurred to him at any point during his planning and organizing over the months to consider it as part of the ongoing series of problems plaguing Lalos—it is, quite literally, disconnected from the world. An isolated system in every respect.

Yet a great kernel of horror is beginning to take root within him as he gazes upon the cluster of floating islands above. One such clan that would care a great deal about a mythologized home of starlings... would be the one that hunts those people to empower themselves. Their increased activity and renewed fervor in pursuit of power across the continent—had he truly underestimated their reach so completely?

Campaign Link



The previous quest chain you've completed will determine which version of encounter 9.1 you will tackle.

If you completed Quest 7 and slayed Bahzar, proceed to “How Wide Was It”  136.

If you completed Quest 8 and harmonized The King of Storms, proceed to “How Deep Was It”  138.

How Wide Was It

Introduction

The queen lies still, her immense body curled within the hollow like so much broken wood. Her once-lustrous carapace now dull—its iridescence bleached by her death. The stormcaller stands beside her, one hand resting on the curve of the matriarch’s swollen abdomen, the other hanging uselessly at her own side. The stormcaller clenches her fists, her nails digging into her palms until they bleed. She had poured everything into this one—her ether, her will, her love. The galeaper she chose had been perfect, one of palm-sized myriads that finally absorbed the ether of the starling cores. Together, they had commanded a swarm, a hungering force that could reshape the entire continent. Now, that beautiful host is gone, and the silence presses against the human’s ears.

What is the point? An endless struggle for control over a chaotic world, which not even the peak of a being’s form is able to stand against.

Stepping outside of the Unsouled Barrens feels... wrong. It has been at least two decades since Ozendyn last tread upon ground that did not bleed and heard wind that did not howl. With the fall of Bazhar and his Bonespire, Ozendyn was paralyzed by the now indeterminate nature of his future. In an effort to put off such thoughts, he extends an offer to accompany you at least partially as you seek to track where the Star Hunter clan has established their current base of operations.

Following the trail of destruction carved by the clan backwards from the Unsouled Barrens is simple enough. It leads east to a series of abandoned camps nestled in the plateau of the mountains adjacent to the Seat of Storms, a region frequently migrated through by clans and those seeking to become part of one.

Your travel is cut short as a boulder of ether shrieks its way into the ground some distance in front of your path. Another arrives, but as it lands, it releases a clutch of galeaper that had been clinging to its surface. The sky grows dark and a hateful scream heralds a sudden onslaught of wind and rain. Wingbeats add to the growing pitch of the storm. A human descends alongside her flock of winged creatures, water and unbridled rage pouring from her face.

“Every time we take a step closer to our goals, you show up and send us sprawling backwards. You may be more powerful now than when you killed my partner, but Uzem’s reflections left more than enough power to harvest even after you scared the beast off. The next step is the most important for us all AND YOU WILL NOT INTERFERE!” she shrieks, the final word punctuated by a clap of thunder.

Setup



Take 9 ▶ Go to 59 ▶ Go to 102-103.

Victory Condition



Slay the Battering Winds.

Round limit: 8 ⌚

Loss Conditions



Lose if Ozendyn is slain.

Challenges



- 1 The Battering Winds has +4*R .
- 2 When the Battering Winds attacks a Rover, they must drain all and ether dice in their personal or infusion pools.
- 3 Rovers can't benefit from the effects of wind nodes and can't take ether dice from them. Adversaries are affected by wind nodes when within 1-2.

Special Rules



Ozendyn

Ozendyn is a character ally to Rovers. For this encounter Ozendyn will only use the "Picket" side and will not flip.

Terrain



Non-flying units that enter jagged bones suffer 1.



Units within 1 of this object gain +1 .

Codex Links



160

Immediately when the Battering Winds is slain, read "Wait, Where is Mo?", 73.

How Deep Was It

Introduction

Ozendyn jerks awake, reaching for his blade and scanning his tent for Gargaki's calming presence. After the Rovers had helped him deal the final blow to Bazhar, the Unsouled Barrens were slowly but surely calming. The roars and desperate howls of its denizens spaced farther and farther apart. Strange things still lurked and slithered throughout but its never-ending haze of hunger and violence had tangibly lessened.

So to hear not just a shriek in the night, but one that was identifiably human, set his nerves on edge. A group of bandits had been lurking along the eastern stretch of the Barrens, but surely they hadn't been so foolish as to tread upon the Barrens in pursuit of some travelers? Ozendyn quietly gathers his supplies and begins his hike towards the source of the sound.

It's not long before he discovers the source of the commotion—a human warrior, distorted and wroth. Ozendyn keeps his distance as he watches the man throw himself along the ground in fits. Blood runs along his head and torso, pouring freely from gleaming crystals impaled through his flesh.

The cores left behind by a fell cradle. Raw, twisted ether of desperate monsters flooding in and out of an equally desperate and monstrous individual. Ozendyn shakes his head ruefully and turns back to return to his camp. He would have to warn the young zusag triplets to stay away for a while.

Travel in and out of the valley surrounding The Seat of Storms is often dangerous, but with Uzem having fled to find respite, getting around the range of mountains is much safer. Or it would be, were your party not speeding through as quickly as possible to chase down the fleeing Star Hunters. Silky has impressed a sudden sense of urgency after briefly following their route.

As you all reach the plateau on the other side of the mountains, your advance is cut short by the sound of screams and howling. When you draw closer, the only sound that remains is the howling—not from a beast, but a human. A lone harrow, surrounded by the carved remains of other Star Hunters, screams his fury skyward as he impales himself with the starling cores collected from their bodies. His figure is grotesque—bloated and churning with barely contained pulses of ether. The beasts scattered throughout the camp snarl, but keep their distance from the man.

Mo recoils from the sight, pressing themselves against Grandpaw's bulk in an effort to hide. "The vessels. He must have decided the foul things of Navel could grant power. I think they had... other ideas, once they felt the other essences within him."

The frenzied warrior whirls around to face your group, his attention focused entirely on Grandpaw and Mo. Coated in gore and viscera, gleaming ether cores pulsating within his flesh. He is no different than one of the mindless monstrosities of the Barrens now.

Setup



Take 9 ▶ Go to 60 ▶ Go to 104-105.

Victory Condition



Slay the Final Cut.

Round limit: 8

Challenges



- 1 The Final Cut gains +2 movement points to all of their movement actions.
- 2 Ashemaks gain +2 .
- 3 Adversaries are immune to the effects of morph nodes. Rovers can not take ether dice from morph nodes and are affected by them while within 1-2.

Terrain



Non-flying units that enter jagged bones suffer 1.



Units within 1 of this object gain -1 to the first attack they perform during their turn.

Codex Links



Immediately when the Final Cut is slain, read “Wait, Where is Mo?”, 73.

The Amber of This Moment

Introduction

Mo twists the bar of metal in the furnace thoughtlessly. They weren't sure how long they had been working. It didn't matter. Nothing mattered.

Another clan member came to deliver the next scratchpad for the crafting requests. A young keb rasska pairing, based on the keb's nascent Morph ether. They lingered in Mo's chamber, clearly working up the courage to try and speak.

A tendril wrapped itself around Nu's core unbidden. Mo hadn't wanted to begin absorbing it, so it was simply kept as close as possible. Another tendril whipped out violently at the young keb rasska and the starling let out their best approximation of a rasska's warning hiss. The pair startled and dropped the scratchpad as they turned and fled.

Guilt churned its way across Mo's body. The starling walked over and picked up the request and ran a pair of tendrils along its surface. Lockboxes that would withstand long-distance travel on the back of a draught arkenyn, with hidden chambers that could store smaller containers of lyst. An extra note expressed concern about 'contamination'. Curious, Mo hadn't met anybody outside of the commune that understood unsorted lyst could leech off of one another and dilute their efficacy.

Mo thrashes against the metal bars holding them captive. It was surprising that the Star Hunters had managed to infuse the cage with enough Earth ether to stymie the starling's efforts, but perhaps that was just a lucky coincidence. The ores from the western volcano and the southern desert both would have been rife with such content. How infuriating it was to have managed to barely escape this exact situation before, only for a cruel twist to bring Mo back to another struggle against the obscene humans once more.

"Patience, boys and girls. Two wings with one arrow on this one! We'll all get our fair share on the next pass once they've finished things up north." Mo's jailer chortled. He was a spindly branch of a man, but unlike many of the warriors of the clan the starling had seen so far, this one was so very... precise. A Morphic core at the base of the neck to balance the flow of Water and Air from either shoulder. This individual was important enough to receive special attention from the more experienced implanters.

A flash of Crux catches Mo's attention. Without stopping their assault against the cage, the starling began to focus on the source. Perfect symmetry cut into the shape of a bird—Silky had scouted the camp in record time. Mo didn't relax, but found themselves gently rubbing Nu's core.

A vindictive glee was bubbling within the starling's limbs.

Setup



Take 9 ▶ Go to 61 ▶ Go to 106-107.

Victory Condition



Free Mo from their cage.

Round limit: 8 ⌚

Challenges



- 1 Set the Round Limit to 6.
- 2 The Warden gains +2 .
- 3 Briarwogs and streaks gain +1 to all of their attacks.

Special Rules



Caged Starling

Mo has been captured by the Star Hunters. The Warden will execute Mo soon and take their shard for themselves. There are several ways to free Mo. Pick the path that best suits your team composition.

Clear the Camp

Slay all the enemies. If all adversaries are slain, you have the freedom to uncage Mo with no threat of retaliation.

Uncage Mo

Slay the Warden, take the cage key from them, then move to within 1 of cage to open it and free Mo.



Sunder the Cage

Open the cage by force and flee with Mo. Cage is a special object and has R*5 and 4. Rovers treat the cage as an enemy and no faction treats it as an ally.

Terrain



Non-flying units that enter jagged bones suffer 1.



Units within 1 of this object gain +1 .



Units that end their turn within 1 of this object suffer 1.

Codex Links



161 If the Warden is slain, read “Cage Master”, 74.



162 Immediately when all adversaries are slain, read “Let’s Get You Out of Here”, 74.



162 Immediately when cage space is destroyed, read “Let’s Get You Out of Here”, 74.

What Do The Birds Say

Introduction

The Eclipse stands directly beneath the floating archipelago of Era. Its islands visible through the jagged opening in the cavern roof above. They were quiet, peaceful, incapable of knowing what plagued the world beneath. One hand traces along the back of Andiron's spine, the other is twisted upward towards one of the islands overhead.

He grips one of the larger starling cores embedded in the beast's spine, stirring the higher concentration of Anima ether he had focused through Andiron's body. Their twin heads begin to snarl, but they just as quickly release their temper, knowing full well that they had been nurtured for this. Then it was time to call upon the Arcana swirling within his own body. Hundreds of starlings had been judged and selected for their composition. Such precarious balance that elevated him and his companion above all others. But it was only the first step. Paltry in comparison to what The Eclipse knew could be achieved.

Punctured along the cavern wall are numerous ether spikes harvested from the Thunder Mesa. The pure essence of Air wrought by Uzem's innumerable bolts of lightning, and the solid essence of Earth excavated where no other forces could hope to spoil its purity. The right combination, the right technique, the right timing...

He would make sure the starlings understood just what their name for him truly meant.

The shockwave hits you before anything else. It wraps the world in a blanket of complete and utter silence. No scream, no moan, no whimper will deny its theft of voice.

Then comes the wind. It crashes against your bodies and squeezes around you like the hand of an invisible colossus. This pressure does not care whether your body is made of flesh, metal, rock, fire—you will bend. You will break.

A wall of dust and debris follows. Pebbles and splinters slash across your bodies with the force of small explosives. It batters you relentlessly. It demands that you fall.

Hundreds of shadows obscure the sky—rocks, trees, bodies. They are cast across the entirety of Lalos with apocalyptic force. You are far enough away that none of it threatens to collide with you, but not far enough to be spared the sight of the carnage spilling out across the continent.

Sheer jubilation echoes through the valley. Star Hunters pour out from either side of the mountain pass, elated that their leader had managed to wield enough power to literally make the sky fall. The greatest success for the clan yet.

Then one of the clan notices the party of shocked and dismayed travelers. A row of people arranged like an audience in the furthest seats of the theater to a performance of unfathomable destruction. She laughs and cheers to her fellows, readies her bow, and begins dreaming of the coming celebration feasts.

Setup



Take 9 ▶ Go to 62 ▶ Go to 108.

Victory Condition



Slay all adversaries.

Round limit: 8

Challenges



- 1 Courslayers gain +1 to all of their attacks.
- 2 Grovetenders have +6*R .
- 3 Rovers can't benefit from the effects of earth nodes and can't take ether dice from them. Adversaries are affected by earth nodes when within 1-2.

Special Rules



Ambush

You have been ambushed by the Star Hunters. In this encounter, the Adversary faction gains priority before the Rover faction.

Terrain



Units that end their turn within 1 of this object recover 1.

Codex Links



163

The first time a courlsayer is slain, read “Trained Killer”, 74.

164

Immediately when all adversaries are slain, read “This is Bad”, 75.

Feet of Lead, Wings of Tin

Introduction

The blanket of silence stretches far and wide. Every so often, the sound of shifting soil or collapsing rock echoes across the impact crater. A node of ether bursts or shatters. Muffled shouts from Star Hunters ravaging the structures brought down with the island. But just as quickly, the silence always reclaims its hold on the area.

Silky couldn't help but flit about the scene with barely restrained excitement. Direct opportunities to study Era were exceedingly rare. Before long he gathers himself and begins to help with mapping the ruins more directly. His proposed first step is to find where the largest sources of ether might have been scattered, as that usually coincides directly with the clan's primary interests.

Era proves to be something of a riddle for everybody. The floating archipelago is home to a "clan" that doesn't need to worry about much of what drives the collection and innovation found within the terrestrial regions of Lalos (or likely the entirety of Chorus). There are obvious designs for myriad structures and apparatus, but everything has been so thoroughly pulverized that it's a futile task to try and piece any of it back together directly.

Then, two howls, twisting together, fighting for space in the air. One low and mournful, like the wind through an empty canyon; the other shrieked sharp and high, like an avian whistle, just piercing enough to make one's head ache. Not much progress has been made, but all the same, you've run out of time. The quiet has been shattered fully.

Booming footfalls echo over the lip of the impact crater. A titanic individual rides upon a twin-headed theran. Both are practically unrecognizable. A human and his companion at one point, perhaps. Both gleam with the sheen of a hundred dead souls speared through their flesh. Potent ether roils off of them in a tangible vapor.

The Eclipse.

"Silence, Andiron." the leader of the Star Hunters commands. His voice is an ensemble performance in which none of the singers can agree on the song. Each word arrives layered and fractured, a dozen chants rising and falling—some loud, some soft, some cracked and full of gravel, others smooth and cold as a frozen lake. The sound fills the air, ricocheting off the rubble, folding back in on itself. The voices didn't harmonize—they competed. One hisses while another booms. His face is calm, stoic even, as though it isn't his own mouth unleashing the noise.

It is cacophony.

Andiron, the twin-headed beast, snarls at your group. The Eclipse cracks a wide grin, though the expression is closer to the snarl of his companion. Both of their mouths are a mixture of unnatural fangs and embedded replacements made of sharpened starling core. "The fish that got away."

Silky tilts his head. "The density of the ether... How can they even move?! We..."

"GO!" shrieks Mo. "JUST GO! THERE IS A CHANCE! MOVE DEEPER! GO!"

Setup



Take 9 ▶ Go to 63 ▶ Go to 110-111.

Tiles: 3x Magical Traps

Victory Condition



Escape the Eclipse.

Round limit: 8 ⌚

Challenges



- 1 Courslayers gain +1 ✨ to all of their attacks.
- 2 Harrows gain +1 movement points to all of their movement actions.
- 3 Stormcallers gain +2 ⚡ to all of their attacks.

Special Rules



Eclipse

The Eclipse is the cruel and greedy leader of the Star Hunters, who rides upon his primal worg, Andiron. While within the ruins of Era, and the magics of the starling cores, the Eclipse is practically invulnerable. You can't win this fight. Flee to the exit spaces quickly.

Terrain



Units that trigger Magic traps suffer ✨ 3. When a Magic trap is triggered, roll an ether dice and place the ether field that corresponds with the result of the roll in the space the trap was in. A result of crux or morph places an adversary or , respectively.



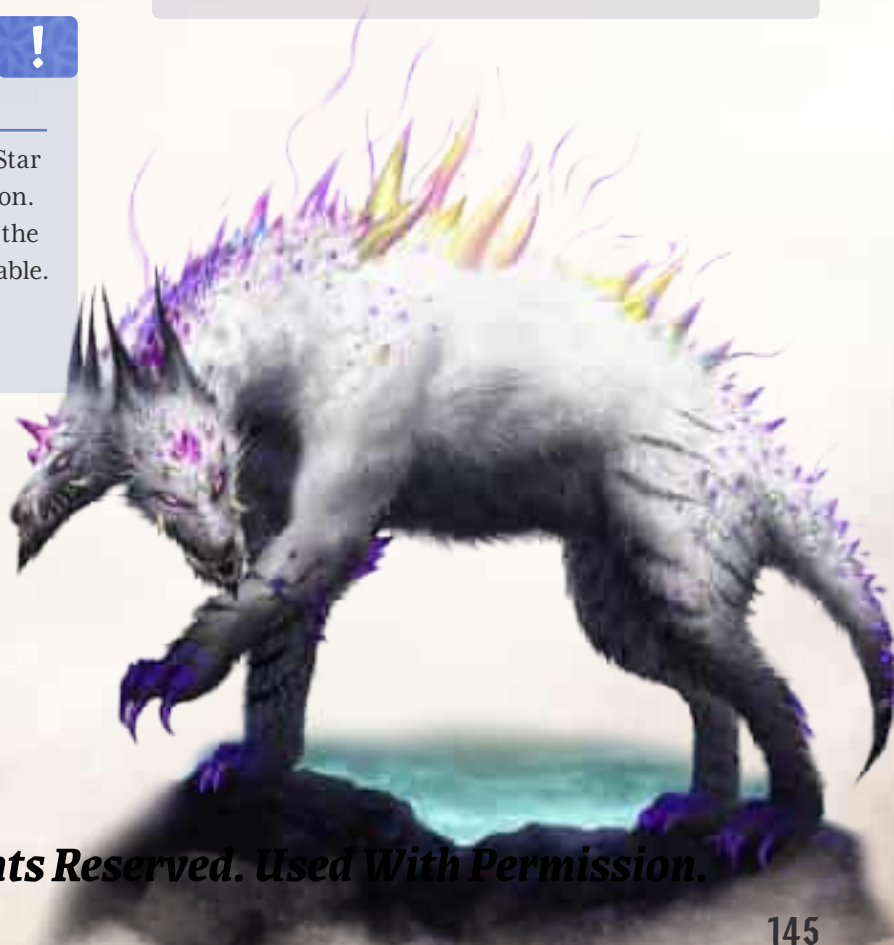
Units within ⚡ 1 of this object gain +1 🛡️.

Codex Links



🔍 165

At the end of the round, if all Rovers occupy an space, read “We Better Move Quickly”, 75.



Requirements of Chaos

Introduction

Era rustles gently in the breeze. A handful of petals drift from the canopy of the great tree and into the tendrils of the starling working between its boughs. These, too, would be used in the construction of the next piece of art that is to be stored in one of the displays of the outer islands. Every few months, a starling was selected to scale Era and gather weakening branches. As it absorbed more ether and grew ever larger, the branches obscured by the thickest parts of the canopy would start to wither. This was a practice brought to Era decades prior, impressed upon a starling that grew with humans.

Two starlings are engaged in a spirited debate. Eventually, the younger of the pair delivers a conclusion that surprises the older starling. The two reiterate their discussion and agree on the consensus achieved. They then begin to discuss the importance of their discussion. It is agreed to be of middling relevance, and so they will share their thoughts in one of the outer islands. The travel is satisfying as they descend into one of the hollow chambers. When they arrive, one of the starlings extends a single tendril that curls in upon itself. After a moment of concentration, it hardens, and the other starling severs it free and drops it into the clay canister. This was how Era fashioned their libraries, impressed upon a starling that grew with zusag.

Chimes fill the space of the glowing hollow. A lone starling kneels on a pedestal, surrounded by a circle of other starlings. Each holds a different instrument fashioned from the resources of Era. Clay pipes, crystalline chimes, wooden drums. One starling even sings, though the lyrics are simply emotion given voice and hold no true structure. The lone starling is old and diminished. They resemble a silvan whose wreath is that of pure Fire. With no desire to leave the confines of Era and replenish themselves, a rite is held instead as the last vestiges of their ether begins to burn away. They wish for their core to be fashioned into a light for this very chamber. This was what Era practiced as a funeral, impressed upon a starling that grew with tihfur.

Silky stretches from his perch upon Grandpaw's head, looking for any sign of the sources of ether that Mo had detected. The starling can only vaguely gesture in three directions. "I think this can work. If we had more time I could even use the refuse, but for now I believe the concentrated objects I'm feeling are the right choice. Their ether is... inspiring." Mo says.

"The clan is also everywhere, and I'd bet my left leg they're going to be attracted to that ether as well." Makaal retorts. He sighs and looks back at each of you with a tired smile. "But whatever happens, I'm more than happy to bet on your strength!"

Victory Condition



Find three starling shards.

Challenges



- 1 During the end phase of each round, Rovers must drain one non-☉ dice in their personal or infusion pool.
- 2 Rovers remove all ether dice from their personal and infusion pools when transitioning into a new area.
- 3 The 🐼 in the final area gains +5*R ❤️ and +1 ⚡ to all of their attacks.

There are three different areas to explore within the Era ruins, the Reliquary, the Archives, and the Mausoleum. All three locations must be explored to find all starling shards. Choose which area to explore first and reference the appropriate pages.

Reliquary

If you choose the Reliquary, proceed to page 112 of the adversary book, page 64 of the map book, and page 148 of the campaign book.

Archives

If you choose the Archives, proceed to page 113 of the adversary book, page 65 of the map book, and page 149 of the campaign book.

Mausoleum

If you choose the Mausoleum, proceed to page 114 of the adversary book, page 66 of the map book, and page 150 of the campaign book.

Place Rovers in 🚩 spaces and spawn adversaries according to Rover count as shown on the map. Rover ❤️, ether dice, and infusion dice carry over. Glyphs and summons carry over and are placed within 🏹 1 of their owner. You have 6 rounds to complete the next area.

Reliquary

Introduction

The area near the largest Great Tree on the fallen island survived the best, including the nondescript hole in the island's crust at its base. Despite the lack of ornamentation or adornment the solemnity of the area speaks to a place of veneration, a holy place. Tiny roots woven together form the ceiling and walls as you descend on worn stone stairs. You can see the roots sucking in Air ether and expelling small amounts of Morph. Mo observes that the Morph runs along the roots, holding the islands together, while the Air collects in the sap, slowly forming the abounding crystals which provide lift, keeping Era skybound.

Unfortunately this sacred place, too, has been defiled by the Star Hunters in their quest for personal enrichment. When you reach the bottom of the stairs you find a wide, open room filled with hulking harrow and their accompanying kifa. The Star Hunter captain, a stormcaller, stands in the center of the room, directing its destruction and pilfering.

The room was once filled with small shrines holding delicate relics wrought from the wood and leaves of the Great Trees of Era. Many were destroyed when the island fell, filling the room with rubble and ruin. Three greater shrines persist, miniature temples holding the most hallowed artifacts of Era. One of these must be the infused object that 'inspired' you to come this way.

Setup



Take 9 ▶ Go to 64 ▶ Go to 112

Tiles: 3x Magical Traps

Reliquary

The air is electric with potential. A powerful construct is housed here.

Area Victory Condition:



One Rover ends the round within 1 of the Reliquary .

Terrain



Units that trigger Magic traps suffer 3. When a Magic trap is triggered, roll an ether dice and place the ether field that corresponds with the result of the roll in the space the trap was in. A result of crux or morph places an adversary or , respectively.



Units within 1 of this object gain +1 to the first attack they perform during their turn.



Units within 1 of this object gain +1 .

Campaign Link



Go to "Reliquary Complete" 151.

Archives

Introduction

Makaal stares at the stony bit of starling tentacle in his hands. “Mo, what is this?! Why did you give me this?” Mo looks confused. “You asked how I knew that dagger would shatter. Is it not better to share information directly, rather than use imprecise verbiage?” Makaal takes a long, slow breath. “Mo, my friend, I appreciate the thought, but you know I can’t fuse with this like a starling!” The starling flinches, “No, you don’t fuse with it! Though I see the similarity, all you need to do is hold it against you while you meditate.” Makaal just shakes his head and hands the tendril back to his friend.

The archives are the deepest structures on Era; so deep you can occasionally see an exposed blue Water gem, like those that cover the bottom of the island sucking latent Water from the air to sustain the Great Trees. Thankfully, they are also the best reinforced and managed to remain largely in-tact even having fallen from the sky.

Normally the tidiest, best organized section of Era, the impact still all but ruined the interior leaving the shelves knocked down, dozens of clay jars dashed against the ground. Pottery and petrified starling tendrils crunch under the feet of the briarwogs patrolling the aisles while their masters seek out the infused shard. Silky’s aerios swoons in the air, appalled at the sight of such disregard for one of the greatest stores of information in the world. “The object of power will be stored alongside a tendril in one of the archives, Rovers, now hurry before I’m sick!” he exclaims.

Setup



Take 9 ▶ Go to 65 ▶ Go to 113

Tiles: 3x Magical Traps

Archives

The great chamber is eerily silent, as if the room itself holds its breath.

Area Victory Condition:



One Rover ends the round within 1 of the Archive .

Terrain



Units that trigger Magic traps suffer 3. When a Magic trap is triggered, roll an ether dice and place the ether field that corresponds with the result of the roll in the space the trap was in. A result of crux or morph places an adversary or , respectively.



It costs units 1 additional movement point to enter a space within 1 of this object.



Units that end their turn within 1 of this object suffer 1.

Campaign Link



Go to “Archives Complete” 151.

Mausoleum

Introduction

Mo leads you to an offshoot Great Tree on the fallen island. Even these ‘smaller’ trees are the size of a house on the surface, their twisting bark glowing with a golden inner light forming the walls of large hollows inside. Mo explains that many of the trees near the edges of Era are mausoleums, including the one they are leading you to now.

You peek your head around the entrance to scope out the inside. The mausoleum is a mess of shattered crystals and ruined burial urns, but you see only one harrow and her accompanying wrathbones defiling the graves in their search. One thing strikes you as odd, however; whereas typically the Star Hunters smash first and ask questions later, this harrow seems to be carefully fiddling with a starling core embedded in a scone.

Makaal whispers, “The cores are crafted into the memorial work. They have to be carefully extracted, or you risk destroying the entire core.” You nod and step up, ready to get to work. Before you can even make an impression, several coursayers drop from the ceiling where they had been extracting cores out of view. You steel yourselves regardless; the starling shard must be recovered.

Setup



Take 9 ▶ Go to 66 ▶ Go to 114

Tiles: 3x Magical Traps

Mausoleum

A heavy pal hangs over the markers of those lost.

Area Victory Condition:



One Rover ends the round within 1 of grave marker .

Terrain



Units that trigger Magic traps suffer 3. When a Magic trap is triggered, roll an ether dice and place the ether field that corresponds with the result of the roll in the space the trap was in. A result of crux or morph places an adversary or , respectively.



Units that end their turn within 1 of this object recover 1.



Units within 1 of this object gain -1 to the first attack they perform during their turn.

Campaign Link



Go to “Mausoleum Complete” 151.

Reliquary Complete

Record in your campaign log that, “The Reliquary starling shard was found.” If this is the first starling shard you have found, read “Collected An Echo of the Past”, on  75, then choose which room to go to next:

If you pick the Archives, proceed to  113,  65, and “Archives”,  149.

If you pick the Mausoleum, proceed to  114,  66, and “Mausoleum”,  150.

If this is the second starling shard you have found, proceed to the last room:

If the last room is the Archives (last),  116,  68, and “Archives Last”,  153.

If the last room is the Mausoleum (last),  117,  69, and “Mausoleum Last”,  154.

Place Rovers in  spaces and spawn adversaries according to Rover count as shown on the map. Rover  , ether dice, and infusion dice carry over. Glyphs and summons carry over and are placed within  1 of their owner. The round limit has been reset. You have 6 rounds to complete the next area.

Archives Complete

Record in your campaign log that, “The Archives starling shard was found.” If this is the first starling shard you have found, read “Collected An Echo of the Past”, on  75, then choose which room to go to next:

If you pick the Reliquary, proceed to  112,  64, and “Reliquary”,  148.

If you pick the Mausoleum, proceed to  114,  66, and “Mausoleum”,  150.

If this is the second starling shard you have found, proceed to the last room:

If the last room is the Reliquary (last), proceed to  115,  67, and “Reliquary Last”,  152.

If the last room is the Mausoleum (last),  117,  69, and “Mausoleum Last”,  154.

Place Rovers in  spaces and spawn adversaries according to Rover count as shown on the map. Rover  , ether dice, and infusion dice carry over. Glyphs and summons carry over and are placed within  1 of their owner. The round limit has been reset. You have 6 rounds to complete the next area.

Glyphs and summons carry over and are placed within  1 of their owner. The round limit has been reset. You have 6 rounds to complete the next area.

Mausoleum Complete

Record in your campaign log that, “The Mausoleum starling shard was found.” If this is the first starling shard you have found, read “Collected An Echo of the Past”, on  75, then choose which room to go to next:

If you pick the Reliquary, proceed to  112,  64, and “Reliquary”,  148.

If you pick the Archives, proceed to  113,  65, and “Archives”,  149.

If this is the second starling shard you have found, proceed to the last room:

If the last room is the Reliquary (last), proceed to  115,  67, and “Reliquary Last”,  152.

If the last room is the Archives (last),  116,  68, and “Archives Last”,  153.

Place Rovers in  spaces and spawn adversaries according to Rover count as shown on the map. Rover  , ether dice, and infusion dice carry over. Glyphs and summons carry over and are placed within  1 of their owner. The round limit has been reset. You have 6 rounds to complete the next area.

Reliquary (Last)

Introduction

The area near the largest Great Tree on the fallen island survived the best, including the nondescript hole in the island's crust at its base. Despite the lack of ornamentation or adornment the solemnity of the area speaks to a place of veneration, a holy place. Tiny roots woven together form the ceiling and walls as you descend on worn stone stairs. You can see the roots sucking in Air ether and expelling small amounts of Morph. Mo observes that the Morph runs along the roots, holding the islands together, while the Air collects in small, sparkling jewels of sap which provide lift, keeping Era skybound.

Unfortunately this sacred place, too, has been defiled by the Star Hunters in their quest for personal enrichment. The open room you find at the base of the stairs is filled with hulking, raging harrow and screeching kifa.

The space is filled with the rubble and ruin of dozens of small shrines, each of which once held a delicate relic wrought from the wood and leaves of the Great Trees. Only the three greater shrines persist, though not untouched. At the far end of the room you see this group's stormcaller captain clutching a pallid carving depicting starlings circling the sun while a tempest of Air drains from the relic into their embedded cores. The stormcaller seems to thin, becoming transparent as the intense ether of the Breath of Ama suffuses their being. You must recover the infused shard here quickly, before it meets a similar fate.

Setup



Take 9 ▶ Go to 67 ▶ Go to 115

Tiles: 3x Magical Traps

Reliquary

The air is electric with potential. A powerful construct is housed here.

Area Victory Condition:



Slay the Stolen Breath.

Terrain



Units that trigger Magic traps suffer 3. When a Magic trap is triggered, roll an ether dice and place the ether field that corresponds with the result of the roll in the space the trap was in. A result of crux or morph places an adversary or , respectively.



Units within 1 of this object gain +1 to the first attack they perform during their turn.



Units within 1 of this object gain +1 .

Codex Links



Immediately when the Stolen Breath is slain, read “We Have Need of Your Knowledge One Last Time”, 76.

Archives (Last)

Introduction

The archives are the deepest structures on Era; so deep you can occasionally see an exposed blue Water gem, like those that cover the bottom of the island sucking latent Water from the air to sustain the Great Trees. Thankfully, they are also the best reinforced and managed to remain largely in-tact even having fallen from the sky.

Normally the tidiest, best organized section of Era, the impact still all but ruined the interior leaving the shelves knocked down, dozens of clay jars dashed against the ground. Pottery and petrified starling tendrils crunch under the feet of the briarwogs patrolling the aisles while their masters seek out the infused shard. One such stands in the center, hands to his sides while absorbing the latent ether stored in the discarded tendrils. With each he drains another story, argument, essay, or other piece of knowledge is irretrievable lost from the world, forever.

Seeing so many petrified tendrils destroyed, Silky's aerios buzzes in the air, "These monsters!" Silky exclaims. "Were I there in form I'd rend their very souls for this!" He spins to face you all, "I'll trust you all do your work with suitable gusto to sate my nerves, Rovers! The artifact is sure to be in one of these jars, alongside the tendril that explains it. Seek it quickly, so we might sweep these pests from the archive!"

Setup



Take 9 ▶ Go to 68 ▶ Go to 116

Tiles: 3x Magical Traps

Archives

The great chamber is eerily silent, as if the room itself holds its breath.

Area Victory Condition:



Slay the Piercing Gaze

Terrain



Units that trigger Magic traps suffer 3. When a Magic trap is triggered, roll an ether dice and place the ether field that corresponds with the result of the roll in the space the trap was in. A result of crux or morph places an adversary or , respectively.



It costs units 1 additional movement point to enter a space within 1 of this object.



Units that end their turn within 1 of this object suffer 1.

Codex Links



Immediately when the Piercing Gaze is slain, read "We Have Need of Your Knowledge One Last Time", 76.

Mausoleum (Last)

Introduction

Mo leads you to an offshoot Great Tree on the fallen island. You peek your head around the entrance; the room is a mess of shattered crystals, ruined burial urns, and ether-infused debris. You see several courslayers carefully tearing away bits of Erawood and metal from starling cores once laid to rest.

Makaal whispers, “The cores are crafted into the memorial work. They have to be carefully extracted, or you risk destroying the entire core.” You nod and observe the rest of the room. Across the room stands a large mud-brick hearth full of roiling flame. Suddenly the flames contract to reveal a harrow, her face a confusing mix of rage and bliss. The flames seem to flow from her left hand, a bloody mess completely obscured by a giant, newly embedded starling core. She has infused herself with the Ardor of Inhe, granting her immense Morph and Fire ether.

This brutal, profane desecration of interred remains enrages Makaal, who urges you to destroy the Star Hunters within, “Down to the last mote!” Mo seems to be shaking from a flush of emotion, Nu clutched to their chest, but they nod as well saying, “Don’t worry about further disturbing the tombs for now. We must staunch the bleeding before we can worry about recovery.”

Setup



Take 9 ▶ Go to 69 ▶ Go to 117

Tiles: 3x Magical Traps

Mausoleum

A heavy pal hangs over the markers of those lost.

Area Victory Condition:



Slay the Heavy Hand.

Terrain



Units that trigger Magic traps suffer 3. When a Magic trap is triggered, roll an ether dice and place the ether field that corresponds with the result of the roll in the space the trap was in. A result of crux or morph places an adversary or , respectively.



Units that end their turn within 1 of this object recover 1.



Units within 1 of this object gain -1 to the first attack they perform during their turn.

Codex Links



167

Immediately when the Heavy Hand is slain, read “We Have Need of Your Knowledge One Last Time”, 76.



Something Worth Wishing For

Introduction

The Eclipse stood before the immense boulder of ether. The beating heart of the very island he wrenched from the sky. It pulses vibrantly with a light that is every color at once. He slammed his hands into it, palms flat against the surface, the embedded cores spiking through the lodestone. He grit his teeth and absorbed the ether into himself, one agonizing second at a time. It poured through his fingers, up his arms, into his chest—an indescribable torrent of energy that no living being should be able to withstand.

The lodestone cracked. A single fissure ran its length, spilling light and ether into the deepest recess of the impact crater. The Eclipse growled, his skin already beginning to glow in places. He could feel himself... unraveling, not dying exactly, but becoming something else, something bigger and stranger. This broken heart of Era didn't care about him. It didn't care about anything. It only poured itself out, ceaseless and unrelenting.

Andiron whined and growled, angered at the inability to fight back this unseen threat.

The Eclipse stands before the bleeding lodestone, sitting comfortably atop his theran beast. The wisps of ether pouring from the fractures of the lodestone snake their way into the bodies of the two monsters. He languidly turns his attention to your group, smirking to himself about an unspoken joke.

“Might makes right? No, that’s not enough. How embarrassing it is to be... vulnerable.” he begins. “That is our problem. Individually, collectively, totally. Each and every one of us are VULNERABLE! If Chorus is to sustain itself, sustain us, we must cease to be so vulnerable.” He runs a hand against the flank of Andiron.

“We find solace in numbers. Pairs, clans, armies. Even beasts. Swarms, packs, flocks. So intrinsic is this vulnerability that all living things seek to bolster themselves with numbers. Yet there is one place where this is not a fact of life,” he says, pointing one finger straight into the air. The rest of Era trails overhead. Dozens of small figures can be seen floating between the islands—starlings, terrified of the sudden attack on their home.

“They lived free of fear. Free of struggle. Why not remind them what it means to be... vulnerable? How cruel of them, to selfishly withhold such power that could render us all free of this obvious flaw.” his smirk melts away, leaving behind a snarl of disgust.

Mo’s tendrils writhe in fury, but they withhold their anger towards The Eclipse. Instead, they turn to face you. “Those treasures are the pinnacle of my work. You’ve all become so adept at channeling ether—these will let you take the final steps to perfect control. In, and out. Neutralize the sources of ether, and demonstrate that even The Eclipse cannot escape this ‘flaw’ we all have.”

Setup



Take 9 ▶ Go to 70 ▶ Go to 118-119.



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Victory Condition

Slay Eclipse.

Challenges

- 1 Each time a Rover places an ether field in an enemy space, they place the same ether field in their own space.
- 2 After Eclipse attacks a Rover, that Rover must reroll all non-☐ dice in their personal and infusion pools.
- 3 Rovers suffer ⚡ 1 each time they generate an ether dice.

Special Rules

Vengeance

Eclipse is a cruel and unrelenting fighter. This encounter does not have a round limit, but you will still have to keep track of rounds. On every 4th round, Eclipse gains +1 ⚡ to all attacks they perform. This is an accumulative bonus, meaning on the 8th round this bonus is +2 ⚡, on the 12th round the bonus is +3 ⚡, etc.

Invincible

Eclipse has absorbed an unhealthy amount of ether, making themselves nearly invincible. To stand a chance of taking down Eclipse you will have to sever their connection to the Ether Lodestone. To do this, you'll have to place ☐ dice onto R*2 Ether Lodestone spaces. Each Ether Lodestone space can only have one ☐ dice on it. Rovers gain two new abilities for this phase:

Drain Ether: Return one of your ether dice from your personal pool to the general pool and gain one ☐ dice.

Infuse Dim: Place one ☐ dice from your personal pool onto an Ether Lodestone space within ↗ 1.

Note: Drain Ether and Infuse Dim are abilities and require an ability activation to use.

Note: ☐ dice can not be removed from the Ether Lodestone.

Terrain



Units that end their turn within ↗ 1 of this object suffer ⚡ 1.



Units that end their turn within ↗ 1 of this object recover ♥ 1.



It costs units 1 additional movement point to enter a space within ↗ 1 of this object.



Units within ↗ 1 of this object gain +1 🛡.



Units within ↗ 1 of this object gain +1 ⚡ to the first attack they perform during their turn.



Units within ↗ 1 of this object gain -1 ⚡ to the first attack they perform during their turn.

Codex Links

Q 168

At the end of the round, if there are ☐ dice on R*2 Ether Lodestone spaces, read “Severed Connection”, 📖 76.

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